

A B U R Y,

A

T E M P L E

OF THE

British DRUGS,

With SOME OTHERS,

D E S C R I B E D.

By WILLIAM STUKELEY, M.D.

A B U R Y,
A
T E M P L E
OF THE
British DRUIDS,
With SOME OTHERS,
DESCRIBED.

By *WILLIAM STUKELEY*, M.D.

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Abury, A Temple of the British Druids, With Some Others, Described

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Abury, A Temple of the British Druids, With Some Others, Described

Author: William Stukeley

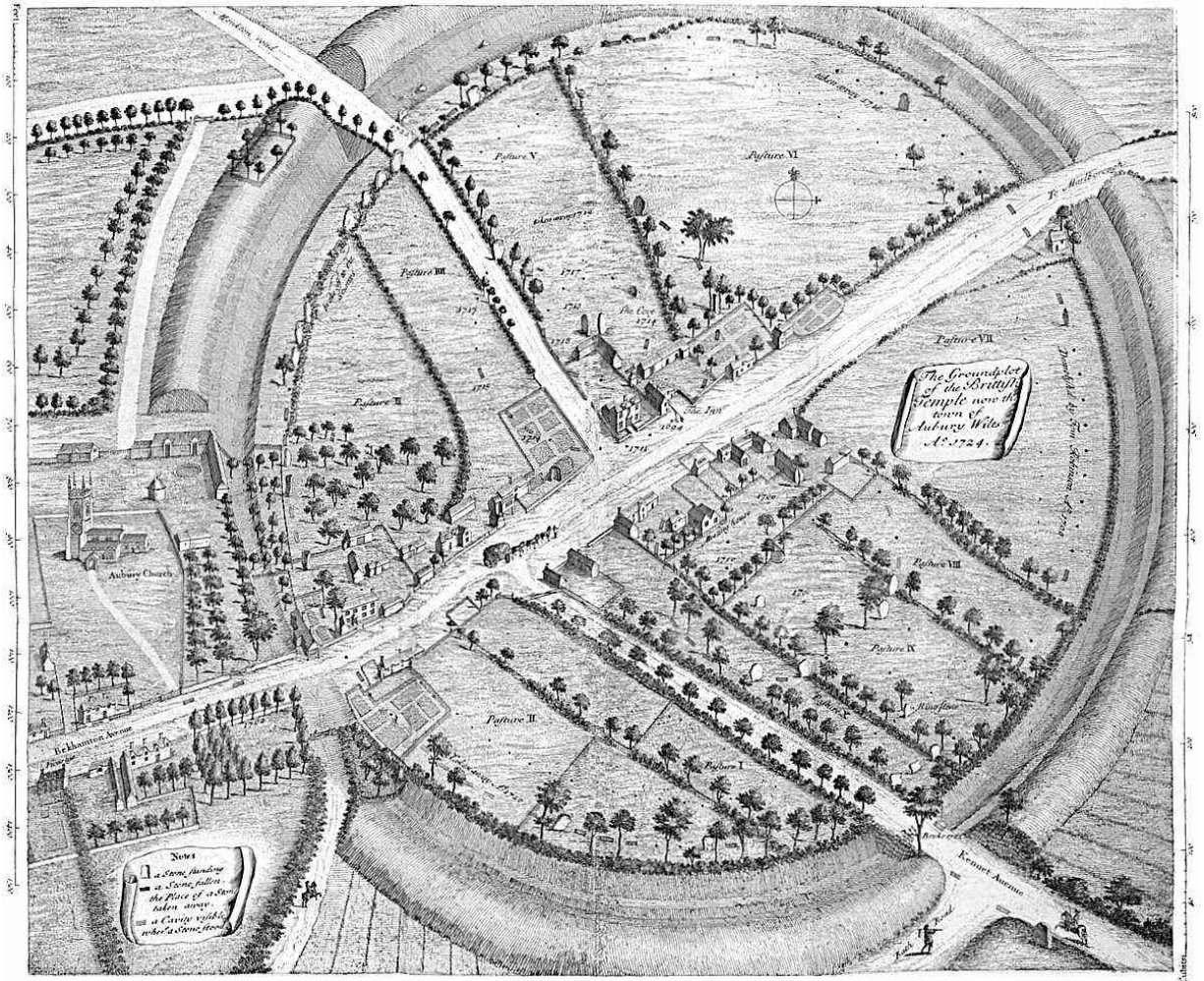
Release date: February 25, 2021 [eBook #64626]
Most recently updated: October 18, 2024

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/64626

Credits: Tim Lindell, Robert Tonsing, The British Library and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This file was produced from images generously made available by the Bibliothèque nationale de France (BnF/Gallica) at <http://gallica.bnf.fr>)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ABURY, A
TEMPLE OF THE BRITISH DRUIDS, WITH SOME OTHERS,
DESCRIBED ***



Stukeley del.

E. Kirkall sculp.

*The Groundplot
of the Brittish
Temple now the
town of
Aubury Wilts.
A°. 1724*

A B U R Y,
A
T E M P L E
OF THE
British D R U I D S,
With S O M E O T H E R S,
D E S C R I B E D.

Wherein is a more particular account of the first and patriarchal religion; and of the peopling the BRITISH ISLANDS.

———*Quamvis obstet mihi tarda vetustas,
Multaque me fugiant primis spectata sub annis,
Plura tamen memini*——— Ov. Met. XII. v. 182.

By WILLIAM STUKELEY, M.D.

Rector of All-Saints in Stamford.

L O N D O N:

Printed for the AUTHOR: And Sold by *W. Innys, R. Manby, B. Dod,*
J. Brindley, and the Booksellers in London.

M DCC XLIII.

CONTENTS.

[DEDICATION](#)

[PREFACE.](#)

[CHAP. I.](#)

[CHAP. II.](#)

[CHAP. III.](#)

[CHAP. IV.](#)

[CHAP. V.](#)

[CHAP. VI.](#)

[CHAP. VII.](#)

[CHAP. VIII.](#)

[CHAP. IX.](#)

[CHAP. X.](#)

[CHAP. XI.](#)

[CHAP. XII.](#)

[CHAP. XIII.](#)

[CHAP. XIV.](#)

[CHAP. XV.](#)

[CHAP. XVI.](#)

[INDEX.](#)

To the RIGHT HONOURABLE

H E N R Y

EARL of PEMBROKE, &c. &c.

RIGHT HONOURABLE,

IN a family that has been in all ages remarkably the friend of the muses, I think myself happy, that I have a particular claim. To You, my Lord, this dedication is devolv'd by hereditary right. Through Your father's auspices and encouragement, I began and continued the work. He was ever pleas'd to look upon my mean performances with a favourable eye; and to assist me out of the inexhaustible fund of his own knowledge, in all kinds of ancient learning; and promised to patronize it, when published.

But if any thing herein be acceptable to the publick, they are indebted to Your Lordship for its appearing abroad sooner than I intended myself. Out of that innate love of letters which warms the breast of the PEMBROKES, You thought fit to prompt and encourage me to the printing of it; and Your Lordship's judgment will be an agreeable prejudice in my favour; who have cultivated Your excellent talents by your own industry; by all that can be learn'd in a curious view and observation of the antiquities of *Italy*; who are in every sense a master of that immense treasure of *Greek* and *Roman* marbles, which render *Wilton* the *Tramontane Rome*.

Besides that learning which is the ornament of the present age, Your Lordship knows how to put a true value on the antiquities proper to Your own country. If they want somewhat of the delicacy of the *Augustan* times, or that of *Alexander* the great; yet they have their beauties, and even

elegancies, which affect so exquisite a taste as Your Lordship's. A symmetry and harmony of parts, an amazing grandeur in the design, the incredible force of the mechanick powers employ'd in them, the most magnificent effect produc'd, will for ever recommend the works of the Druids, to those of Your Lordship's discerning eye and accurate judgment.

We see a convincing demonstration of this, in the fine and costly model of *Stonehenge*, which Your Lordship introduces in the garden at *Wilton*; where, I may be bold to say, it shines amidst the splendours of *Inigo Jones's* architecture; amidst what he did there in person, and what Your Lordship has since added, so agreeable to the former, as to render the design of that great genius complete.

So uncommon and unconfined is Your Lordship's knowledge in architecture, particularly, that *Great Britain* beholds a bridge arising, chiefly under Your direction, superior to any the *Roman* power produc'd at the height of empire. And *Thames*, which so lately rescu'd the *Danube* from *gallic* tyranny, boasts of a nobler ornament than that which *Trajan* built across that famous river.

That commendable ardour of mind, which in Your younger years led you to study men and manners, places and things, in foreign countries, you now employ for the good of Your own; in the exercise of civil and military arts. Your Lordship tempers that love of liberty, which is the glory of government, with that just allegiance to the sovereign, which is the security of all; so as to give us a view of that amiable character of ancient *english* nobility, which adorns every page of *british* history. Permit me the honour to profess myself

Your LORDSHIP'S

most faithful, and

most obedient

humble servant,

January 1, 1742-3.

WILLIAM STUKELEY.

P R E F A C E.

HISTORY is political wisdom, philosophy is religious. The one consists in the knowledge of memorable things, and application of that knowledge to the good conduct of life: in embracing the good, and avoiding the ill consequences and examples of actions. So the other teaches us to entertain worthy notions of the supreme being, and the studying to obtain his favour: which is the end of all human and divine wisdom. Religion is the means to arrive at this purpose. In order to be satisfied what is true religion, we must go up to the fountain-head as much as possible. The first religion undoubtedly is true, as coming immediately from God.

When I first began these studies about the Druid antiquities, I plainly discern'd, the religion profess'd in these places was the first, simple, patriarchal religion. Which made me judge it worth while to prosecute my enquiries about them, as a matter the most interesting and important. Knowledge is the glory of a man, divine knowledge of a christian. What I have done in this volume, is a further prosecution of the scheme I have laid down to this purpose. The noble person to whom it is dedicated, induc'd me to hasten the publication, suggesting the shortness of human life, and having a good opinion of the work.

I was willing to lay hold on the first opportunity of communicating to the world, the pleasure of contemplating so very noble antiquities, which we enjoy in our own island, before it be too late to see them. My endeavour in it is to open the times of first planting the world, after the flood; the propagation of true religion together with mankind; the deviation into idolatry; the persons that built the several kinds of patriarchal temples, such as we see here, in the more eastern parts of the world; the planters of *Great Britain* in particular; and the connexion there is between the east and west in matters of religion. All this shews there was but one religion at first, pure and simple.

Pausanias in Corinthiac. writes, “the *Phliasians*, one of the most ancient colonies in *Greece*, had a very holy temple, in which there was no image,

either openly to be seen, or kept in secret." He mentions the like of a grove or temple of *Hebe*, belonging to that people; and adds, "they give a mystical reason for it." I guess the mystery to be, that it was after the first and patriarchal manner. The same author says *in argol*. "that at *Prona* is a temple of *Vesta*, no image, but an altar, on which they sacrifice." The ancient *Hetruscans* ordain'd by a law, that there should be no statue in their temples. *Lucian de dea Syr.* writes, "the ancient temples in *Egypt* had no statues." *Plutarch, in Numa*, and *Clemens Alexan. strom.* I. remark, "that *Numa* the second king of *Rome*, made express orders against the use of images, in the worship of the deity." *Plutarch* adds, "that for the first 170 years after building the city, the *Romans* used no images, but thought the deity to be invisible." So to the days of *Silius Italicus* and *Philostratus*, at the temple of *Hercules* our planter of *Britain*, at *Gades*, the old patriarchal method of religion was observ'd, as bishop *Cumberland* takes notice, *Sanchoniathon*, p. 266.

Sed nulla effigies, simulachrave nota deorum.

Silius III.

And our *british* Druids had no images. And whatever we find in history, that looks like idolatry in them, is not to be referr'd to the aboriginal Druids, but to the later colonies from the continent.

Likewise I have open'd a large communication between the patriarchal family, of *Abraham* particularly, and of the first planters of the coasts on the ocean of *Spain*, *Gaul*, *Germany* and *Britain*. 'Tis plain, what religion was here first planted, as being an almost inaccessible island, flourished exceedingly, and kept up to its original system, even to the days of *Cæsar*, I mean among the aboriginal inhabitants. The new planters from the continent, on the southern and eastern shore of the island, were tainted at least with idolatry, in the later times. Whilst on the continent, where more frequent changes of inhabitants happen, idolatry every where polluted it. But in all accounts of the first beginnings of nations, they had the first religion: 'till as every where, time, riches, politeness and prosperity bring on corruption in church and state.

We find, on the continent, idolatry crept on by degrees universally, which was the occasion of providence exerting its self in the *Mosaick* dispensation: and thereby changing the manner of these temples, altogether

polluted. Nevertheless we have no reason to think but that the Druids, in this island of ours, generally kept up to the purity of their first and patriarchal institution. And that is the reason that all our classical writers, tho' much later than the times we are treating of, represent them as a people of a religion diametrically opposite to that of the rest of the world, even as the *Jews* then, or christians afterwards.

Therefore I thought it fully worth while, to bestow some pains on these temples of theirs, as the only monuments we have left, of the patriarchal religion; and especially in regard to their extraordinary grandeur and magnificence, equal to any of the most noted wonders of the world, as commonly termed.

I have shewn largely enough, the evidences that there were such kinds of temples built all the world over, in the first times; but probably nothing of them now remaining, comparable to those in our own island: which therefore we ought to seek to rescue from oblivion, before it be too late.

I propose to publish but one volume more to complete this argument, as far as I have materials for that purpose. What I have done, I look upon as very imperfect, and but as opening the scene of this very noble subject. The curious will find sufficient room to extend it, to correct and adorn the plan I have begun. And I take it to be well worthy of the pains; as it lets in upon us an excellent view of the scheme of providence, in conducting the affair of true religion, thro' the several ages of the world. We may hence discern the great purpose of inducing the *Mosaick* dispensation, on that very spot of ground where the main of idolatry began, and from whence it was propagated over all the western and politer world; and over which world providence rais'd the mighty *Roman* empire, to pave the way of a republication of the patriarchal religion.

We may make this general reflexion from the present work, that the true religion has chiefly since the repeopling mankind after the flood, subsisted in our island: and here we made the best reformation from the universal pollution of christianity, popery. Here God's ancient people the *Jews* are in the easiest situation, any where upon earth; and from hence most likely to meet with that conversion designed them. And could we but reform from the abominable publick profanation of the sabbath and common swearing,

we might hope for what many learned men have thought; that here was to be open'd the glory of Christ's kingdom on earth.

I have render'd it sufficiently clear, that the *Apollo* of the ancients was really *Phut* son of *Cham*. And I have pointed to the reader, how he may have a perfect idea of the countenance of the man, in innumerable monuments of antiquity, now to be seen. I have pursued that amusing topick thro' very many of the ancient patriarchs before and after *Phut*: so as to recover their, at least heroical, effigies. Which, I hope, sometime I may find an opportunity of publishing.

I shall conclude my preface with a piece of old poetry, being some nervous lines, in no contemptible vein, wrote on our subject a hundred years ago, by *Samuel Danyel* a domestick of queen *Anne*'s, wife to king *James* I. The curious reader will observe a remarkable delicacy in the sentiments throughout: a struggle between time and the greatness of these works, equal to that of letters, in endeavouring to recover and preserve the memory of them; which their founders, tho' well qualified, neglected to do.

*O Blessed letters, that combine in one
All ages past; and make one live with all!
Make us confer with those who now are gone,
And the dead living unto counsel call!
By you th' unborn shall have communion
Of what we feel, and what does us befall.*

*Soul of the world, knowledge, without thee
What hath the earth that truly glorious is?
Why should our pride make such a stir to be;
To be forgot? What good is like to this,
To do worthy the writing, and to write
Worthy the reading, and the world's delight!*

*You mighty lords, that with respected grace,
Do at the stern of fair example stand;
And all the body of this populace,
Guide with the only turning of your hand:
Keep a right course, bear up from all disgrace,
Observe the point of glory to our land.*

*Hold up disgraced knowledge from the ground,
Keep virtue in request, give worth her due.
Let not neglect with barbarous means confound
So fair a good, to bring in night anew.
Be not, oh be not accessory found
Unto her death, that must give life to you.*

*Where will you have your virtuous names safe laid?
In gorgeous tombs, in sacred cells secure?
Do you not see, those prostrate heaps betrayed
Your fathers bones, and could not keep them sure?
And will you trust deceitful stones fair laid,
And think they will be to your honour truer?*

*No, no, unsparing time will proudly send
A warrant unto wreck, that with one frown
Will all these mockeries of vain-glory rend,
And make them as before, ungrac'd, unknown.
Poor idle honours that can ill defend
Your memories that cannot keep their own!*

*And whereto serves that wondrous trophy now,
That on the goodly plain near Wilton stands?
That huge dumb heap, that cannot tell us how,
Nor what, nor whence it is, nor with whose hands,
Nor for whose glory it was set to show,
How much our pride mocks that of other lands.*

*Whereon when as the gazing passenger
Hath greedy look'd with admiration,
And fain would know its birth, and what it were,
How there erected, and how long ago;
Inquires and asks his fellow-traveller,
What he hath heard, and his opinion!*

*And he knows nothing; then he turns again,
And looks and sighs, and then admires afresh,
And in himself with sorrow doth complain,
The misery of dark forgetfulness.*

*Angry with time, that nothing should remain,
Our greatest wonders wonder to express.*

*Then ignorance, with fabulous discourse,
Robbing fair art and cunning of their right,
Tells how those stones were by the devil's force,
From Africk brought, to Ireland in a night:
And thence to Britannie, by magick course,
From giants hand redeem'd by Merlin's sleight.*

*And then near Ambry plac'd, in memory
Of all those noble Britons murder'd there,
By Hengist and his Saxon treachery,
Coming to parle in peace at unaware.
With this old legend then, credulity
Holds her content, and closes up her care.*

*And as for thee, thou huge and mighty frame,
That stands corrupted so by times despite,
And gives no evidence to save their fame,
That set thee there, and testify their right:
And art become a traitor to their name,
That trusted thee with all the best they might.*

*Thou shall stand, still belyed and slandered,
The only gazing stock of ignorance,
And by thy guilt the wise admonished,
Shall never more desire such heaps t' advance,
Nor trust their living glory with the dead,
That cannot speak, but leave their fame to chance.*

*Tho' time with all his power of years, hath laid
Long battery, back'd with undermining age,
Yet thou makes head, only with thy own aid,
And war with his all conquering forces wage;
Pleading the heavens prescription to be free,
And have a grant t' indure as long as he.*

A B U R Y,
A T E M P L E of the
British D R U I D S,
With some Others, DESCRIBED.

CHAP. I.

Of the origin of Druid or patriarchal temples, with publick religion and celebration of the sabbath. They were made of rude stones set upright in the ground, round in form, and open. In hot countries, groves were planted about them. Abraham practised it, and from him our Druids. Of the quality of evidence, in matters of such antiquity. The patriarchs had a knowledge of the nature of the Deity to be ador'd, subsisting in distinct personalities: which is even deducible from human reason. The Druids had the same knowledge, as appears by their works. The first publick practice of religion was called, invoking in the name of Jehovah, the mediator.

THE writers on antiquities generally find more difficulty, in so handling the matter, as to render it agreeable to the reader, than in most other subjects. Tediousness in any thing is a fault, more so in this than other sciences. 'Tis an offence, if either we spend much time in a too minute description of things, or enter upon formal and argumentative proofs, more than the nature of such accounts will well bear. Nevertheless the dignity of the knowledge of antiquities, will always insure a sufficient regard for this very considerable branch of learning, as long as there is any taste or learning left in the world. And indeed we may in short ask, what is all

learning, but the knowledge of antiquities? a recalling before us the acquirements in wisdom, and the deeds of former times. But the way of writing well upon them, as I conceive, is so to lay the things together, to put them in such attitude, such a light, as gains upon the affection and faith of the reader, in proceeding; without a childish pointing out every particular, without a syllogistical proving, or mathematical demonstration of them: which are not to be sought for in the case. The subject of antiquities must be drawn out with such strong lines of verisimilitude, and represented in so lively colours, that the reader in effect sees them, as in their first ages: And either brings them down to modern times, or raises himself, in the scale of time, as if he lived when they were made. Then we may truly say with the poet,

*Scilicet antiquis proficiscitur inde venustas,
Quod, tanquam nova sint, qui legit illa, legat.*

In endeavouring to keep up to such a rule, I must advertise the reader of the general purport of this volume. It may be said to consist of four parts. Three are descriptions of the three kinds of Druid temples, or we may call them patriarchal temples, which I have observed in *Britain*. The fourth will be reflexions upon them, as to their antiquity and origin; the founders of such in the more early ages of the world, and in the more oriental countries. And tho' in writing the descriptive part of these heads, (which I did on the spot, and with great leisure) my papers swell'd to an enormous bulk; and it was necessary for my own right understanding the antiquities: yet I shall shorten them exceedingly, in delivering the work to the publick. In doing this, I shall be very much helped by the engraven designs which at one view give the reader a better notion of the things, than the most elaborate descriptions. Likewise in that part of the work wherein I reason upon these temples, and trace out the vestiges of such as are recorded to us by the learned authors of antiquity now preserved, I shall barely lay the appearances of things together; the relation between these monuments we now see with our eyes, and the accounts of such-like (as I take them) which I find in those authors to have been from oldest time. I shall leave the reader to form his judgment from such evidence, without endeavouring to force his assent with fancied proofs, which will scarce hold good, in matters of so remote an age.

After what I have said in my former volume on *STONEHENGE*, which carries our ideas concerning these antiquities, up to the very earliest times of the world; I may venture to discourse a little *ex priori*, concerning the origin of temples in general. And this will open my purpose concerning the three first heads of this book: the three different kinds of the Druid or patriarchal temples in the *Britannic* isles. If we desire to know any thing of a matter so very remote, as in all other affairs of antiquity, we must necessarily have recourse to the Bible. And I apprehend, it is mentioned in that passage *Genesis* IV. the last verse; “and to *Seth*, to him also there was born a son, and he call’d his name *Enos*: then began men to call upon the NAME of the LORD.”

I observe on this passage, the gloss in our *English* Bibles is thus, to call *themselves* by the name of the LORD, which is very erroneous: *themselves* is a mere interpolation; and would we translate it truly, it ought to be, to *call in* the name of *Jehovah*; rather, to *invoke* in the name of *Jehovah*. *Vatablus* turns it, then began the name of *Jehovah* to be invoked. The jewish writers generally take this passage to mean the origin of idolatry, as if it imported, then began men to profane the *Name*, by calling themselves therewith. And our great *Selden* drops into that opinion. But was it probable, the divine historian would have been so careful to commemorate an epoch so disagreeable? or to what purpose, even before he had so much as mention’d any publick form of true religion? the very wording of that verse imports somewhat very remarkable, which he was going to declare, “and to *Seth*, to him also there was born a son, and he called his name *Enos*: then began men to invoke in the name of *Jehovah*.”

TAB. II.
P. 2.

English Feet	Cubits	English Feet	Cubits	English Feet	Cubits	English Feet	Cubits
1	1	1	1	10	10	100	100
2	2	2	2	20	20	200	200
3	3	3	3	30	30	300	300
4	4	4	4	40	40	400	400
5	5	5	5	50	50	500	500
6	6	6	6	60	60	600	600
7	7	7	7	70	70	700	700
8	8	8	8	80	80	800	800
9	9	9	9	90	90	900	900
10	10	10	10	100	100	1000	1000
11	11	11	11	110	110	1100	1100
12	12	12	12	120	120	1200	1200
13	13	13	13	130	130	1300	1300
		14	14	140	140	1400	1400
		15	15	150	150	1500	1500
		16	16	160	160	1600	1600
		17	17	170	170	1700	1700
		18	18	180	180	1800	1800
		19	19	190	190	1900	1900
		20	20	200	200	2000	2000

In understanding this verse aright, we must certainly affirm that *Moses* intended hereby, to assert the practice of publick religion; which necessarily includes two things, the origin of temples, and the sabbatical observance. For in all publick actions, time and place are equally necessary. In the generation, or days of *Enos*, grandson of *Adam*, when mankind were multiply'd into distinct families; besides private and family devotion, the publick worship of God was introduc'd in places set apart for that purpose, and on sabbath days. Publick worship necessarily implies all this.

Many and great authorities confirm this understanding of the words, as well as the reason of things. The *Targum* of *Onkelos*, *Aquila's* translation. *Rabbi Elieser* in *Maase Bereschit* XXII. *R. Salomon Jarchi*, the *Chaldee* paraphrast. *Vossius in comm.* on *Maimonides* de idololatria. And very many more, too tedious to be recited.

Try the place by other like expressions in scripture, and we find, it amounts to the same thing. *Genes.* xii. 8. *Abram* builded an altar unto *Jehovah*, and *invoked* in the name of *Jehovah*. So it ought to be translated. This was the second altar he built in *Canaan*, being the second place he settled at, near *Bethel*. In the preceding verse, we have an account of his first settling at *Sichem*, and of *Jehovah* appearing to him personally and conversing with him: and of his building an altar to that *Jehovah*, who appeared unto him. But I think there is so little difficulty in it, that 'tis needless to multiply authorities or argumentations: yet the importance of it demanded thus much.

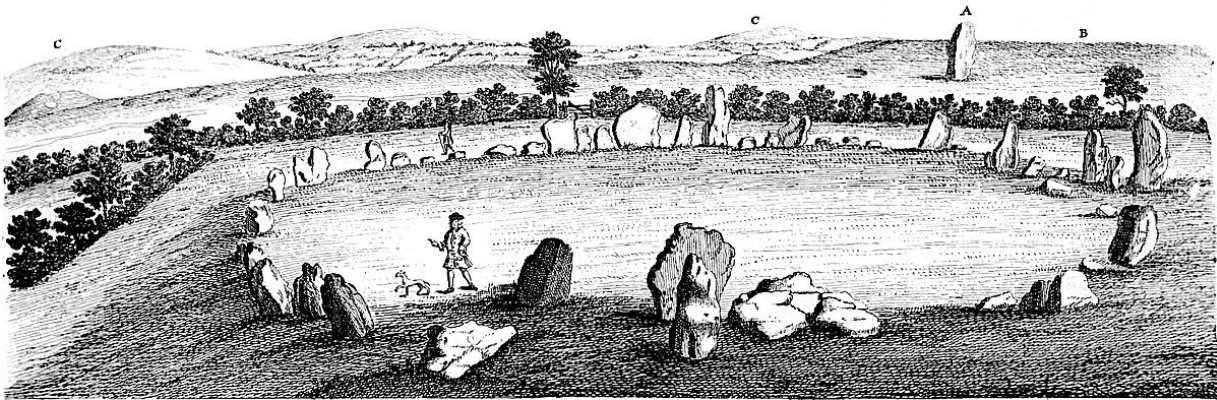
Here three things most evidently appear, 1. *Jehovah* was that person in the deity, who appeared visibly and discoursed with the patriarchs, not the invisible supreme. 2. That *Abram* erected an altar to this divine person *Jehovah*, worshipped him, and invoked in his *name*. Invoked whom? the supreme unquestionably, *i. e.* prayed to the supreme Being, in the *name*, virtue, effect, and merit of *Jehovah*, the mediatorial deity. The word NAME, in these passages of scripture, means the mediatorial deity, JEHOVAH by name: 'Ο Θεος Επιφανης, the God who appear'd personally to the patriarchs, who was the king of the *Mosaic* dispensation, and of the *Jewish* people, call'd the anointed or *Messiah*, 1 *Sam.* ii. 10, 35. he was the captain of the *Israelites*, that conducted them from *Egypt* to *Canaan*, *Exod.* xxiii. 20. the royal angel, the king, emperor. The angel of his face or presence, *Isaiah* lxiii. 9. the angel of the covenant, *Malachi* iii. 1. *Melech Jehovah* the angelick king, *Zechar.* iii. 1, 2, 3, 4. he is very God: for, says the supreme, in the before quoted passage in *Exodus*, *behold I send an angel before thee* (the angel, it ought to be read) *to keep thee in the way, and to bring thee into the place which I have prepared. Beware of him and obey his voice, provoke him not, for he will not pardon your transgressions; for my NAME is in him.* This same way of speaking *Joshua* uses, *Josh.* xxiv. 19. *Ye cannot serve Jehovah; for he is a holy deity, he is a jealous God, he will not forgive your transgressions, nor your sins.* The *Jews*

confess this doctrine to be just. *Rabbi Hadersan* upon that passage in *Zephaniah* iii. 9. to call upon the NAME of *Jehovah*, says, this *Jehovah* is no other than *Messiah*. All this shews the patriarchs had a knowledge of the true nature of the deity, and that the Christian or mediatorial religion is the first and the last. And when men were quite deviated from the first, the *Mosaic* dispensation was but an intervening veil upon the effulgence and spirituality of true religion for a time, to reduce them to it, in the actual advent of the *Messiah*. 3. These altars, as they are here called, were the patriarchal temples like those of our druids, the places of publick worship; and invoking in the name of *Jehovah*, is a form of speech importing publick worship on sabbath days: equivalent to our saying, to go to church on sundays. Whence *Servius* on the *Æneid* III. v. 85. writes, in the most ancient manner of worshipping, they only pray'd directly to the deity, without offering sacrifice. And thus I apprehend, we are to understand *Herodotus* II. where he says the *Athenians* learn'd invoking, of the *Pelasgi*, who were *Phœnicians*: and probably they had it from *Abraham*, who was introduc'd into the land of *Canaan*, as a reformer of religion. Invoking was the ordinary method of devotion on sabbath days: sacrificing was extraordinary.

It was *Abraham's* custom, wherever he dwelt, to build one of these temples: as afterward, in the plain of *Mamre*, by *Hebron*, *Gen.* xiii. 18. And at *Beersheba* we are told he planted a grove, and there invoked in the name of *Jehovah*, the everlasting God, *Gen.* xxi. 33. It cannot be doubted but there was an altar and work of stones at the same place. And this was the usage of all the patriarchs, his successors, ever after; as is obvious in scripture, even to *Moses's* time. *Isaac* builded an altar in *Beersheba*, and invoked in the Name of *Jehovah*, who personally appear'd to him, *Gen.* xxvi. 25. *Jacob* set up the anointed pillar at *Bethel*, xxviii. 18. and the temple there, xxxv. At *Shechem* he builded another, xxxiii. 20. At *Bethel* he set up a pillar, where *Jehovah* personally appeared to him, and blessed him: he anointed it, and poured a drink-offering, or libation thereon, xxxv. 14. In *Exod.* xxiv. 4. we read, *Moses rose early in the morning, and builded an altar under the hill, and twelve pillars*, which we have no reason to doubt were set in a circle. The like was done after they were seated in the land of *Canaan*, till the temple of *Solomon* was built: for *Samuel*, when he dwelt at *Ramah*, built an altar, to *Jehovah* there, whereat to celebrate publick offices of religion, 1 *Sam.* vii. 17.

Hence we gather further these three things. 1. That they planted groves in patriarchal times, as temples for publick worship. It seems that this was done in those hot countries, for convenience in the summer-season: and perhaps for magnificence. For we are told, *Abraham* dwelt long at *Beersheba*, where he planted the grove. These were as our cathedrals; they were planted round about the circular parts of stones, as porticos for receiving of the congregation. Whence groves and temples became a synonymous appellation, both in sacred and heathen writers. 2. That these temples which they call'd altars, were circles of stones, inclosing *that* stone more properly nam'd the altar. The circles were greater or less, of more or fewer stones, as the will or convenience of the founder prompted. *Moses* his temple was a circle of twelve stones: and such we have in *England*. 3. They were commonly made on open plains, and rising grounds, conspicuous and commodious for multitudes, a whole neighbourhood to assemble in. This is the consequence of the nature and reason of the thing: for a matter of publick use must be in the most publick and conspicuous place. 4. The patriarchal religion, and the christian, is but one and the same. Hence in *Isaiah* xix. 19. the prophet speaking of the restitution of the patriarchal religion in *Egypt*, under the gospel dispensation, says, "In that day shall there be an altar to *Jehovah* in the midst of the land of *Egypt*; and a pillar, at the border thereof, to *Jehovah*." This is expressly making use of the terms of a patriarchal temple, with a view to that religion restor'd, meaning the christian.

View of the Temple of Rowldrich from the South.



Stukeley del.

A. the King Stone, as called. B. the Archdruids barrow. CC. round barrows: or King barrows.

These monuments of the piety of the patriarchs in the eastern parts of the world, were in time desecrated to idolatrous purposes, and at length destroy'd, even by the people of *Israel*, for that reason: and temples square in form and cover'd at top, were introduc'd at the *Mosaic* dispensation, in direct opposition to that idolatry. But before then, that first method pass'd all over the western world, and to *Britain*, where we see them to this day. By the way, we trace some footsteps of them, but there is always a fable annex'd; as generally at this day, in our Druid temples at home. Thus *Pausanias in corinthiacis* informs us, that near the river *Chemarus*, is a *septum* or circle of stones. He says, they have a report there, that this is the place whence *Pluto* carry'd away *Proserpine*. By such story we must understand, the mysteries were there celebrated. *Pausanias* writes, that the *Thracians* us'd to build their temples round, and open at top, in *Bæotic*. He speaks of such at *Haliartus*, by the name of *Ναός*, equivalent to the *Hebrew Beth*, which name *Jacob* gave to his temple. He speaks of several altars dedicate to *Pluto*, set in the middle of *areas* fenc'd in with stones: and they are call'd *hermionenses*. He tells us too, among the *Orchomenians*, is a most ancient temple of the *Graces*, but they worship 'em in the form of stones. From the number three, we may easily guess this was a *Kist vaen*, as our old *Britons* call it, or *Kebla*, like that in our great temple of *Abury*, and

elsewhere. Indeed, the stones of these *Kebla* in time, instead of a direction in worship, became the object of worship; as *Clemens Alexandrinus* affirms.

That our Druids were so eminently celebrated for their use of groves, shews them to have a more particular relation to *Abraham*, and more immediately from him deriving the usage: by which way, I pointed at in good measure, in the account of *STONEHENGE*. Hence the name of Druid imports, priest of the groves; and their verdant cathedrals, as we may call them, are celebrated by all old writers that speak of this people. We all know the awful and solemn pleasure that strikes one upon entering a grove; a kind of religious dread arises from the gloomy majesty of the place, very favourable to the purpose intended by them. *Servius* upon *Æneid* III.

Ante urbem in luco falsi Simoëntis ad undam,

observes, *Virgil* never mentions a grove without a note of religion. Again, *Æneid* IX. ver. 4. *Strabo* says, the poets call temples by the name of groves. And this is frequently done in the scripture. But it is natural for our classic writers, when speaking of the Druids and their great attachment to religious rites, so different from what they were acquainted with, to insist much upon their groves; overlooking our monuments, which they would scarce dignify with the name of temples, because not covered like their own. Yet if with some, we would from hence conclude, that they were the only temples of the Druids, and therefore *Stonehenge* and the works we are upon, were none of theirs, we should err as much, as if we asserted *Abraham* only made use of groves, and not of the other temples erected on plains and open places.

Thus far I premis'd with brevity, as an introduction to our discourse, shewing the origin of temples among mankind; a necessary provision for that duty we owe to our sovereign author and benefactor. For unless we can prove ourselves self-sufficient and independent, all nature cries aloud for our acknowledgment of this duty. Private and domestic prayer is our duty as private persons and families, that we have life, and subsistence, and the common protection of providence: but the profession and exercise of publick religion is equally necessary as we are a community, a part of the publick, a parish, a city, a nation, link'd together by government, for our common safety and protection; in order to implore at the hands of God almighty the general blessings of life, wanting to us in that capacity. And that person who secludes himself from his share in this duty, is a rebel and

traitor to the publick, and is virtually separated from the common blessings of heaven. But *time* is equally necessary to this publick duty as *place*, as every one's reason must dictate. Therefore was the sabbath instituted; the very first command of our maker, even in the happy seat of *Paradise*, and before our fatal transgression. 'Tis the positive institution of God, and founded upon the strictest reason. So that if we allow the patriarchs to have built these temples, wherein to assemble for publick devotion, and disallow of the sabbath, because not particularly mention'd in the scripture that they did celebrate it, we think absurdly, and err against common sense and reason. The scriptures were given to teach us religion, but not to inform us of common sense and reason.

The duty of the sabbath commences as early as our being, and is included with great propriety in that observation of the divine historian concerning *Adam's* grandson, *Enos*; when it pass'd from a family-ordinance to that of several families united, as then was the case. The particularity of the expression, *invoking* in the name of *Jehovah*, dictates to us the form of their religion, founded on the mediatorial scheme, which Mediator was a divine person, to be worshipped; and thro' our faith and hope in him, or in his *Name*, we were to invoke God almighty for our pardon and protection. Therefore the same scheme of religion subsists, from the beginning to this day, the *Mosaic* system intervening chiefly as a remedy against idolatry, till the world was prepar'd for the great advent; and patriarchal religion should be republish'd under the name of christian.

From all this we must conclude, that the ancients knew somewhat of the mysterious nature of the deity, subsisting in distinct personalities, which is more fully reveal'd to us in the christian dispensation. All nature, our senses, common reason assures us of the one supreme and self-originated being. The second person in the deity is discoverable in almost every page of the old testament. After his advent, he informs us more fully of the nature of the third person: and that third person is discoverable in almost every page of the new testament. That the ancients had some knowledge of this great truth, the learned *Steuchus Eugubinus* demonstrates, in *perenni philosoph.* from their writings which are still left, such as *Hermes*, *Orpheus*, *Hydaspes*, *Pythagoras*, *Plato*, the *Platonics*, the sibylline verses, the oracles, and the like. Our *Cudworth* has very laudably pursued the same track, and *Kircher*, and our *Ramsey* in his history of *Cyrus*, and many more,

to whom I refer the curious reader, who has a mind to be convinced of it. I shall only add this, that upon supposition only of an ancient tradition of it, having been handed down from one generation to another, in order to light up and kindle our reason concerning it; that 'tis a doctrine so far from being contrary to reason, or above human reason, that 'tis deducible therefrom, and perfectly agreeable to it, as I shall shew in [Chap. XV.](#)

Nor is this a slight matter; for if knowledge be a valuable thing, if it be the highest ornament and felicity to the human mind; the most divine part of all knowledge is to know somewhat of the nature of the deity. This knowledge the Druids assuredly attempted to come at, and obtained, as we gather from the different kinds of their temples; and when we have described them, we shall beg leave to resume this argument, and briefly to discourse on it again, as being the chief and ultimate purpose of all antique inquiries.

TAB. IV.
P. 6.

View of Rowldrich Stones from the West Sept. 11. 1724.



Stukeley del.

A. the Kistvaen at a Distance.

CHAP. II.

Of the origin of temples more particularly, the meaning of the name.

The manner of them, round and open. The Mosaic tabernacle a temple square and cover'd, in opposition to the former desecrated into idolatry. Another reason, covered with skins, because typical of Messiah. So the patriarchal or Druid temples made in those forms, that were symbols of the deity, and the divine personalities thereof. When become idolatrous generally dedicated to the sun, by reason of their round form. The most ancient symbolic figure of the deity was the circle, snake and wings, which we see frequently on Egyptian and other Monuments. The patriarchal temples made in representations thereof; therefore of three kinds. I. A circle only. II. A circle and snake. III. A circle and wings. This Volume treats of a temple of each of these kinds in Britain. The temple of ROWLDRICH in Oxfordshire being of the first sort, described. The Evidence of its being a work of the Druids, drawn up in a kind of order, as a specimen. 1. Its high situation, on an open heath by the heads of rivers. 2. An open circle of stones set upright, taken from the surface of the ground. 3. The appearance of the weather on them. 4. From the name, the Gilgal of Joshua explain'd. 5. From the measure, the Druid cubit. 6. From the barrows all round it. A Druid's court. The king's tumulus. The archdruid's tumulus, the founder. 7. From old reports concerning these works. 8. Sepulchres frequently the occasion of founding temples in all ages, from a hope of the body's resurrection, and one occasion of deifying heroes, and introducing idolatry, the first species of it.

TEMPLE is a word deriv'd from the greek *Τεμενος*, a place cut off, inclosed, dedicated to sacred use, whether an area, a circle of stones, a field, or a grove. This matter, as all others, advanced from simplicity, by degrees, till it became what we now call a temple. Thus we read in *Iliad* II, of *Ceres's* field. *Iliad* VIII, of *Jupiter's* field and altar. In XXIII, another at the

fountain of *Sperchius*. In *Odyss.* VIII, that of *Venus Paphia*. *Pausanias* mentions many of these. *Cicero* too among the *Thebans*, *de nat. deor.* III. In *Odyss.* XVII, a grove perfectly round by *Ithaca*. And these were encompass'd by a ditch which *Pollux* calls *peribolus*. *Pausanias* makes this particular remark in *Achaic*, of the grove of *Diana servatrix*. They were kept by priests who dwelt there for that purpose, as *Maron* in *Odyss.* IX.

Tempe signifies a grove or temple, which is the same thing. *Strabo* writes, that the poets, for ornament sake, call all temples groves. This was in affectation of antiquity.

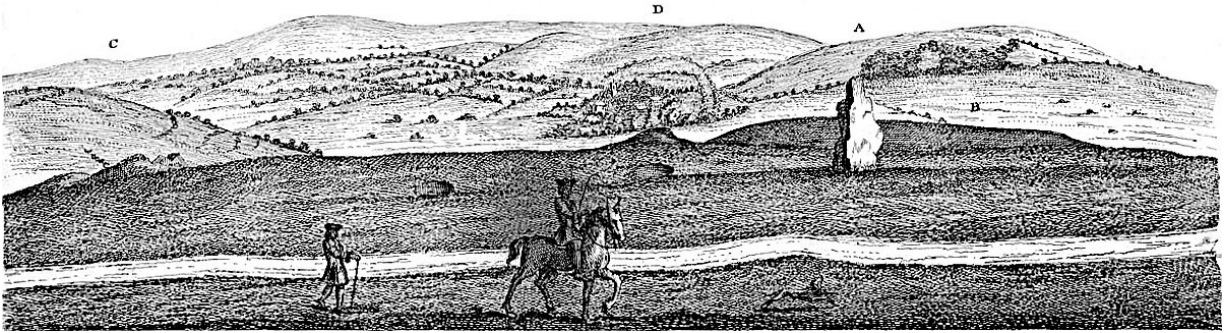
*Est nemus Æmoniaë, prærupta quod undique claudit
Sylva, vocant Tempe.*——

Tempulum, or contractedly *templum*, is a lesser grove, or temple properly speaking, built with pillars, as it were in imitation of a great grove. The patriarchal *temeni* were call'd *במיה excelsa*, because generally made on high places. Hence the greek word *βωμος*. By the *hebrew* writers they were call'd *sacella montana*, mountain oratories. *Sacellum*, says *Festus*, is an open chapel, or without a roof. At length the word temple was apply'd to sacred structures built with a roof, in imitation of *Solomon's*. And that was a durable and fixed one, an edifice of extraordinary grandeur and beauty, made in imitation of the *Mosaic* tabernacle, which was a temple itinerant, the first idea of a cover'd one, properly. There were two reasons, among others, why it was cover'd and square in form. 1. By way of opposition to the heathen ones, practised in all the countries round about, which were imitations of the first patriarchal temples there, and now were converted to idolatrous purposes. 2. Because it was a type of Messiah, or *JEHOVAH* who was to come in the flesh, therefore cover'd with skins. And that we may have the greatest authority in the case, our Saviour himself declares in the most publick manner, that the temple of *Jerusalem* was symbolical of his body, as we find it recorded in the gospel, *John* ii. 19. And the author of the *Hebrews* largely deduces the necessity of making temples to be the pictures of heavenly things, and particularly of the mediator, *Heb.* ix. 11, 23. which can be done no otherwise than symbolically. And authors that describe the tabernacle and temple, insist upon this largely. Nor is it otherwise with us christians, in our cathedrals, designing our saviour's body extended on the cross. But in the more ancient patriarchal times, before the

great advent, they form'd them upon the geometrical figures or pictures, or manner of writing, by which they express'd the deity, and the mystical nature thereof. And this same design of making temples in some kind of imitation of the deity, as well as they could conceive it, was from the very beginning. The heathen authors retain some notion of this matter, when they tell us, of temples being made in the form and nature of the gods. *Porphyry* in *Eusebius pr. ev.* III. 7. affirms the round figure to be dedicated to eternity, and that they anciently built temples round; but he did not understand the whole reason. And when they built temples properly, in imitation of the Jewish, they made them often of a round form, and often open at top, to preserve as near as might be, the most ancient manner they had been acquainted with. Whence *Pausanias* writes, the *Thracians* us'd to build their temples round, and open at top.

Thus at *Bethel*, the place where *Jacob* built his temple, and where his grandfather *Abraham* had built one before, *Jeroboam* chose it for his idolatrous temple, call'd by the *Alexandrian Greeks* in after times, οἶκος Ὠν, the temple of *On*. *S. Cyril* in his comments on *Hosea* writes, that *On* is the sun, from its round form. The heathen had done all they could to corrupt the remembrance of the name of the true God, and turn'd *Beth-el*, which signifies the house of E L or God, to οἶκος Ὠν, the house of *On*, or the sun. As ἡλῖος, is a word undoubtedly made from E L, in the *Hebrew*, expressing God's power and sovereignty; so much like *Elion* a name of God in Scripture, signifying *Hypsistus*, the most high. *Gen.* xiv. 18. *Luke* i. 37. in *Arabic*, *allah taâla* the most high God. Whence *Atlas* the name of consecration of the *African* hero, *allah taâl*.

The prospect Northward from Rowldrich Stones.



Stukeley del.

A. the King Stone. B. the Archdruids barrow. C. king barrows or round barrows. D. long compton.

When these ancient patriarchal temples in other countries came to be perverted to idolatry, they consecrated many of them to the sun, thinking their round form ought to be referr'd to his disc; and that these pyramidal stones, set in a circle, imitated his rays. Hence call'd *Aglibelus*, *rotundus Deus*, as interpreted by *Bochart*. עגל בעל, ζευς επικυκλιος among the orientals, as *Schedius* observes. And had the ancient *Greek* writers seen our temples of *Stonehenge*, and the rest, they would have concluded them dedicated to the sun.

These temples of ours are always of a round form: and there are innumerable of them, all over the *Britannic* isles, nevertheless they are to be ranked into three kinds; for tho' they are all circular, yet there are three manifest diversities which I have observ'd, regarding that threefold figure, by which the ancients, probably even from *Adam's* time, express'd in writing, the great idea of the deity. This figure by *Kircher* is call'd *ophio-cyclo-ptygo-morphus*. 'Tis a circle with wings, and a snake proceeding from it. A figure excellently well design'd to picture out the intelligence they had, no doubt, by divine communication, of the mysterious nature of the deity. And it was the way of the ancients in their religious buildings, to copy out or analogize the form of the divine being, as they conceiv'd it, in a symbolical manner. By this means they produc'd a most effectual prophylact, as they thought, which could not fail of drawing down the

blessings of divine providence upon that place and country, as it were, by sympathy and similitude.

I shall therefore make it the subject of the present volume, to describe one or two of each sort of the temples built upon the plan of these figures: wherein the founders have left an incontestible proof of that knowledge which the ancient world had of the divine nature, by these durable and magnificent monuments. The remainder of these temples (as many as are come to my knowledge) together with the places of the sports and games of the ancient *Britons*, and the religion of the Druids, I shall publish in the succeeding volume.

Names or words are necessary for the understanding of things; therefore 1. The round temples simply, I call temples; 2. Those with the form of a snake annext, as that of *Abury*, I call serpentine temples, or *Dracontia*, by which they were denominated of old; 3. Those with the form of wings annext, I call alate or winged temples. And these are all the kinds of Druid temples that I know of. We may call these figures, the symbols of the patriarchal religion, as the cross is of the christian. Therefore they built their temples according to those figures.

ROWLDRICH.

I shall begin with *Rowlright* or rather *Rowldrich*, and as a specimen of what requisites are sought for in these enquiries, I shall draw them up in a kind of order: which may be useful in all researches of this sort.

1. A situation on high ground, open heaths, by heads of rivers.

ROWLDRICH is a temple of the Druids of the first kind, a circular work which has been often taken notice of in print, lying in the north-west part of *Oxfordshire*: upon high ground, where the counties of *Oxford*, *Warwick*, and *Glocester* meet. 'Tis near the town of *Chippin-Norton*. Two rivers rise here, that run with quite contrary directions; the *Evenlode* towards the south part of the kingdom, which joining the *Isis* below *Woodstock*, visits the great luminary of *Britain*, *Oxford*, and then meets the *Thames* at *Dorchester*, the ancient *Episcopal see* of the *Mercian* kingdom. At this *Dorchester* are fine remains both of *Saxon* church antiquity, of *Roman*, and of *British*. The inquisitive that prefer our own country antiquities to the vain tour of

foreign, will find much of curious amusement there. The other river *Stour* runs from *Rowldrich* directly north, to meet the *Avon* at *Stratford*, thence to the *Severn* sea. So that *Rowldrich* must needs stand on very high ground, and to those that attentively consider the place itself, it appears to be a large cop'd hill, on the summit of an open down; and the temple together with the Archdruid's barrow hard by, stand on the very tip of it, having a descent every way thence: and an extensive prospect, especially into *Glocestershire* and *Warwickshire*. The country hereabouts was originally an open, barren heath; and underneath, a quarry of a kind of rag stone. At present near here are some inclosures, which have been plough'd up. The major part of our antiquity remains: tho' many of the stones have been carried away within memory, to make bridges, houses, &c.

2. 'Tis an open temple of a circular form, made of stones set upright in the ground. The stones are rough and unhewn, and were (as I apprehend) taken from the surface of the ground. I saw stones lying in the field north of *Norton*, not far off, of good bulk, and the same kind as those of our antiquity. There are such in other places hereabouts, whence the Druids took them: tho' in the main, carry'd off ever since, for building and other uses.

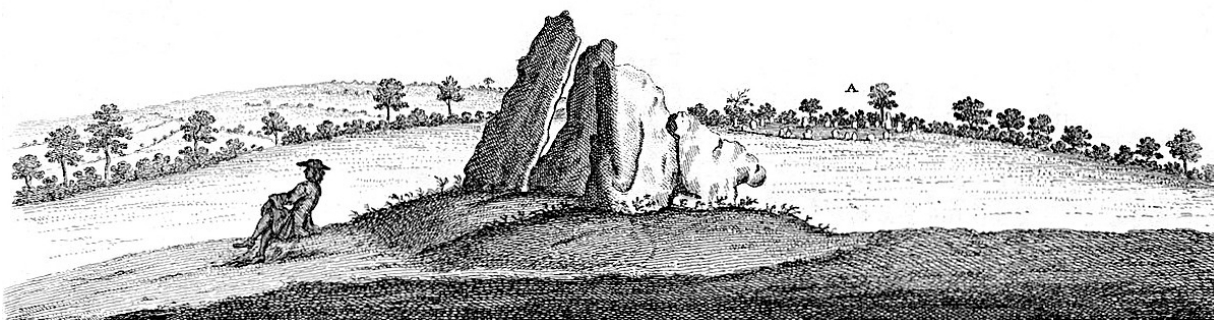
3. We observe the effect of the weather upon these works. This we are treating of, stands in a corner of the hedge of the inclosure, near the northern summit of the hill, "a great monument of antiquity," says the excellent Mr. *Camden*, "a number of vastly great stones plac'd in a circular figure. They are of unequal height and shape, very much ragged, impair'd and decay'd by time." Indeed as from hence we must form some judgment of their age, we may pronounce them not inferior to any in that respect; corroded like worm-eaten wood, by the harsh jaws of time, and that much more than *Stonehenge*, which is no mean argument of its being the work of the Druids.

4. We are led to this conclusion from the name. Mr. *Camden* calls them *Rolle-rich* stones. Dr. *Holland* in his note says, in a book in the *Exchequer* (perhaps he means doomsday book) the town adjacent, (whence its name) is *Rollendrich*, if it was wrote exactly, I suppose it would be *Rholdrwyg*, which means the Druids' *wheel* or *circle*. *Rhwyll* likewise in the *British*, is *cancelli*, for these stones are set pretty near together, so as almost to become a continued wall, or *cancellus*. Further, the word *Roilig* in the old *irish*

language, signifies a church; then it imports the *Druids'* church, *chancel*, or *temple*, in the first acceptation of the word. We may call this place the *Gilgal* of *Britain*, to speak in the oriental manner, a word equivalent to the *Celtic Rhol*, a wheel or circle, which gave name to that famous camp or fortress where the host of *Israel* first pitch'd their tents in the land of *Canaan*; after they pass'd the river *Jordan* in a miraculous manner, dry-shod, as 'tis described in the sublimest manner, and equal to the dignity of the subject, in *Joshua* iv. There also we read, that *Joshua* caused twelve men, a man out of each tribe, to pitch twelve stones in the channel of the river *Jordan*, where the ark stood whilst the people pass'd over, when the stream was cut off; they were set there for a memorial. And they likewise took up twelve stones out of the bed of the river, and *Joshua* pitch'd them in *Gilgal*, in a circular form, which gave name to the place, meaning a *rhowl* or *wheel*. And to this he alludes in the next chapter, in that passage, which otherwise is difficult to be understood; for here *Joshua* circumcised the people, that rite having been omitted in the young race during their peregrination in the wilderness: "And the LORD said unto *Joshua*, this day have I *rolled* away the reproach of *Egypt* from off you; wherefore the name of the place is called *Gilgal* unto this day."

TAB. VI.
P. 10.

View of the Kistvaen at Rowldrich from the East.



Stukeley del.

A. the Druid temple at a distance.

Commentators not apprehending this, run into many odd solutions, as not seeing a reason between *name* and *thing*. Some therefore suppose it so

call'd, because from hence *Joshua* conquer'd all his enemies *round about*, and the like. But the truth is, *Joshua* set the stones in a circular form, like the ancient temples; but placed no altar there, because they had no need to use it as a temple, where the tabernacle was present, therefore call'd it simply the *wheel*. So I doubt not but the altar which *Moses* built under mount *Sinai*, with twelve pillars, was a circular work, as our Druid temples, *Exod.* xxiv. 4. The like we ought to think of the altar which *Moses* built, and called *Jehovah Nissi*, which the heathen perverted into *Jupiter Nyseus*, or *Dionysus*, *Exod.* xvii. 15. The like must be affirm'd of all the patriarchal altars of *Abraham*, *Isaac*, and *Jacob*. These works of ours prove it, which are but little later in time, and made in imitation of theirs; and without a pun, or false logic, these matters may be said to prove each other in a circle; where 'tis absurd to demand any positive proof thro' extreme distance of times and places. I apprehend nothing further ought to be expected from us than to lay together circumstantial evidence, a concurrence of numerous and strong verisimilitudes; as is now the case with us concerning *Rowldrich*.

5. We very justly infer this is a temple of the Druids, from the measure it is built upon. In a letter from Mr. *Roger Gale* to me, dated from *Worcester*, Aug. 19, 1719, having been to visit this antiquity at my request, he tells me, the diameter of the circle is 35 yards. So the bishop of *London* writes, the distance at *Stonehenge* from the entrance of the area to the temple itself is 35 yards; so the diameter of *Stonehenge* is 35 yards. We suppose this is not measur'd with a mathematical exactness; but when we look into the comparative scale of *English* feet and cubits, we discern 60 cubits of the Druids is the measure sought for. The diameter of the outer circle of *Stonehenge*, and this circle at *Rowldrich*, are exactly equal.

I have repeated the table of the Druid cubits collated with our *English* feet, which will be of service to us throughout this work, [plate II.](#)

The circle itself is compos'd of stones of various shapes and dimensions, set pretty near together, as may best be seen by the drawings, TABLE [III](#), [IV](#). They are flattish, about 16 inches thick. Originally there seems to have been 60 in number, at present there are 22 standing, few exceeding 4 foot in height; but one in the very north point much higher than the rest, 7 foot high, 5½ broad. There was an entrance to it from the north-east, as is the case at *Stonehenge*. *Ralph Sheldon*, esquire, dug in the middle of the circle at *Rowldrich*, but found nothing.

6. Another argument of its being a Druid temple, is taken from the barrows all around it, according to the constant practice in these places. To the north-east is a great *tumulus* or barrow of a long form, which I suppose to have been of an arch-druid. Between it and our temple is a huge stone standing upright, called the *kingstone*; the stone is 8 foot high, 7 broad, which, together with the barrow, may be seen in TABLES [III](#), [V](#). but the barrow has had much dug away from it. 'Tis now above 60 foot in length, 20 in breadth, flattish at top.

I know not whether there were more stones standing originally about this barrow, or that this belong'd to some part of the administration of religious offices in the temple, as a single stone.

In the same plate may be seen another barrow, but circular, below the road to the left hand, on the side of the hill. Under it is a spring-head running eastward to *Long Compton*. This barrow has had stone-work at the east end of it. Upon this same heath eastward, in the way to *Banbury*, are many barrows of different shapes, within sight of *Rowldrich*; particularly, near a place call'd *Chapel* on the heath, is a large, flat, and circular *tumulus*, ditch'd about, with a small tump in the center: this is what I call a Druid's barrow; many such near *Stonehenge*, some whereof I opened; a small circular barrow a little way off it. There are on this heath too, many circular dish-like cavities, as near *Stonehenge*, we may call them barrows inverted.

Not far from the Druid's barrow I saw a square work, such as I call Druids' courts or houses. Such near *Stonehenge* and *Abury*. 'Tis a place 100 cubits square, double-ditch'd. The earth of the ditches is thrown inward between the ditches, so as to raise a terrace, going quite round. The ditches are too inconsiderable to be made for defence. Within are seemingly remains of stone walls. 'Tis within sight of the temple, and has a fine prospect all around, being seated on the highest part of the ridge. A little further is a small round barrow, with stone-work at the east end, like that before spoken of near *Rowldrich*; a dry stone wall or fence running quite over it, across the heath.

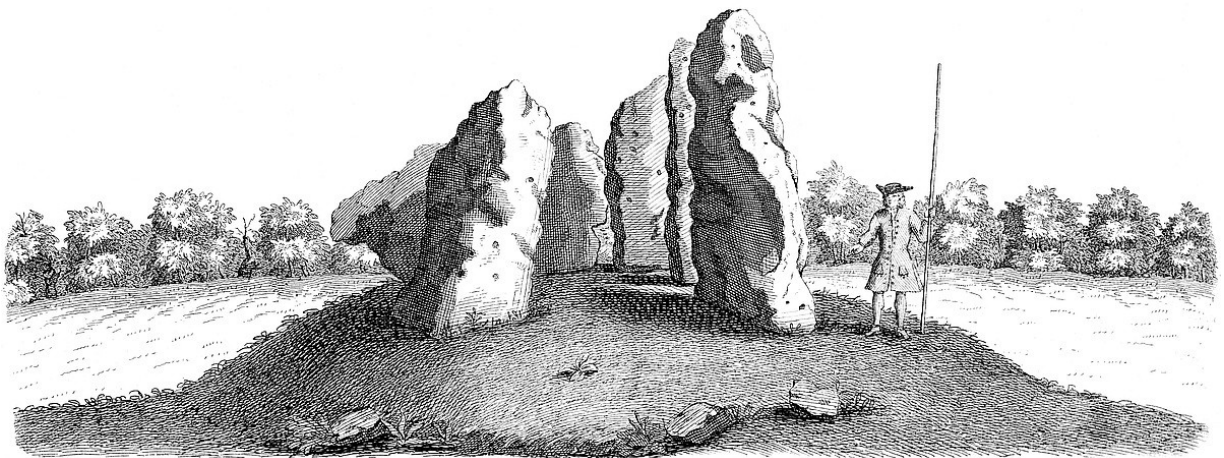
Return we nearer to the temple, and we see 300 paces directly east from it in the same field, a remarkable monument much taken notice of; 'tis what the old *Britons* call a *Kist vaen* or stone chest; I mean the *Welsh*, the descendants of those invaders from the continent, *Belgæ*, *Gauls* and

Cimbrians, who drove away the aboriginal inhabitants, that made the works we are treating of, still northward. Hence they gave them these names from appearances; as *Rowldrich*, the *wheel or circle of the Druids*; as *Stonehenge* they call'd *choir gaur*, the *giants' dance*; as our *saxon* ancestors call'd it *Stonehenge*, the *hanging-stones*, or *stone-gallows*. Every succession of inhabitants being still further remov'd from a true notion and knowledge of the things.

Our *Kist vaen* is represented in plates [VI.](#) and [VII.](#) One shews the foreside, the other the backside; so that there needs but little description of it. 'Tis compos'd of six stones, one broader for the back-part, two and two narrower for the sides, set square to the former; and above all, as a cover, a still larger. The opening is full west, to the temple, or *Rowldrich*. It stands on a round *tumulus*, and has a fine prospect south-westward down the valley, where the head of the river *Evenlode* runs. I persuade myself this was merely monumental, erected over the grave of some great person there buried; most probably the king of the country, when this temple was built. And if there was any use of the building, it might possibly be some way accommodated to some anniversary commemoration of the deceased, by feasts, games, exercises, or the like, as we read in the classic poets, who describe customs ancients than their own times. It is akin to that *Kist vaen* in *Cornwall*, which I have drawn in [plate XXXVII.](#)

TAB. VII.
P. 12.

View of the Kistvaen of Rowldrich from the Southwest.



Stukeley del.

V^{dr}. Gucht. Sculp.

Near the arch-druid's barrow, by that call'd the *Kingstone*, is a square plat, oblong, form'd on the turf. Hither, on a certain day of the year, the young men and maidens customarily meet, and make merry with cakes and ale. And this seems to be the remain of the very ancient festival here celebrated in memory of the interr'd, for whom the long barrow and temple were made. This was the sepulture of the arch-druid founder. At *Enston*, a little way off, between *Neat Enston* and *Fulwell*, by the side of a bank or *tumulus*, stands a great stone, with other smaller. 'Tis half a mile south-west of *Enston* church. A famous barrow at *Lineham*, by the banks of the *Evenlode*.

7. Mr. *Camden* writes further concerning our antiquity, that "the country people have a fond tradition, that they were once men, turn'd into stones. The highest of all, which lies out of the ring, they call the *king*. Five larger stones, which are at some distance from the circle, set close together, they pretend were knights, the ring were common soldiers." This story the country people, for some miles round, are very fond of, and take it very ill if any one doubts of it; nay, they are in danger of being stoned for their unbelief. They have likewise rhymes and sayings relating thereto. Suchlike reports are to be met with in other like works, our Druid temples. They savour of the most ancient and heroic times. Like *Perseus*, turning men into stones; like *Cadmus*, producing men from serpents' teeth; like *Deucalion*, by throwing stones over his head, and such like, which we shall have occasion to mention again, [chap. XIV.](#)

8. We may very reasonably affirm, that this temple was built here, on account of this long barrow. And very often in ancient times temples owe their foundation to sepulchres, as well as now. *Clemens Alexandrinus* in *Protrept.* and *Eusebius*, both allow it; and it is largely treated of in *Schedius* and other authors; 'tis a common thing among these works of our Druids, and an argument that this is a work of theirs. I shall only make two observations therefrom. 1. That it proceeded from a strong notion in antiquity of a future state, and that in respect of their bodies as well as souls; for the temples are thought prophylactic, and have a power of protecting and preserving the remains of the dead. 2. That it was the occasion of consecrating and idolizing of dead heroes, the first species of idolatry; for they by degrees advanc'd them into those deities of which

these figures were symbols, whereof we shall meet with instances in the progress of this work.

Thus we pronounce *Rowldrich* a Druid temple, from a concurrence of all the appearances to be expected in the case; from its round form, situation on high ground, near springs, on an extended heath, from the stones taken from the surface of the ground, from the name, from the measure it is built on, from the wear of the weather, from the barrows of various kinds about it, from ancient reports, from its apparent conformity to those patriarchal temples mentioned in scripture. This is the demonstration to be expected in such antiquities. Nor shall I spend time in examining the notion of its belonging to *Rollo* the *Dane*, and the like. Mr. *Camden* had too much judgment to mention it. 'Tis confuted in the annotations to *Britannia*, and in *Selden's* notes on *Drayton's Polyolbion*, page 224. And let this suffice for what I can say upon this curious and ancient monument: the first kind, and most common of the Druid temples, a plain circle: of which there are innumerable all over the *Britannick* isles; being the original form of all temples, 'till the Mosaick tabernacle.

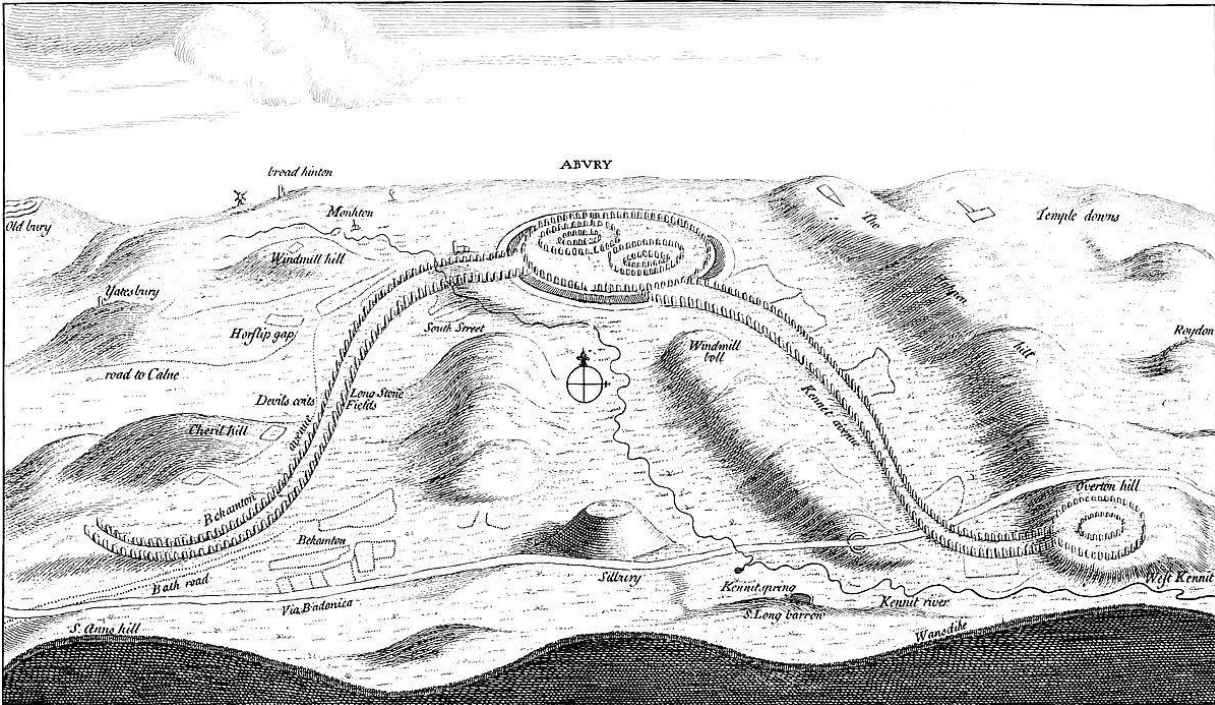
CHAP. III.

Abury, the most extraordinary work in the world, being a serpentine temple, or of the second kind, described. Now was the critical time of saving the memory of it. Account of the place. Natural history. The gray weathers, call'd Sarsens, a phœnician word, meaning a rock. Whence the name of the city of Tyre. Their weight and texture. The wear of the weather, more apparent here, than at Stonehenge, an argument of its being a much older work.

WHEN we contemplate the elegance of this country of *Wiltshire*, and the great works of antiquity therein, we may be persuaded, that the two atlantic islands, and the islands of the blessed, which *Plato* and other ancient writers mention, were those *in reality* of *Britain* and *Ireland*. They who first took possession of this country, thought it worthy of their care, and built those noble works therein, which have been the admiration of all ages. *Stonehenge* we have endeavoured to describe; and we are not more surpriz'd at the extraordinary magnitude of this work of *Abury*, than that it should have escap'd the observation of the curious: a place in the direct *Bath*-road from *London*. Passing from *Marlborough* hither, 'tis the common topic of amusement for travellers, to observe the gray weathers on *Marlborough* downs, which are the same kind of stones as this of our antiquity, lying dispers'd, on the surface of the ground, as nature originally laid them. When we come to this village, we see the largest of those stones in great numbers, set upright in the earth, in circles, in parallel lines and other regular figures, and a great part inclos'd in a vast circular ditch, of above 1000 foot diameter. And what will further excite one's curiosity, the *vallum* or earth, which is of solid chalk, dug out of that ditch, thrown on the outside; quite contrary to the nature of castles and fortifications. The ditch alone, which is wide and deep, is a very great labour, and the rampart very high, and makes the appearance of a huge amphitheatre, for an innumerable company of spectators; but cannot possibly be design'd for offence or

defence. This is twice passed by all the travellers: and its oddness would arrest one's attention, if the stones escap'd it.

TAB. VIII.
P. 14. *A Scenographic view of the Druid temple of ABURY in north Wiltshire, as in its original.*



W. Stukeley Delin.

*Præhonorabili Dño. Dño. Philippo Dño. Hardwick, summo magnæ
Brittanniæ Cancellario tabulam. L.M.D. W. Stukeley.*

The mighty carcase of *Stonehenge* draws great numbers of people, out of their way every day, as to see a sight: and it has exercis'd the pens of the learned to account for it. But *Abury* a much greater work and more extensive design, by I know not what unkind fate, was altogether overlooked, and in the utmost danger of perishing, thro' the humor of the country people, but of late taken up, of demolishing the stones. Mr. *Camden* the great light of *British* antiquities, took *Kennet* avenue to be plain rocks, and that the village of *Rockley* took its name from them. It is strange that two parallel lines of great stones, set at equal distance and intervals, for a mile together, should be taken for rocks in their natural site. As for the town of *Rockley*, 'tis four miles off, has nothing to do with this antiquity, tho' probably had its name from the adjacent gray weathers, whence our stones were drawn.

Dr. *Holland*, his annotator, writes thus of it. “Within one mile of *Selbury*, (by which he means *Silbury-hill*) is *Abury*, an uplandish village, built in an old camp, as it seemeth, but of no large compass. It is environed with a fair trench, and hath four gates, in two of which stand huge stones, as jambs; but so rude, that they seem rather natural than artificial: of which sort, there are some other, in the said village.” In the time, when this was wrote, all the circles of these great stones, within the village of *Abury*, were nearly perfect; two of about 150 foot diameter, two of 300 foot diameter, and the great one of above 1000: which merited a higher notice. The largeness of the circles hinder’d an incurious spectator from discerning their purpose.

I persuade my self the intelligent reader, by casting his eye over the plate in the [frontispiece](#), being the village of *Abury*, will see enough to excite a vast idea of the place: more so, if they conceive that the two avenues of *Kennet* and *Bekampton*, going off at the bottom, to the right and the left, extend themselves each, above a mile from the town.

Dr. *Childrey* likewise, in his *Britannia Baconica*, takes these stones about *Kennet* to be mere rocks. Thus if our minds are not properly dispos’d for these inquiries, or we believe nothing great in art, preceded the times of the *Romans*, we may run into *Munster*’s error, in *cosmograph.* iii. 49. who believes, plain *celtic* urns dug up in *Poland*, to be the work of nature. *Harrington* in his notes on *Orlando furioso* speaks likewise of *Abury*.

Just before I visited this place, to endeavour at preserving the memory of it, the inhabitants were fallen into the custom of demolishing the stones, chiefly out of covetousness of the little *area* of ground, each stood on. First they dug great pits in the earth, and buried them. The expence of digging the grave, was more than 30 years purchase of the spot they possess’d, when standing. After this, they found out the knack of burning them; which has made most miserable havock of this famous temple. One *Tom Robinson* the *Herostratus* of *Abury*, is particularly eminent for this kind of execution, and he very much glories in it. The method is, to dig a pit by the side of the stone, till it falls down, then to burn many loads of straw under it. They draw lines of water along it when heated, and then with smart strokes of a great sledge hammer, its prodigious bulk is divided into many lesser parts. But this *Atto de fe* commonly costs thirty shillings in fire and labour, sometimes twice as much. They own too ’tis excessive hard work; for these stones are often 18 foot long, 13 broad, and 6 thick; that their weight

crushes the stones in pieces, which they lay under them to make them lie hollow for burning; and for this purpose they raise them with timbers of 20 foot long, and more, by the help of twenty men; but often the timbers were rent in pieces.

They have sometimes us'd of these stones for building houses; but say, they may have them cheaper, in more manageable pieces, from the gray weathers. One of these stones will build an ordinary house; yet the stone being a kind of marble, or rather granite, is always moist and dewy in winter, which proves damp and unwholsom, and rots the furniture. The custom of thus destroying them is so late, that I could easily trace the *obit* of every stone; who did it, for what purpose, and when, and by what method, what house or wall was built out of it, and the like. Every year that I frequented this country, I found several of them wanting; but the places very apparent whence they were taken. So that I was well able, as then, to make a perfect ground-plot of the whole, and all its parts. This is now twenty years ago. 'Tis to be fear'd, that had it been deferr'd 'till this time, it would have been impossible. And this stupendous fabric, which for some thousands of years had brav'd the continual assaults of weather, and by the nature of it, when left to itself, like the pyramids of *Egypt*, would have lasted as long as the globe, must have fallen a sacrifice to the wretched ignorance and avarice of a little village unluckily plac'd within it; and the curiosity of the thing would have been irretrievable.

Such is the modern history of *Abury*, which I thought proper to premise, to prepare the mind of the reader. All this was done in my original memoirs, which I wrote on the spot, very largely. Tho' it was necessary for me then to do it, in order to get a thorough intelligence of the work; yet I shall commit nothing more to the press, than what I judge absolutely necessary to illustrate it.

In regard to the natural history of the stones, 'tis the same as that of *Stonehenge*, which is compos'd of the very same stones, fetch'd from the same *Marlborough-downs*, where they lie on the surface of the ground in great plenty, of all dimensions. This was the occasion, why the Druids took the opportunity of building these immense works in this country. The people call these great stones, *sarsens*; and 'tis a proverb here, *as hard as a sarsen*; a mere *phœnician* word, continued here from the first times, signifying a *rock*. The very name of *Tyre* is hence derived, of which largely

and learnedly *Bochart, Canaan* II. 10. This whole country, hereabouts, is a solid body of chalk, cover'd with a most delicate turf. As this chalky matter harden'd at creation, it spew'd out the most solid body of the stones, of greater specific gravity than itself; and assisted by the centrifuge power, owing to the rotation of the globe upon its axis, threw them upon its surface, where they now lie. This is my opinion concerning this appearance, which I often attentively consider'd. 'Tis worth while for a curious observer to go toward the northern end of that great ridge of hills overlooking *Abury* from the east, call'd the *Hakpen*, an oriental name too, that has continued to it from *Druid* times. A little to the right hand of the road coming from *Marlborough* to *Abury*, where are three pretty barrows, and another dish-like barrow, if we look downwards to the side of the hill toward *Abury*, we discern many long and straight ridges of natural stone, the same as the gray weathers, as it were emerging out of the chalky surface. They are often cross'd by others in straight lines, almost at right angles. For hereabouts, it seems, that the chalk contracting itself, and growing closer together, as it hardened, thrust the lapidescent matter into these fissures. 'Tis a very pretty appearance. This is near that part of the *downs* call'd *Temple-downs*. There are no quarries, properly speaking, nearer *Abury* than *Swindon*, and those have not long been dug. In *Caln* they dig up a paltry kind of stone, fit for nothing but mending the highways. But our gray weather stone is of so hard a texture, that Mr. *Ayloff* of *Wooton-basset* hewed one of them to make a rape-mill stone, and employ'd twenty yoke of oxen to carry it off. Yet so great was its weight, that it repeatedly broke all his tackle in pieces, and he was forc'd to leave it. It may be said of many one of our gray weathers,

Est moles nativa, loco res nomina fecit.

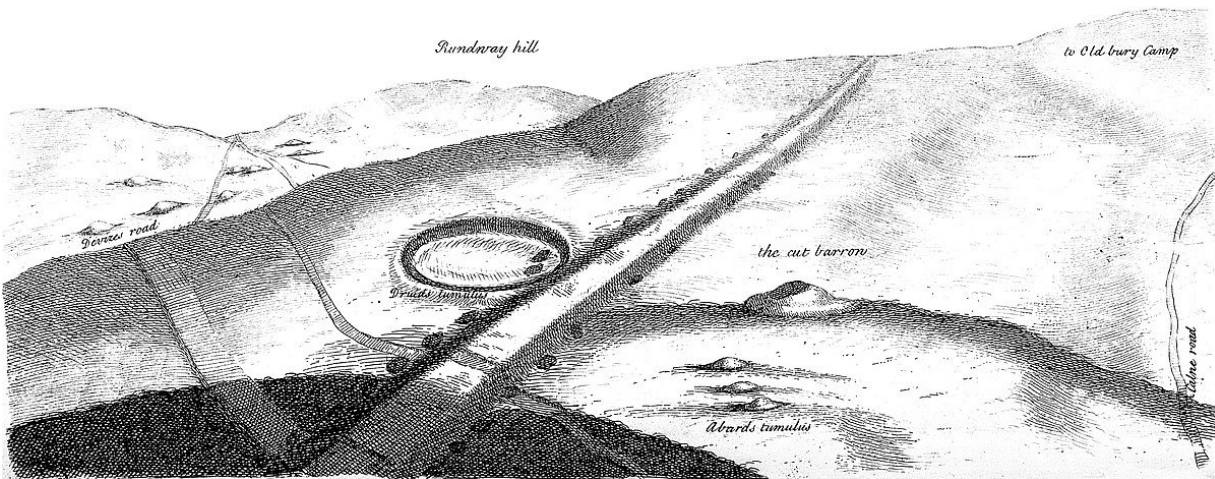
Appellant saxum, pars bona montis ea est.

Ovid.

Lord *Pembroke* caus'd several of these stones to be dug under, and found them loose, and detach'd. My lord computed the general weight of our stones at above fifty tun, and that it required an hundred yoke of oxen to draw one. Dr. *Stephen Hales* makes the larger kind of them to be seventy tun. Mr. *Edward Llwyd*, in his account of the natural history of *Wales*, *Phil. Trans. abridg'd*, Vol. V. 2. p. 118. writes, he found a strange appearance of great stones, and loose fragments of rocks on the surface of the earth, not only on wide plains, but on the tops too of the highest mountains. So the

moor stones on the wastes and hill-tops of *Cornwall, Derbyshire, Devonshire, Yorkshire*, and other places, of a harder nature than these, and much the same as the *Egyptian granite*.

TAB. IX.
P. 16. *The Roman road leading from Bekampton to Hedington July 18. 1723.*



Stukeley del.

v^{dr}. Gucht. Sculp.

As to the internal texture of this stone, when broke, it looks whitish like marble. It would bear a pretty good polish, but for a large quantity of bluish granules of sand, which are soft, and give it a grayish or speckled colour, when smooth'd by an engine. It consists, as all other stones, of a mixture of divers substances, united by lapidescent juices, in a sufficient tract of time. Sometimes in one stone shall be two or three colours, sometimes bits of flints kneaded amongst the rest. In one stone fetch'd from *Bekampton* avenue, near *Longstone barrow* (as commonly call'd) and which was broken and made into a wall, at the little alehouse above *Bekampton*, in the *Devizes* road, I saw several bones, plainly animal, part of the composition of the stone. This I admir'd very much, and concluded it to be antediluvian. The stone in general is shining, close, and hard, little inferior to common marble; yet the effect which time and weather has had upon it, far beyond what is visible at *Stonehenge*, must necessarily make us conclude the work to be many hundred years older in date. In some places I could thrust my

cane, a yard long, up to the handle, in holes and cavities worn through by age, which must needs bespeak some thousands of years continuance.

CHAP. IV.

The figure of the temple of Abury is a circle and snake. Hakpen, another oriental word still preserved here, meaning the serpent's head. The chorography of Abury. A description of the great circle of stones 1400 foot in diameter. Of the ditch inclosing it. The vallum form'd on the outside, like an amphitheater to the place. This represents the circle in the hieroglyphic figure. Of the measures, all referring to the ancient eastern cubit which the Druids us'd.

THE situation of *Abury* is finely chose for the purpose it was destin'd to, being the more elevated part of a plain, from whence there is an almost imperceptible descent every way. But as the religious work in *Abury*, tho' great in itself, is but a part of the whole, (the avenues stretching above a mile from it each way,) the situation of the intire design is likewise projected with great judgment, in a kind of large, separate plain, four or five miles in diameter. Into this you descend on all sides from higher ground. The country north of *Abury*, about *Berwick-basset* and *Broad Hinton*, is very high, tho' not appearing so to be, and much above the level of *Abury* town. In a field of *Broad Hinton* the water runs two ways, into the *Thames* and *Severn*, and they pretend 'tis the highest ground in *England*. 'Tis indeed part of that very great ridge of hills, coming from *Somersetshire*, and going hence north-eastward, to the *white-horse hill*. So that the ground northward and westward, tho' not much appearing so, is still very high, a cliff descending that way; and whilst guarded to the east by the *Hakpen*, yet it may be called like the *thessalian*, of the same name,

——*Zephyris agitata Tempe.* Hor.

The whole temple of *Abury* may be consider'd as a picture, and it really is so. Therefore the founders wisely contriv'd, that a spectator should have an advantageous prospect of it, as he approach'd within view. To give the reader at once a foreknowledge of this great and wonderful work, and the magnificence of the plan upon which it is built, I have design'd it

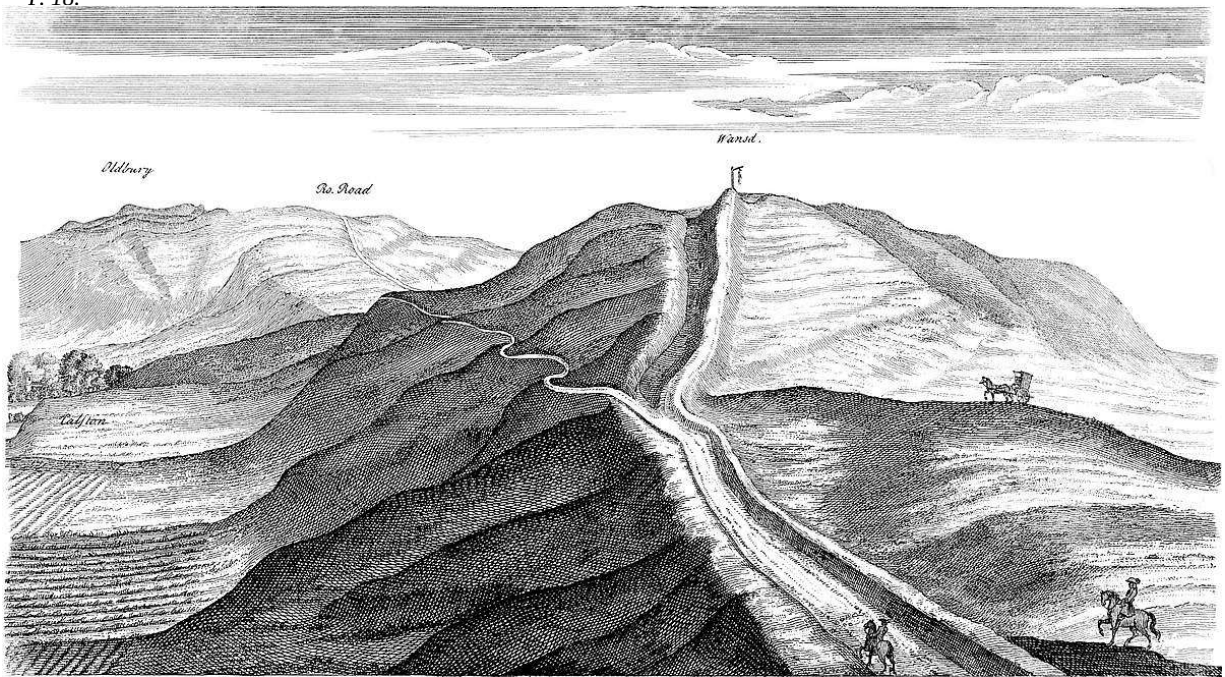
scenographically in [TABLE VIII](#), the eye being somewhat more elevated than on the neighbouring hill of *Wansdike*, which is its proper point of sight, being south from it.

When I frequented this place, as I did for some years together, to take an exact account of it, staying a fortnight at a time, I found out the entire work by degrees. The second time I was here, an avenue was a new amusement. The third year another. So that at length I discover'd the mystery of it, properly speaking; which was, that the whole figure represented a snake transmitted thro' a circle; this is an hieroglyphic or symbol of highest note and antiquity.

In order to put this design in execution, the founders well studied their ground; and, to make their representation more natural, they artfully carry'd it over a variety of elevations and depressures, which, with the curvature of the avenues, produces sufficiently the desired effect. To make it still more elegant and picture-like, the head of the snake is carried up the southern promontory of the *Hakpen* hill, towards the village of *West Kennet*; nay, the very name of the hill is deriv'd from this circumstance, meaning the head of the snake; of which we may well say with *Lucan*, *lib. IV*.

*Hinc ævi veteris custos, famosa vetustas
Miratrixque sui signavit nomine terras,
Sed majora dedit cognomina collibus istis.*

Again, the tail of the snake is conducted to the descending valley below *Bekamton*.



Stukeley d.

*Prospect of the Roman Road & Wansdike Just above Calston May 20. 1724.
This demonstrates that Wansdike was made before the Roman Road.*

Thus our antiquity divides itself into three great parts, which will be our rule in describing the work. The circle at *Abury*, the fore-part of the snake, leading towards *Kennet*, which I call *Kennet-avenue*; the hinder part of the snake, leading towards *Bekampton*, which I call *Bekampton-avenue*; for they may well be look'd on as avenues to the great temple at *Abury*, which part must be more eminently call'd the temple.

This town is wrote *Aubury*, *Avebury*, *Avesbury*, sometimes *Albury*: 'tis hard to say which is the true. The former three names may have their origin from the brook running by, *au*, *aux*, water, *awy* in *welsh*; the old *german* *aha*. The latter points to *Aldbury*, or *old work*, regarding its situation within the *vallum*. Nor is it worth while to dwell on its etymology; the *saxon* name is a thing of so low a date, in comparison of what we are writing upon, that we expect no great use from it; unless *Albury* has regard to *al*, *hal*, *healle*, *gothicè* $\text{A} \lambda h$ a temple or great building. There are two heads of the river *Kennet* rising near it: one from a little north-west of *Abury*, at *Monkton*, runs southward to *Silbury-hill*; this affords but little water, except in wet seasons. At *Silbury-hill* it joins the *Swallow* head, or true fountain of the *Kennet*, which the country people call by the old name, *Cunnet*; and it is not

a little famous among them. This is a plentiful spring. It descends between *east* and *west Kennet*, by the temple on *Overton-hill*, which is properly the head of the snake: it passes by *Overton*, and so to *Marlborough*, the *roman Cunetio*, which has its name from the river.

To conduct the reader the better through this great work, I must remind him of what I wrote in the account of *Stonehenge*, p. 11, concerning the Druid cubit or measure, by which they erected all their structures, that 'tis 20 inches and four fifths of the *english* standard. For this purpose I have repeated the [plate](#) wherein the *english* foot and Druid cubit is compar'd to any lengths, which must necessarily accompany us in the description. A ready way of having the analogism between our feet and the cubits is this, 3 foot 5 inches and a half makes 2 cubits. A staff of 10 foot, 4 inches, and a little more than half an inch, becomes the measuring-reed of these ancient philosophers, being 6 cubits, when they laid out the ground-plot of these temples; where we now are to pursue the track of their footsteps which so many ages have pass'd over.

The whole of this temple, wherein the town of *Abury* is included I have laid down in [TABLE I](#), the frontispiece, done from innumerable mensurations, by which means I fully learn'd the scheme and purport of the founders. 'Tis comprehended within a circular ditch or trench above 1400 foot in diameter, which makes 800 cubits, being two *stadia* of the ancients. A *radius* of 400 cubits, one *stadium*, struck the inner periphery of the ditch, in the turf. This is done with a sufficient, tho' not a mathematical exactness. They were not careful in this great measure, where preciseness would have no effect, seeing the whole circle cannot be taken in by the eye on the same level. The ditch is near 80 foot, which is 45 cubits broad, very deep, like the foss that encompasses an old castle. The great quantity of solid chalk dug out of it, is thrown on the outside, where it forms a mighty *vallum*, an amphitheatrical terrace, which hides the sight of the town as we come near it, and affords a good shelter from the winds. 'Tis of the same breadth at bottom as the ditch at top. The compass of this, on the outside, Mr. *Roger Gale* and I measured about 4800 feet, *August 16, 1721*.

The included *area* of the temple containing about 22 acres, I observ'd to have a gentle descent, from the meridian line of it to the east, and to the west: carrying the rain off both ways. The north point is the highest part of the whole. About 35 feet or 20 cubits within the verge of this circular ditch,

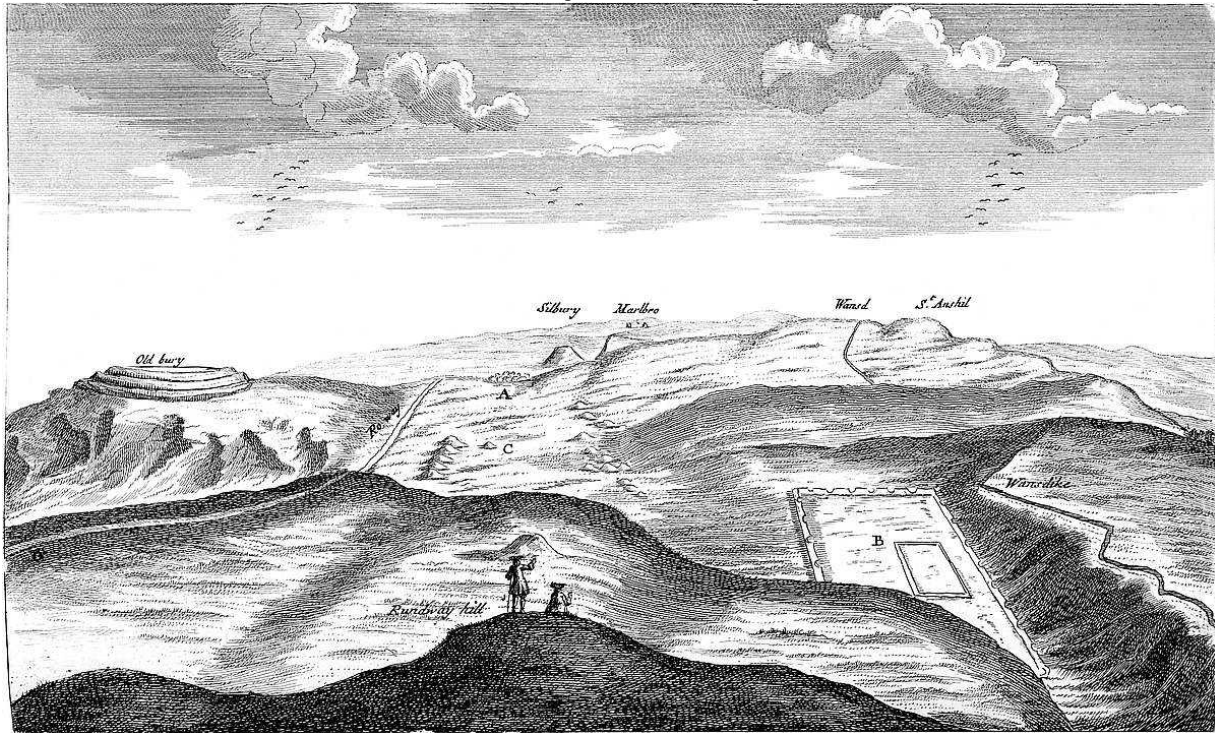
is a great circle of *great* stones. The epithet may well be redoubled. These great masses are really astonishing, if we contemplate a single stone, and consider how it was brought hither, and set upright in the ground, where it has stood, I doubt not, 3 or 4 thousand years. But how is the wonder heightened, when we see the number one hundred, which composes this mighty circle of 1300 foot diameter! The stones of this circle, tho' unhewn, are generally about 15, 16, or 17 foot high, and near as much in breadth. About 43 *English* feet, measures regularly from the center of one stone, to the center of the other. Look into the scale and we discern these measures of the height and breadth of the stones. 17 feet is ten cubits; 43 feet the central distance from stone to stone, is 25 cubits of the Druids; so that the interval between is 15 cubits. Tho' this be the general and stated measure, which was proposed by the founders, where the stones suited, and of the largest dimensions, yet we must understand this, as in all their works, with some latitude. The ancients studied a certain greatness: to produce an effect, not by a servile exactness no way discernible in great works, but in securing the general beauty; especially we must affirm this of our Druids, who had to do with these unshapely masses, and where religion forbade them applying a tool. But the purpose they proposed, was to make the breadth of the stone to the interval, to be as two to three. They very wisely judg'd that in such materials, where the scantlings could not be exact, the proportions must still be adjusted agreeable to their diversities, and this both in respect of the particulars, and of the general distance to be filled up. These stones were all fetched from the surface of the downs. They took the most shapely, and of largest dimensions first; but when 'twas necessary to make use of lesser stones, they set them closer together, and so proportion'd the solid and the vacuity, as gave symmetry in appearance, and a regularity to the whole.

Therefore tho' 25 cubits be the common measure of the interval between center and center of the largest stones of this circle, yet this is not always the rule; for if we measure the two stones west of the north entrance (which entrance was made for the convenience of the town, by throwing the earth of the *vallum* into it again) you will find it to be about 27 feet. This is but 16 of the Druid cubits, and here us'd, because these stones are but of moderate bulk. The next intervals are 43 feet as usual, being of the larger kind of stones, so plac'd 25 cubits central distance, and then they proceed. This is in that call'd pasture IIII. in the ground plot.

I have always been at first in some perplexity in measuring and adjusting these works of the Druids, and they seem'd magical, 'till I became master of their purpose. Therefore to make it very plain to the reader, I shall repeat what I have deliver'd in other words, concerning this great circle, which is a general rule for all others.

TAB. XI.
P. 20.

Rundway hill 18 Iuly, 1723.



Stukeley del.

A. Bekhampton. B. the Model of a Camp. C. Celtic barrows. D. the way to Verlucio.

As to the construction of this circle, by diligent observation, I found this to be the art of the Druids. 'Tis not to be thought, they would be at the trouble of bringing so many mountains together, of placing them in a regular form, without seeking how to produce the best effect therein, and thus they obtain'd their purpose. As it was necessary, the stones should be rude and native, untouch'd of tool, and that it was impossible to procure them of the dimensions exactly; they consider'd that the beauty in their appearance must be owing to their conformity, as near as may be, and to the proportion between the solid and the void interval. This *ratio* with judgment they chose to be as two to three: two parts the breadth of the stone, the interval three. And this they accommodated to the whole circle. So that they

first brought 100 of their choicest stones together, and laid them in the destin'd circle, at the intended distances, according to that proportion: and then raised them into their respective places.

Hence I find, that where the stones are 15, 16, or 17 feet high above ground, and as much broad, as for the most part they are, about 43 *English* feet measures, from the center of one stone to the center of another; there the square of the solid or stone is ten cubits, the void or interval is 15: the whole central distance 25. Therefore the proportion of the solid to the void is as two to three.

But before I found out this key to the work, I met with a good deal of difficulty, because the central intervals and the voids were different, for they proportion'd these to the breadths of the stones, as above. Still they chose whole numbers of cubits for that proportion; for instance, in the stones at the northern and modern entrance, where they are but of a moderate bulk, you measure but about 27 feet central distance. This is 16 cubits.

Further I observ'd, they took care to make a reasonable gradation, between greater and lesser stones, not to set a great stone and a little one near one another, but make a gradual declension; by this means in the whole, the eye finds no difference. The proportion of solid and void being the same, the whole circle appears similar and altogether pleasing.

I thought it adviseable to give a [plate](#) of a very small part of this magnificent circle, being 3 stones now standing *in situ*. 'Tis a most august sight, and whence we may learn somewhat of the appearance of the whole.

I observ'd further, that as these stones generally have a rough and a smoother side; they took care to place the most sightly side of the stone inwards, toward the included *area*. For this vast circle of stones is to be understood, as the portico inclosing the temple properly. Between this circle and the ditch is an esplanade or circular walk quite round, which was extraordinary pretty when in its perfection. It was originally 25 cubits broad, equal to the central distances of the stones. The quickset hedges now on the place, sometimes take the range of the stones, sometimes are set on the verge of the ditch. Further I observ'd they set the largest and handsomest stones in the more conspicuous part of the temple, which is that southward, and about the two entrances of the avenues.

Out of this noble circle of stones 100 in number, there was left in the year 1722, when I began to write, above 40 still visible: whereof 17 were standing, 27 thrown down or reclining. Ten of the remainder all contiguous, were at once destroy'd by *Tom Robinson*, anno 1700, and their places perfectly levelled, for the sake of the pasturage. In the north entrance of the town one of the stones, of a most enormous bulk, fell down, and broke in the fall.

——*nec ipso*
monte minor procumbit.—— Virg.

It measured full 22 feet long. *Reuben Horsall*, clerk of the parish, a sensible man and lover of antiquity, remembers it standing. And when my late lord *Winchelsea* (*Heneage*) was here with me, we saw three wooden wedges driven into it, in order to break it in pieces.

In the great [frontispiece plate](#), I have noted many dates of years, when such and such stones were demolished, and took down the particulars of all: some are still left buried in the pastures, some in gardens. I was apt to leave this wish behind;

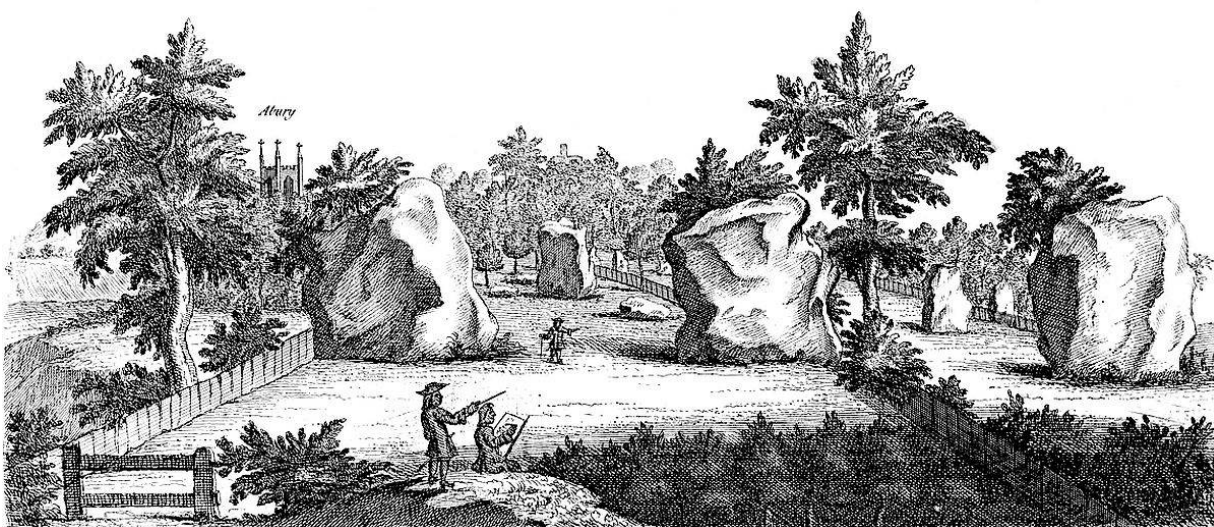
Pro molli viola, pro purpureo narcisso
Carduus, & spinis surgat paliurus acutis! Virg.

The seat of many is visible by the remaining hollow; of others by a hill above the interr'd. Of many then lately carry'd off the places were notorious, by nettles and weeds growing up, and no doubt many are gone since I left the place. But the ground-plot representing the true state of the town and temple, when I frequented it, I spare the reader's patience in being too particular about it.

When this mighty colonnade of 100 of these stones was in perfection, there must have been a most agreeable circular walk, between them and the ditch; and it's scarce possible for us to form a notion of the grand and beautiful appearance it must then have made.

TAB. XII.
P. 22.

*A peice of the great circle, or
A View at the South Entrance into the temple at Abury Aug. 1722.*



Stukeley delin.

CHAP. V.

Of the two great temples included in the area of the great circle of stones. Each consists of two concentrick circles. One has a central obelisc or ambre, a very high stone in the center. The Egyptians called an obelisc an ambre. The other temple has a cove in the center, compos'd of three stones of a stupendous bulk, set in a nich-like figure. A short history of the destroyers of this noble work, but a very few years ago.

THE great circle of stones last described, together with the ditch and rampart inclosing all, may be esteemed as the *præcinctus* of the temple, not properly the temple; but including the area thereof. There are strictly within this great compass, two temples, of like form and dimensions: each temple consists of two concentric circles. The line that connects their centers, runs from north-west to south-east: which line passes thro' the center of the whole area. The outer circles of them consist each of 30 stones of like dimensions with those of the outer circle, and at like intervals. The inner circles of both consist each of 12 stones, of the same size and distances. The geometry therefore of them, when laid down on paper, shews, the inner circle must be 100 cubits in diameter, the outer 240.

The centers of these two double circles are 300 cubits asunder. Their circumferences or outward circles are 50 cubits asunder, in the nearest part. By which means they least embarrass each other, and leave the freest space about 'em, within the great circular portico (as we may call it) inclosing the whole; which we described in the former chapter. There is no other difference between these two temples (properly) which I could discover, save that one, the southermost, has a central obelisc, which was the *kibla*, whereto they turn'd their faces, in the religious offices there performed: the other has that immense work in the center, which the old *Britons* call a cove: consisting of three stones plac'd with an obtuse angle toward each other, and as it were, upon an ark of a circle, like the great half-round at the east end of some old cathedrals: or like the upper end of the cell at

Stonehenge; being of the same use and intent, the *adytum* of this temple. This I have often times admir'd and been astonish'd at its extravagant magnitude and majesty. It stands in the yard belonging to the inn. King *Charles II.* in his progress this way, rode into the yard, on purpose to view it.

This cove of the northern temple was undoubtedly the *kibla* thereof. It opens pretty exactly north-east, as at *Stonehenge*. It measures 34 foot, from the edge of the outer jambs; 20 cubits: and half as much in depth. *Varro V. divinorum*, writes, altars were of old call'd *ansæ*. So *Macrobius saturn. II. 11.* It seems that they mean this figure before us. And I suppose 'tis what *Schedius* means; *de dis germ. c. 25.* speaking of altars among the old *germans* set in a triangle, he says, the Druids understood a mystery thereby. Perhaps they intended it for a nich-like hemispherical figure, in some sort to represent the heavens. *Sex. Pompeius* writes, the ancients called the heavens, *cove*. The altar properly lay upon the ground before this superb nich. That, no doubt, was carry'd off long ago, as not being fix'd in the earth, and one of the wings is gone too, the northern. It fell down 1713, as marked in the ground-plot.

Fit sonus ingenti concussa est pondere tellus. Virg.

They told me it was full seven yards long, of the same shape as its opposite, tall and narrow. We measur'd this 17 foot above ground, 10 whole cubits; 7 foot broad, two and a half thick. These were the *ansæ* or wings of this noble ellipsis. That on the back, or in the middle, is much broader, being 15 foot, as many high, 4 thick; but a great piece of one side of it has been broke off by decay of the stone. We cannot conceive any thing bolder, than the idea of those people that entertain'd a design of setting up these stones. The vulgar call them the *devil's brand-irons*, from their extravagant bulk, and chimney-like form. These coves, as *Maundrel* says of the *turkish kiblas*, shew the Druids' aversion to idolatry, expressing the reality of the divine presence there, and at the same time its invisibility; no doubt a most ancient and oriental custom.

Of the exterior circle of this northern temple but three stones are now left standing, six more lying on the ground, one whereof in the street by the inn-gate. People yet alive remember several standing in the middle of the street;

they were burnt for building, *anno* 1711. That at the corner of the lane, going to the north gate of the town, not many years since lying on the ground, was us'd as a stall to lay fish on, when they had a kind of market here. The ruin of the rest is noted in the ground-plot, and so of the others. But they told us, that about a dozen years ago both circles were standing, and almost entire. Those in the closes behind the inn, were taken up a year ago; (this was when I first went thither, about 1718,) farmer *Green* chiefly demolished them to build his house and walls at *Bekamton*. Of the southern temple several stones were destroy'd by farmer *John Fowler*, twelve years ago; he own'd to us that he burnt five of them; but fourteen are still left, whereof about half standing. Some lie along in the pastures, two let into the ground under a barn, others under the houses. One lies above ground under the corner of a house, over-against the inn. One buried under the earth in a little garden. The cavities left by some more are visible, in the places whereof ash-trees are set. All those in the pastures were standing within memory.

The central obelisk of this temple is of a circular form at base, of a vast bulk, 21 feet long, and 8 feet 9 inches diameter; when standing, higher than the rest. This is what the scripture calls a pillar, or standing image, *Levit.* xxvi. 1. These works, erected in the land of *Canaan* by the same people, the *Phœnicians*, as erected ours, were ordered to be demolished by the *Israelites*, because at that time perverted to idolatry. All the stones, our whole temple, were called *ambres*, even by our *phœnician* founders; but this particularly. The *Egyptians* by that name call'd their obelisks; which *Kircher* did not rightly understand, interpreting it to be sacred books; but meaning *petræ ambrosiæ*, *main ambres in celtic*, *anointed, consecrated stone*; *Manah*, the name of a great stone of this sort which the *Arabians* worshipped. They were called likewise, *gabal*, and the present word *kibla* or *kebla* comes from it, but in a larger sense. *Elagabalus* is hence deriv'd after they turn'd these *kiblas* into real deities. It means the *god obelisc*; and hence our *english* words, *gable end* of a house, *javelin* or *roman pile*, and *gaveloc* a sharp iron bar.



Stukeley del.

A. Abury Steeple. B. the cove. C. Windmill hill.

Exactly in the southern end of the line that connects the two centers of these temples, viz. in that pasture mark'd IX. in our ground-plot, is an odd stone standing, not of great bulk. It has a hole wrought in it, and probably was design'd to fasten the victim, in order for slaying it. This I call the *ring-stone*. From this we may infer the like use of that stone at *Stonehenge*, in the avenue near the entrance into the area of the temple. I spoke of it under the name of *crwm leche*, p. 33. It has a like hole in it.

These two temples were all that was standing originally in the great area, within the circular colonnade. Very probably it was the most magnificent patriarchal temple in the world. Now a whole village of about thirty houses is built within it. This area would hold an immense number of people at their panegyres and public festivals; and when the *vallum* all around was cover'd with spectators, it form'd a most noble amphitheater, and had an appearance extremely august, during the administration of religious offices.

—ter denas curia vaccas
Accipit, & largo sparsa cruore madet.

Ovid. fast. IV.

Each of these temples is four times as big as *Stonehenge*.

About 1694, *Walter Stretch*, father of one of the present inhabitants, found out the way of demolishing these stones by fire. He exercis'd this at first on one of the stones standing in the street before the inn, belonging to the outer circle of the southern temple. That one stone, containing 20 loads, built the dining-room end of the inn. Since then *Tom Robinson*, another *Herostratus* of the place, made cruel havock among them. He own'd to us, that two of them cost eight pounds in the execution. Farmer *Green* ruin'd many of the southern temple to build his houses and walls at *Bekamton*. Since then many others have occasionally practis'd the sacrilegious method, and most of the houses, walls, and outhouses in the town are raised from these materials. Sir *Robert Holford* resented this destruction of them; and *Reuben Horsall*, parish-clerk, had a due veneration for these sacred remains, and assisted me in the best intelligence he was able to give. Concerning the purport of the disposition and manner of the temple hitherto described, I shall speak more largely in [chap. X.](#) toward the end, concluding this with an inscription of the *Triopian* farm consecrated by *Herodes Atticus*.

*Ne cuiquam glebam, saxumve impune movere
Ulli sit licitum. Parcarum namque severæ
Pænæ instant: siquis sacra scelus edat in æde.
Finitimi agricolæ, & vicini attendite cuncti,
Hic fundus sacer est; immotaque jura deorum.*

CHAP. VI.

Concerning antiquities found about this place; with a more particular chorography of the country around. Description of the roman road here, via Badonica. A plain demonstration that these works we are writing upon, are older than the roman times. Another like demonstration. Of Divitiacus, of the british Belgæ, who made the wansdike. A Druid axe or celt, found under one of the stones in Abury. Burnt bucks-horns, charcoal, and the like.

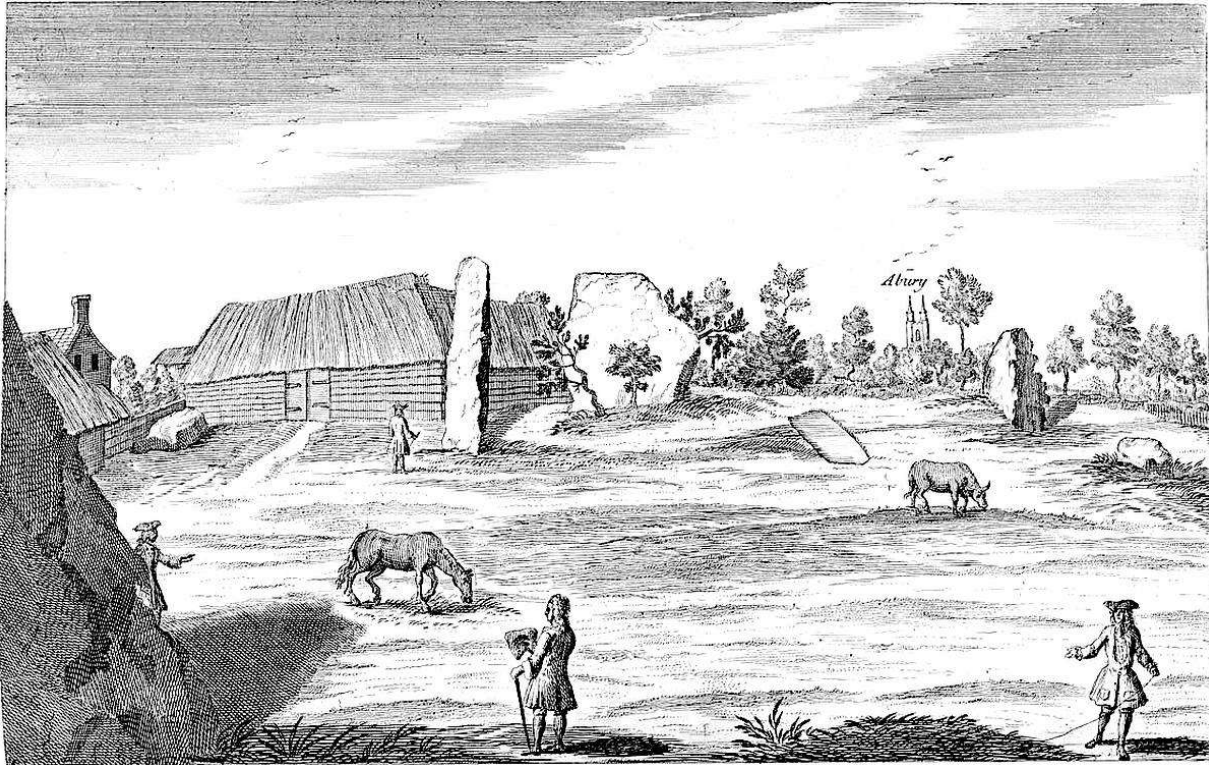
SEVERAL Roman coins have from time to time been found here, and in the neighbouring fields. A mile off goes the *roman way*, which I have described in my *Itinerary*, p. 132. call'd *Via Badonica*, being the way from *London* to *Bath*. It comes from *Marlborough CUNETIO*, crosses the *Hakpen-hill* by *Overton-hill*, quite over the neck of the snake belonging to our temple, goes close by *Silbury-hill*, thro' *Bekampton-fields*; then, a little southward of the tail of the snake, ascends *Runway-hill*, up the heath, where 'tis very plain, just as the *Romans* left it. [Plate IX.](#) exhibits a view of it from the present road to *Bath* and *Devizes*, and at the same time affords us a demonstration that our Druid antiquities, which we are here describing, are prior in time to these works of the *Romans*. This way is not compos'd, as they generally are, of materials fetch'd from a distance, made into a high bank, but only a small ridge of chalk dug up all along close by. We discern upon the heath the little pits or cavities, on both sides, whence it was taken to make the ridge of the road. For this road is not finished, though mentioned in *Antoninus's itinerary*, journey XIV, only chalk'd out, as we may properly say. Moreover, the workmen for readiness, have par'd off above half of a sepulchral barrow on the right hand, of a very finely turn'd bell-like form, to make use of the earth; and there is a discontinuance of the line of the little cavities there for some time, till it was not worth while any longer to fetch materials from it. And on the left hand they have made two of their little pits or cavities within the ditch of a Druid's barrow (as I call them) and quite dug away the prominent part of the barrow, consisting of a

little tump over the urn, inclos'd with the circular ditch of a much larger dimension. This observation is of a like nature with that of [Plate IV.](#) of *Stonehenge*. It must be noted, that this *roman* road here, being mark'd out only; I suppose it was done toward the declension of their empire here, when they found not time to finish it.

I could well enough discern from which point the *roman* workmen carry'd this way, by observing the discontinuity of these little pits, on account of the materials they took from the larger barrow, viz. from *Cunetio Marlborough*, to *Verlucio Hedington*, and so to *Bath*.

This road, as it goes farther on, and passes to the other side of *Runway-hill* (*Roman-way hill*) gives us two other remarkable appearances, both which are seen in [Plate X.](#) which I have repeated again in this book, to which it more properly belongs. It serves to rectify our notions concerning the high antiquity of the temple we are writing upon. 1. We discern the artifice of the *roman* workmen, in conducing their road along the precipitious side of this hill, and preserving at the same time the straight line, as much as may be. 2. We see a part of the famous *Wansdike*, or boundary of the *belgic* kingdom in *Britain*, drawn under their king *Divitiacus*, spoken of by *Cæsar* in his *commentaries*. He built the neighbouring town, the *Devizes*, so call'd from his name, and most probably the city of his residence. I treated of this matter in *Stonehenge*. 3. We may remark the union of the *roman* road and *Wansdike*, for some space, and a proof that *Wansdike* was made before this *roman* road, because the bank of the dike is thrown in, in order to form the road. *Cæsar* says, this *Divitiacus*, king of the *Suessions* in *Gaul*, lived an age before him.

Prospect of the Cove Abury 10 July 1723.



Stukeley del.

At the bottom of this hill is *Hedington*, another *roman* town, call'd *Verlucio*. *Calne*, less than five mile off *Abury*, was a *roman* town too, where many *roman* coins are found. Several of them I saw. Hence, the *romans* being very frequent in this country, 'tis no wonder their coins are found about *Abury*. I think I may well be excus'd from entering into a formal argumentation to prove that we must not hence gather, the *Romans* were founders of *Abury*. In my own opinion, who have duly consider'd these affairs, the temple of the *Druids* here is as much older than the *roman* times, as since the *Romans* to our own time.

Return we down *Runway-hill*, and contemplate that most agreeable prospect, of which I have given a faint representation in [Plate XI](#). We see here the whole course of this *Via Badonica* hence, in a straight line to *Marlborough*, by *Silbury-hill*, the great tomb of the founder of *Abury*. I saw several *roman* coins found about this road on *Overton-hill*, near the *white-hart* alehouse. On the left hand is the strong *roman* camp of *Oldbury*. Every where we behold great numbers of the barrows of the old *Britons*, regarding the temple of *Abury*. On the right hand we may discern a vast length of the *Wansdike*, carried along the northern edge of the high range of hills parting

north and south *Wiltshire*. Below is a pretty work like a *roman* camp, cut in the fine turf. It should seem to be somewhat belonging to the Druids, of which afterwards.

Beside some *roman* coins accidentally found in and about *Abury*, I was inform'd of a square bit of iron taken up under one of the great stones, upon pulling it down. I could not learn particularly what it was, tho' no doubt it belonged to the *British* founders. They found likewise a brass ax-head, under an ash-tree dug up near the smith's shop by the church. I understood, by the description they gave of it, it was one of those Druid axes or instruments call'd *Celts*, wherewith they cut the misletoe, fastening it occasionally on the end of the staff, which they commonly carry'd in their hands, one of the *insignia* of their office, as a pastoral staff of bishops.

When the lord *Stowell*, who own'd the manor of *Abury*, levell'd the *vallum* on that side of the town next the church, where the barn now stands, the workmen came to the original surface of the ground, which was easily discernible by a black *stratum* of mold upon the chalk. Here they found large quantities of bucks' horns, bones, oyster-shells, and wood coals. The old man who was employ'd in the work says, there was the quantity of a cart-load of the horns, that they were very rotten, that there were very many burnt bones among them.

They were remains of the sacrifices that had been perform'd here; probably before the temple was quite finish'd, and the ditch made. These are all the antiquities I could learn to have been found in and about the town of *Abury*.

CHAP. VII.

A description of the great avenue from West-Kennet, a mile off, which is the forepart of the snake proceeding from the circle. Observations on the vallum and ditch. On the proportion between the breadth of the avenue and the side interval of the stones. The avenue broader in that part, which is the belly of the snake, than the neck. Its whole length ten stadia of the ancients; 4000 cubits, an eastern mile. The Hakpen an oriental word, signifying the snake's head. The temple on Overton-hill. Such another temple described by Pausanias in Bœotia, called the snake's head.

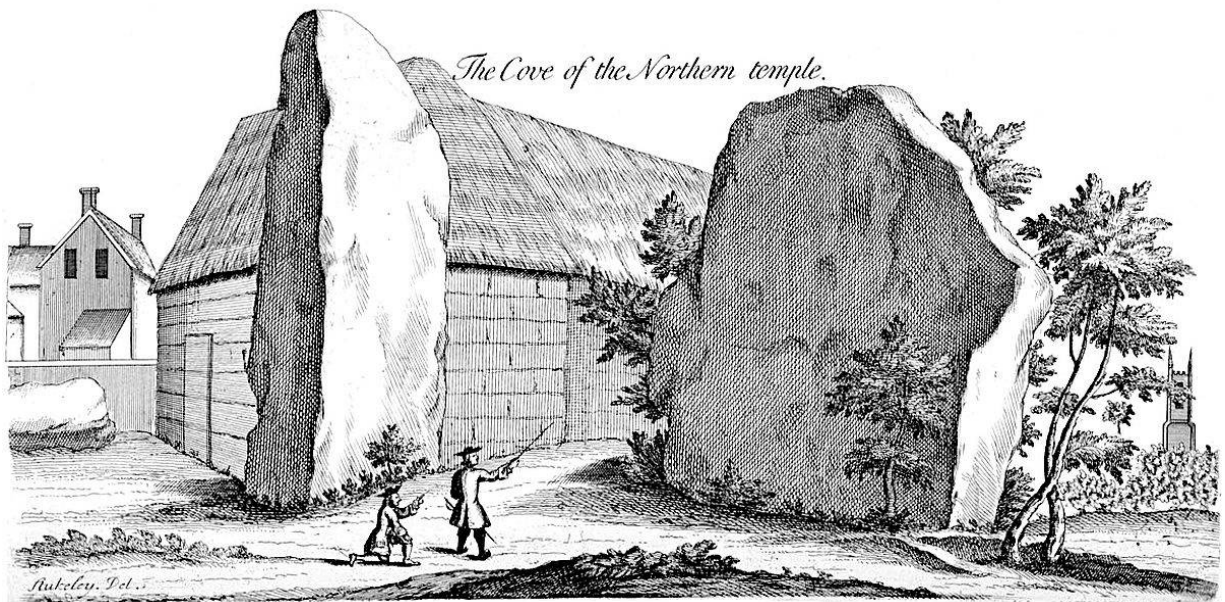
THE Druids, by throwing outwards the earth dug out of the huge circular ditch environing the town, demonstrated to all comers at first sight, that this was a place of religion, not a camp or castle of defence. They prevented its ever being us'd as such, which must have ruin'd their sacred design. Moreover it adds to the solemnity of the place; it gives an opportunity for a greater number of people to assist at the offices of religion.

This further great convenience attends the disposition of ditch and *vallum*, that the water falls off the *area* every way, and keeps it dry, which provides for the stability of their work, and convenience of the priests in their ministry. I observ'd the earth that composes the *vallum* was laid a small distance from the verge of the ditch, so as to leave a parapet or narrow walk between. This was as the *podium* of an amphitheater, for the lower tire of spectators. The ditch and rampart are each 60 feet, or 35 cubits broad. And now the whole is an agreeable terrace-walk round the town, with a pleasant view upon sometimes corn-fields, sometimes heath; the hill-tops every where cover'd with barrows; and that amazing artificial heap of earth call'd *Silbury-hill* in sight. The great *belgic* rampart, the *Wansdike*, licks all the southern horizon, as far as you can see it, crowning the upper edge of that range of hills parting *north* and *south Wiltshire*. Part of this pleasant prospect I have given in [plate XXIII](#), as seen from *Abury* church-steeple.

Let us then walk out of the confines of the temple properly, by the southern entrance of the town. Passing the *vallum*, the road straight forwards leads to *Kennet* and *Overton*, that on the right hand to the *Bath*. But our present way lies straight forwards, which is south-eastward, and may properly enough be call'd *Via sacra*, as being an avenue up to the temple; besides, it forms one half of the body of the snake, issuing out of the circle. There were but two gates or entrances into the temple originally; this was one. And this way I call *Kennet-avenue*.

TAB. XV.
P. 28.

View of the Cell of the Celtic Temple at Abury. Augst: 16. 1721.



Stukeley Del.

The Cove of the Northern temple.

By repeated mensurations, by careful attention and observations, by frequently walking along the whole track thereof, from one end to the other, I found out its purpose, its extent, the number of stones it is compos'd of, and the measures of their intervals. It extends itself from this southern entrance of *Abury* town to *Overton-hill*, overhanging the village of *West-Kennet*. There was another double circle of stones, which made the head of the snake. All the way between there, and this southern entrance, which is above a mile, was set with stones on each hand, opposite to one another, and at regular distances. This was the avenue, and form'd the forepart of the snake.

The Druids, in laying down this design, that it might produce a magnificent effect suitable to so great and operose a work, studied the thing well. As this was to be a huge picture or representation of an animal, they purposed to follow nature's drawing, as far as possible. A snake's body has some variation in its thickness, as slenderer toward the neck, than at its middle. This the Druids imitated in making the avenue broader toward this southern entrance of *Abury*; and drawing it narrower as it approached *Overton-hill*. Again, when a snake is represented in its sinuous motion, the intervals of the stones sideways must have a variation, as set in the inner or the outer curve; so as to make them stand regularly opposite to one another: yet this necessarily makes some little difference in the intervals, and this too is properly regarded in the work.

The whole length of this avenue consists of a hundred stones on each side, reaching from the *vallum* of *Abury* town, to the circular work on *Overton-hill*. Measuring the breadth of it in several places where I had an opportunity of two opposite stones being left, I found a difference; and the like by measuring the interval of stones sideways; yet there was the same proportion preserved between breadth and interval; which I found to be as two to three. So that here by *Abury*-town, in a part that represented the belly of the snake, the breadth of the avenue was 34 cubits, 56 feet and a half, and the intervals of the stones sideways 50 cubits, the proportion of two to three; twice 17 being 34, thrice 17 50. These 34 cubits take in the intire space of two intervals of the stones of the outer great circle of the temple of *Abury* within the ditch, together with the intermediate stone, which is the entry of the avenue to the temple. A most ancient manner, a double door with a pillar in the middle. Such was that of the *Mosaick* tabernacle: and such very often of our cathedrals. When we mount up *Overton-hill*, the avenue grows much narrower. And this observation help'd me in the discovery of the purport and design of the whole figure of the snake; and in the nature of the scheme thereof. Of which wonderful work we may well say with the poet; elsewhere,

Nec rapit immensos orbes per humum, neque tanto
[*Saxeus*] *in spiram tractu se colligit anguis.* Virg. Geor. 2.

When I abode here for some time on purpose, for several summers together; I was very careful in tracing it out, knew the distinct number of

each stone remaining, and where every one stood that was wanting; which often surpriz'd the country people, who remembred them left on the ground or standing, and told me who carried them away. Many of the farmers made deep holes and buried them in the ground: they knew where they lay. Lord *Winchelsea* with me counted the number of the stones left, 72, *anno* 1722. I laid it all down in the nature of a survey, on large imperial sheets of paper, and wrote a detail of every stone present, or absent. But it would be very irksome to load the press with it. I shall recite no more of it, than what I think most useful and necessary.

Standing at the southern entrance of *Abury*, one stone the first, lies on the eastern side or left hand, close by the ditch: its opposite stood where at present a sycamore tree is planted. The next stone on the right hand is standing, by the turning of the *Bath*-road. Twenty four stones on both sides, next following, are carried off. At about 20 intervals going along the road to *Kennet*, which is the same as the avenue, we descend a gentle valley, and then lose sight of *Abury*. There you discern the curving of the avenue, many stones being left together on both sides. Here two stones are standing opposite to each other. I measur'd them near 60 feet asunder, which is 34 cubits. Then we ascend again a little hillock, where a good number of stones remain on both sides.

In a close on the left hand of the avenue, or east of it, not far from *Abury* town, is a pentagonal stone laid flat on the ground, in the middle of which is a bason cut, always full of water, and never overflowing. The country people have a great regard to it: it proceeds from a spring underneath, and for ought I know, it may have been here from the foundation of our temple. Coming out of *Abury*, you observe the line of the [avenue](#) regards *Overton-hill* before you, but soon you find it leaves it, and curves to the right hand a little. At the number of 65 stones on each side, you come to a hedge belonging to the inclosures of *West-Kennet*. In the year 1720 I saw several stones just taken up there, and broke for building; fragments still remaining and their places fresh turf'd over, for the sake of pasturage. Where the corn-fields or pasturage have infring'd upon the sacred ground, our work generally goes to wreck. Where the heath remains, 'tis still perfect enough; of which we say with the great poet,

Nec nulla interea est inaratae gratia terræ.

so that the covetous farmer and grazier have conspired to abolish this most magnificent monument; and that just about the time I was there. *Charles Tucker Esq*; late of *East-Kennet* a gentleman of sense, us'd to be very angry at the ruin of these stones, and prevented it as much as he could.

As to the stones that compos'd this avenue, they were of all shapes, sizes, and height that happen'd, altogether rude. Some we measur'd 6 feet thick, 16 in circumference. If of a flattish make, the broadest dimension was set in the line of the avenue, and the most sightly side of the stone inward. The founders were sensible, all the effect desired in the case, was their bulk and regular station. All the hill tops, especially the *Hakpen*, are adorn'd with barrows as we go along. When the avenue comes to the inclosures aforementioned of *West-Kennet*, it passes through three of them, crosses a little field lane, and the common road from *Marlborough* to *Bath*, just after the road makes a right angle descending from *Overton-hill*. We must note that we have been a good while ascending again. In this angle the *Roman-road* from *Marlborough* coming down the hill, enters the common road. This is the *via Badonica* aforementioned.

John Fowler, who kept the alehouse hard by, demolish'd many of these stones by burning. The alehouse (the *white hart*) and the walls about it, were built out of one stone.

TAB. XVI.
P. 30. *Part of the South Temple from the Central Obelisk 10 July 1723*



As before, the avenue coming out of *Abury* town bended itself to the right, now 'tis easily enough discernible, that it makes a mighty curve to the left, the better to imitate the creature it's intended for.

Fit lapis, & servat serpentis imagine saxum.

Ovid. Met. XII.

Passing the *Roman* road, it traverses an angle of a pasture, and falls into the upper part of the same road again, and marches through two more pastures, all along the quickset hedge-side: so that the quick is planted in the very middle of it. Many of the stones are seen lying in their proper places, both in the pastures and in the road. These stones are all thrown down or reclining, and very large. We measur'd one by the style 12 feet long, 6 and a half broad, 3 and a half thick.

At the bottom of these pastures on the right, runs the virgin stream of *Kennet*, just parted from its fountain by *Silbury-hill*. One stone is still standing by a little green lane going down to the river. Now our avenue marches directly up the hill, across some plough'd fields, still by the hedge of the *Marlborough* road, where yet stands another stone belonging to it. Then we are brought to the very summit of the celebrated *Overton-hill*, properly the *Hakpen* or head of the snake, which is 7000 feet from the *vallum* of *Abury* town. 400 cubits, according to *Herodotus* II, was the *stadium* of the ancients, our furlong; a space that *Hercules* is said to run over at one breath. Had the side-interval of the stones of this avenue been the same throughout, 50 cubits, that repeated 100 times the number of the intervals, would produce 5000 cubits. But because, as I said, they lessen'd this interval proportionably, as they came to the neck of the snake, it amounts to 4000 cubits, which is ten *stadia*, an eastern mile in Dr. *Arbuthnot's* tables, amounting to 7000 feet, as Mr. *Roger Gale* and I measur'd its whole length.

We may observe the proportion between the diameter of the great circle of *Abury* town, which was 800 cubits, two *stadia*, and the length of the avenue, which is five times the other. Observe farther, they carry'd the avenue up the side of the hill, so sloping as to make the ascent gradual and easy.

This [*Overton-hill*](#), from time immemorial, the country-people have a high notion of. It was (alas, it was!) a very few years ago, crown'd with a most

beautiful temple of the Druids. They still call it the sanctuary. I doubt not but it was an *asylum* in Druid times; and the veneration for it has been handed down thro' all succession of times and people, as the name, and as several other particulars, that will occasionally be mention'd. It had suffer'd a good deal when I took that prospect of it, with great fidelity, *anno* 1723, which I give the reader in [plate XXI](#). Then, about sixteen years ago, farmer *Green* aforementioned took most of the stones away to his buildings at *Bekamton*; and in the year 1724 farmer *Griffin* plough'd half of it up. But the vacancy of every stone was most obvious, the hollows still left fresh; and that part of the two circles which I have drawn in the plate, was exactly as I have represented it. In the winter of that year the rest were all carry'd off, and the ground plough'd over.

The loss of this work I did not lament alone; but all the neighbours (except the person that gain'd the little dirty profit) were heartily griev'd for it. It had a beauty that touch'd them far beyond those much greater circles in *Abury* town. The stones here were not large, set pretty close together, the proportions of them with the intervals, and the proportions between the two circles, all being taken at one view, under the eye, charm'd them. The great stones of the great circles at *Abury* were not by them discern'd to stand in circles, nor would they easily be persuaded of it. But these of the sanctuary they still talk of with great pleasure and regret.

This *Overton-hill*, whereon was the elegant temple we are speaking of, is a very pleasant place. 'Tis the southern end of that ridge call'd the *Hakpen*, broken off by the river *Kennet*. All the water that falls in that plain wherein the whole work of *Abury* stands, descends this way. It is a round knoll with a gentle declivity to the east, west, and south. The *Kennet*, as it were, licks its feet on all those sides. The whole hill has its name from this end.

To our name of *Hakpen* alludes *אֲחִים ochim* call'd *doleful creatures* in our translation, *Isaiah* xiii. 21. speaking of the desolation of *Babylon*, "Wild beasts of the desert shall lie there, and their houses shall be full of *ochim*, and owls shall dwell there, and satyrs shall dance there." St. *Jerom* translates it serpents. The *Arabians* call a serpent, *Haie*; and wood-serpents, *Hageshin*; and thence our *Hakpen*; *Pen* is *head* in *british*.

אֲכָן *acan* in the *chaldee* signifies a *serpent*, and *hak* is no other than *snake*; the spirit in the pronunciation being naturally degenerated into a

sibilation, as is often the case, and in this sibilating animal more easily. So *super* from υπερ, *sylva* from υλη, *sudor*, υδωρ. So our word *snap* comes from the *gallic happer*, a *snacot* fish from the *latin acus, aculeatus piscis*. And in *Yorkshire* they call snakes *hags*, and *hag-worms*. Vide *Fuller's Misc.* IV. 15.

The temple that stood here was intended for the head of the snake in the huge picture; and at a distance, when seen in perspective, it very aptly does it. It consisted of two concentric ovals, not much different from circles, their longest diameter being east and west. By the best intelligence I could obtain from the ruins of it, the outer circle was 80 and 90 cubits in diameter, the medium being 85, 146 feet. It consisted of 40 stones, whereof 18 remained, left by farmer *Green*; but 3 standing. The inner circle was 26 and 30 cubits diameter, equal to the interval between circle and circle.

The stones were 18 in number, somewhat bigger than of the outer circle, but all carried off by *Green* aforesaid. Every body here remembers both circles entire, and standing, except two or three fallen.

Mr. *Aubury*, in his manuscript notes printed with *Camden's Britannia*, mentions it, "a double circle of stones, four or five feet high, tho' many are now fallen down. The diameter of the outer circle 40 yards, and of the inner 15. He speaks of the avenue coming up to it, as likewise of our before-describ'd avenue, from *Abury* to *West-Kennet*, set with large stones. One side, he says, is very nearly entire, the other side wants a great many." He did not see that 'tis but one avenue from *Abury* to *Overton-hill*, having no apprehension of the double curve it makes. And he erred in saying there was a circular ditch on *Overton-hill*.

The view here is extensive and beautiful. Down the river eastward we see *Marlborough*, and the whole course of the *Roman* road hence going along *Clatford-bottom*. We see a good way in the road to *Ambresbury*, and the gap of the *Wansdike*, where we pass thro'. Thence the *Wansdike* skims the edge of all the hill tops to *Runway-hill*. There we enter upon the view presented in [plate XXI](#). The *Roman* road runs upon the edge of the hill, on the right hand of that plate, between the barrows there. It descends the hill, and runs to the left hand of *Silbury*, and close by it; and then up *Runway-hill*. Next we see *Oldbury* camp, over *West-Kennet* village. Then we may view the whole length of the avenue hence to *Abury*, and observe the two great

curves it makes, to imitate the figure of a snake, as drawn in the ancient hieroglyphics. Coming from *Abury* town it curves to the right-hand or eastward, then winds as much to the west, till it ascends this *Overton-hill*, full east.

TAB. XVII.
P. 32.

A View of the South Temple July 15 1723.



I observed the breadth of the avenue here is narrower than elsewhere, as being the neck of the snake. 'Tis 45 feet or 26 cubits, equal to the diameter of the inner circle here. And as it is narrower than elsewhere, they made the side-distance between stone and stone proportional, being two thirds of that in breadth. Mr. *Smith*, living here, informed me, that when he was a school-boy, the *Kennet* avenue was entire, from end to end. *Silbury-hill* answers the avenue directly, as it enters this temple, being full west hence. Here is a great number of barrows in sight from this place, two close by; and a little north-eastward that chain of barrows design'd in [plate XXIX](#). the lower part, looking toward *Marlborough*. Human bones found in digging a little ditch by the temple, across some small barrows there, and where there were no barrows. Mr. *Aubury* says, sharp and form'd flints were found among them; arguments of great antiquity. They were of the lower class of *Britons*, that were not at the charge of a *tumulus*.

Thus we have conducted one half, the forepart of the snake, in this mighty work, up to *Overton-hill*, where it reposed its bulky head, and not long ago made a most beautiful appearance. I happen'd to frequent this place in the very point of time, when there was a possibility just left, of preserving the memory of it. In order to do it, I have laid down the groundplot thereof in [plate XX.](#) just as I found it for three years together, before it was demolish'd. I found that a line drawn between *Overton-mill* and the entrance of *Kennet* avenue in *Abury* town, is the ground-line of this avenue, from which it makes two vast curves contrary ways, to imitate the winding of a snake, and the hieroglyphic figures we see on *Egyptian* and other monuments. From *Overton-mill* is a most glorious prospect, overlooking the whole extent of *Abury* temple, and the sacred field it stands in, and beyond that, into *Gloucestershire* and *Somersetshire*.

*Explicat hinc tellus campos effusa patentēs,
Vix oculo premdente modum——* Lucan IV.

As we descend [Overton-hill](#) by the neck of the snake, we discern the main part of the track of this avenue between here and [Abury town](#), and may observe its huge curves both ways. And when we are near entering *Abury* town again, upon mounting the hill by the hedge-corner, at about eighteen intervals of stones from the *vallum*, you see a most advantageous prospect or approach to the temple, partly represented in [plate XVIII.](#) *Windmill-hill*, with its easy acclivity, fronting you directly, the northern end of *Hakpen* on the right and *Cherill-hill* on the left closing the horizon like scenes at a theater.

I observed many of these studied opportunities in this work, of introducing the ground and prospects, to render it more picture-like.

Pausanias in Bæotic. writes, that in the way from *Thebes* to *Glisas*, is a space fenc'd round with select stones, which the *Thebans* call the *snake's head*. And they tell a silly story about it, of a snake putting his head out of a hole there, which *Tiresius* struck with his sword. Just by it, he says, is a hill call'd the *supreme*, and a temple to *Jupiter the supreme*, and the brook *Thermodon* runs under it.

Can we doubt but this was an ancient temple, like what we are describing? It was built by *Cadmus*, or some of his people, of whom we

shall talk more in [chapter XIV](#).

I conclude this account with a verse of the poet's, which I believe was upon a work of the very same nature, as we shall explain by and by.

*Quod caput antè fuit, summo est in monte cacumen,
Ossa lapis fiunt*—— Ovid. Met. IV.

CHAP. VIII.

A description of the other great avenue from Bekamton, a mile off, which is the hinderpart of the snake, proceeding from the circle. The cove on the midway of it call'd Longstones, or the Devil's coits. The avenue terminated in a valley. Some animal bones found in a stone, whence a conjecture concerning their age. Of the number of the stones. Solomon's temple compared with ours. The mechanicks of the Druids called magick. Of the effect of the weather upon the stones.

AFTER I had carefully laid down the plan of *Kennet* avenue, and not understanding the full purport of it; in the year 1722, I found out this other, extending itself above a mile from the town of *Abury*, by another direction. It goes toward the village of *Bekamton*, therefore I call it *Bekamton* avenue. 'Tis really the hinderpart of the hieroglyphic snake, which the Druids meant here to picture out, in this most portentous size.

The former avenue goes out of *Abury* town at the south-east point; this full west, at the interval of 25 stones, or a quadrant of the great circle from *Kennet* avenue, and proceeds by the south side of the churchyard. Two stones lie by the parsonage-gate on the right hand. Those opposite to them on the left hand, in a pasture, were taken away 1702, as mark'd in the ground-plot of *Abury*. *Reuben Horsal* remembers three standing in the pasture. One now lies in the floor of the house in the churchyard. A little farther, one lies at the corner of the next house, on the right hand, by the lane turning off to the right, to the bridge. Another was broke in pieces to build that house with, *anno* 1714. Two more lie on the left hand, opposite. It then passes the beck, south of the bridge. Most of the stones hereabouts have been made use of about the bridge, and the causeway leading to it. A little spring arises at *Horslip* north-west, and so runs by here to *Silbury-hill*, where the real head of the *Kennet* is. But sometimes by a sudden descent of rain coming from *Monkton* and *Broad-Hinton*, this is very deep. The picture here humours the reality so far, as this may be call'd the vent of the snake.

Now the avenue passes along a lane to the left hand of the *Caln* road, by a stone house call'd *Goldsmiths-farm*, and so thro' farmer *Griffin's* yard, thro' one barn that stands across the avenue, then by another which stands on its direction. Two stones and their opposites still lie in the foundation; immediately after this, it enters the open plow'd fields; the *Caln* road running all this while north of it. If we look back and observe the bearings of *Abury* steeple, and other objects, a discerning eye finds, that it makes a great sweep or curve northwards. The avenue entring the open corn-fields, runs for some time by the hedge, on the right hand. When it has cross'd the way leading from *South-street*, we discern here and there the remains of it, in its road to *Longstone* cove. Farmer *Griffin* broke near 20 of the stones of this part of the avenue.

TAB. XVIII.
P. 34.



Stukeley delin.

E. Kirkall sculp.

The Entrance of Kennet avenue into Abury 14. May 1724.

This *Longstone* cove, vulgarly call'd long stones, is properly a cove, as the old *Britons* call'd 'em, compos'd of three stones, like that most magnificent one we described, in the center of the northern temple at *Abury*; behind the inn. They are set upon the ark of a circle, regarding each other with an obtuse angle. This is set on the north side of the avenue; one of the stones of that side makes the back of the cove. This is the only particularity in which this avenue differs from the former. I take it to be chiefly a judicious affectation of variety, and serv'd as a *sacellum* or *proseucha* to the

neighbourhood on ordinary days of devotion, viz. the sabbath-days. For if the Druids came hither in *Abraham's* time, and were disciples of his, as it appears to me; we cannot doubt of their observance of the sabbath. It stands on the midway of the length of the avenue, being the fiftieth stone. This opens to the south-east, as that of the northern temple to the north-east. 'Tis placed upon an eminence, the highest ground which the avenue passes over: these are call'd *Longstone*-fields from it. You have a good prospect hence, seeing *Abury* toward which the ground descends to the brook: *Overton-hill*, *Silbury*, *Bekampton*; and a fine country all around. Many stones by the way are just buried under the surface of the earth. Many lie in the balks and meres, and many fragments are remov'd, to make boundaries for the fields; but more whole ones have been burnt to build withal, within every body's memory. One stone still remains standing, near *Longstone* cove.

Longstone cove, because standing in the open fields, between the *Caln* road and that to the *Bath*, is more talk'd of by the people of this country, than the larger, and more numerous in *Abury* town. Dr. *Musgrave* mentions it in his *Belgium Britannicum*, page 44. and in his map thereof.

Mr. *Aubury* in his manuscript observations publish'd with Mr. *Camden's* *Britannia*, speaks of them by the name of the *Devil's coits*. Three huge stones then standing. It was really a grand and noble work. The stone left standing is 16 feet high, as many broad, $3\frac{1}{2}$ thick. The back stone is fallen flat on the ground, of like dimension.

—*annis solvit sublapsa vetustas:*

Fertur in abruptum magnus mons—

Virg. *Æn.* 12.

The other was carried off by that destroyer *Richard Fowler*, together with many more, but seven years ago (when I was there). The people that saw it broken in pieces by fire, assured me there were perfect flints in its composition and bones. And I verily believe I saw a piece of this same stone in a garden-wall of the little alehouse below in *Bekampton*-road, which had evidently a bone in it. Whence probably we may conclude, that these stones were form'd by nature since *Noah's* deluge, and these bones are of an antediluvian animal, which casually fell into the petrifying matter. They told me the stone contain'd 20 good loads, that the bones were in the middle

of the stone, and as hard as the stone. That stone now standing, was the right hand or eastern jamb of the cove.

A little way hence is a bit of heath-ground, but the plough will soon have devoured it. Here remains a great barrow, call'd *Longstone long barrow*; and from hence we see innumerable more barrows. The avenue continu'd its journey by the corn fields. Three stones lie still by the field-road coming from *South-street* to the *Caln-road*. Mr. *Alexander* told me he remember'd several stones standing by the parting of the roads under *Bekamton*, demolish'd by *Richard Fowler*. Then it descends by the road to *Cherill*, 'till it comes to the *Bath-road*, close by the *Roman-road*, and there in the low valley it terminates, near a fine group of barrows, under *Cherill-hill*, in the way to *Oldbury-camp*; this is west of *Bekamton-village*. This point facing that group of barrows and looking up the hill is a most solemn and awful place; a descent all the way from *Longstone cove*, and directed to a descent, a great way further, down the *Bath-road*, where no less than five valleys meet. And in this very point only you can see the temple on *Overton-hill*, on the south side of *Silbury-hill*.

Here I am sufficiently satisfied this avenue terminated, at the like distance from *Abury-town*, as *Overton-hill* was, in the former avenue; 100 stones on a side, 4000 cubits in length; ten *stadia* or the eastern mile. Several stones are left dispersedly on banks and meres of the lands. One great stone belonging to this end of the avenue, lies buried almost under ground, in the plow'd land between the barrow west of *Longstone long barrow*, and the last hedge in the town of *Bekamton*. *Richard Fowler* shew'd me the ground here, whence he took several stones and demolish'd them. I am equally satisfied there was no temple or circle of stones at this end of it. 1. Because it would be absurd in drawing. The head of the snake was aptly represented by that double circle on *Overton-hill*: but this place, the tail of the snake, admitted no such thing, and I doubt not but it grew narrower and narrower as before we observed, of the neck of the snake. 2. Here is not the least report of such a thing among the country people. It would most assuredly have been well known, because every stone was demolish'd within memory, when I was there. I cannot doubt but many have suffered since; and I have had very disagreeable accounts thereof sent to me. I apprehend this end of the avenue drew narrower in imitation of the tail of a snake, and that one stone stood in the middle of the end, by way of close.

This I infer from the manner of the end of that avenue of the Druid temple at *Classerness*; which I take to be the tail of a snake. Of which hereafter.

For a more mathematical determination of this end of the avenue, see Chap X. at the end.

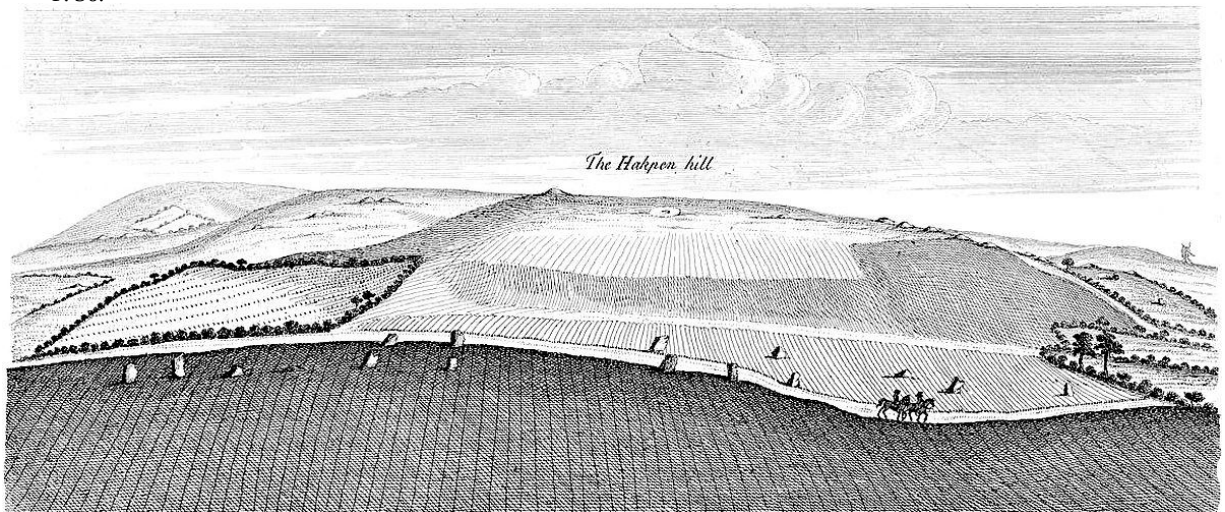
The avenue took another circular sweep of a contrary manner, as it descended from *Longstone* cove, bending southward.

——*pars cætera campum*
Ponè legit, sinuatque immensa volumine terga.

as *Virgil* writes of this creature, *Æneid* II.

And it went over variety of elevations and depressures as the other of *Kennet* avenue; but that terminated on a hill, as this in a valley. With great judgment, they thus laid out the ground, to make the whole more picture-like.

TAB. XIX.
P. 36.



Stukeley delin.

Toms Sculp.

Continuation of Kennet avenue 24. May 1724.

Bekamton-village lies very low, at the bottom of a valley subject to inundations, and the ground is springy: they can't make cellars there: whereas *Abury* is very dry, and their wells deep.

There are many barrows on the south downs, between *St. Anne's-hill* and *Bekamton*, which chiefly regard this avenue. Many as we go up to the

Roman camp of *Oldbury*, and in *Yatesbury*-field. And pretty near the termination, in the valley of *Bekamton* under *Cherill-hill*, is a group or line of half a score of very different forms, which make a pretty appearance. So the valley along the present road from *Bekamton* to the *Devizes* and *Bath*, is full of barrows on both sides; all regarding this part of the sacred work, the tail of the snake.

I am confident, the reader by this time has conceiv'd a just notion of this wonderful work, which we have describ'd with as much brevity as possible; and at the same time he will resent its fate, that a few miserable farmers should, within the space of 20 years, destroy this the noblest monument, which is probably on the face of the globe; which has stood so many ages, and was made to stand as many more. The grandeur of the work has render'd it altogether unnecessary to add any heightning, or any flourishes. I leave it as an out-line of the most masterly hand, a picture that requires no colouring.

Concerning the forms of the religious performances here, I can say but little, more than that I see nothing, but what appears to be in the ancient patriarchal mode, before cover'd temples were introduc'd in the world; the æra of which time, I am fully convinc'd, was that of the *Mosaick* tabernacle. We may well assert this to be ancients than that time; as the largest, so probably one of the most ancient in the *Britannic* isles. The Druids were tempted to make this work here, by the appearance of the stones on the downs, on the other side of *Hakpen-hill*, call'd the gray weathers. Finding the ground all overspread with these enormous masses, they had no difficulty in resolving, and they made none in putting their resolution in execution; in conveying 650 of the choicest of them, to make this notable temple. Thus we cast up the number.

The outer circle of <i>Abury</i> town	100
The outer circle of the northern temple	030
The inner circle	012
The cove	003
The outer circle of the southern temple	030
The inner circle	012
The ambre or central obelisc	001
The ring stone	001

The avenue of <i>Kennet</i>	200
The outer circle of <i>Hakpen</i>	040
The inner	018
The avenue of <i>Bekamton</i>	200
<i>Longstone</i> cove jambs	002
The inclosing stone of the serpent's tail	001
	—
	—
	650

The square of *Solomon's* temple was 700 cubits; the diameter of *Abury* is 800. But *Abury*, in square content, is to *Solomon's* temple as 50 to 49. If we take into the account the *vallum* of *Abury*, we find this would hold incomparably more people than the other, as spectators or assistants. An hundred oxen in sacrifice was an hecatomb. Twenty two thousand were offered by *Solomon* at the dedication, beside other animals. Three times in the year the whole nation of *Israel* assembled there, to pay their devotions and sacrifices, the aboriginal covenant made between God and man, in order to obtain favour and pardon. For ought we know, there might be as many here, and on the same account. I believe their most common times of these extraordinary religious meetings were on the four quarters of the year, the equinoxes and solstices.

We may well wonder how these people could bring together so many of these great stones, and set them up so exactly. The stones they had not far to fetch, only from the other side of the *Hakpen*, from the gray weathers. Their vicinity, their lying on the surface of the ground, the soil here being solid chalk, was the great inducement for the Druids, in these most early ages, to build this temple. The manner of their mechanics, which undoubtedly was very simple, must be equally surprizing. I apprehend, they brought the stones upon strong carriages, and drew them by men. For even in *Cæsar's* time, there was an infinite multitude of people. Their manner of raising the stones seems to have been with tall trees, us'd for leavers, and no doubt very artfully apply'd. The method of fixing these enormous blocks of stone was, to dig a hole in the solid chalk, and ram the foundation of it in, with lesser stones, flints, and coggles, very artfully. They are not let in above two feet and a half deep. And the country being all a solid bed of chalk, was

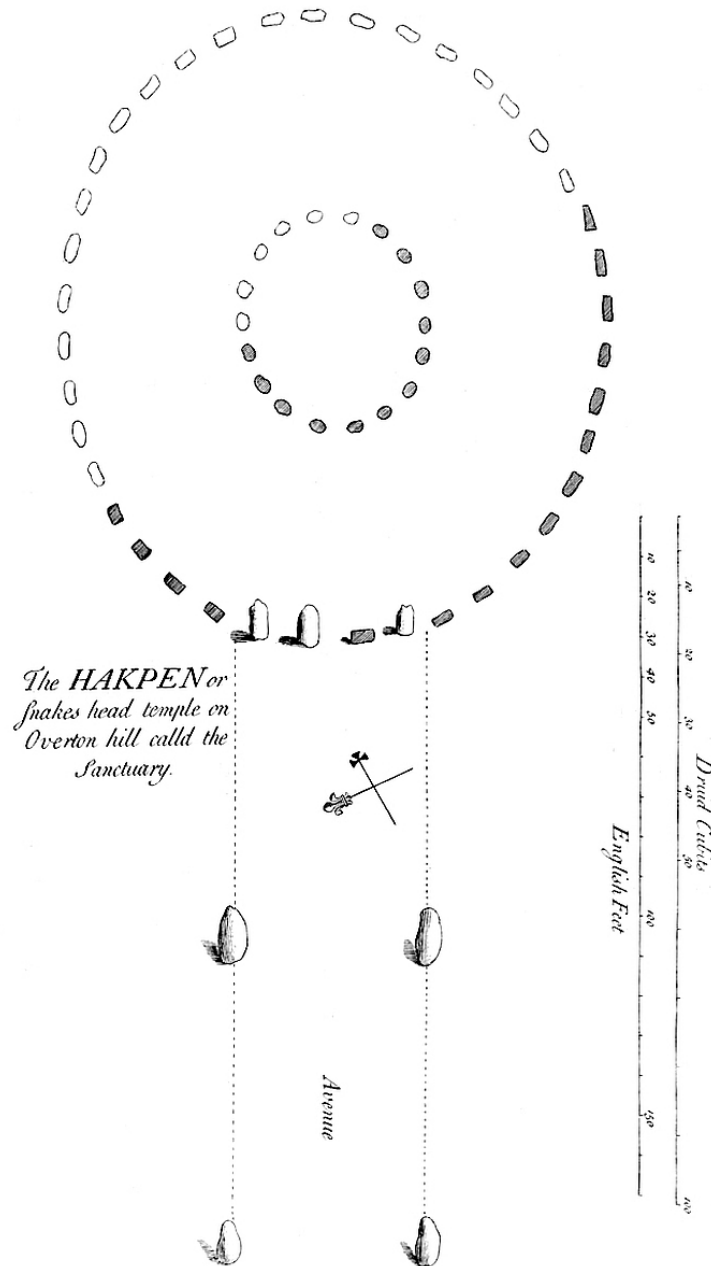
another reason why here, as at *Stonehenge*, they chose it for this extraordinary building. The conducting and rightly managing an immense number of hands, the providing for their maintenance, was a matter of wisdom and great authority. The marvellous effect produced, might well establish the glory of the Druids of *Britain*, which echoed across the ocean, and very much favour'd the opinion mankind had conceiv'd of their practising magick. For magick is nothing else but the science that teaches us to perform wonderful and surprizing things, in the later acceptation of the word. And in very many ages after the Druid times, mankind had the same notion, and the vulgar have to this day, concerning these works. And most probably from them sprung the character, which *Pliny* gives of our *british* Druids practising magic, and being so great proficient therein, as to equal the *persian* and *chaldean magi*, "so that one would even think," says he, "the Druids had taught it them."

I judge it much more probable, the Druids learn'd it from them, at least they both derive it from the same original fountain. And whatever they might practise of real magic, the notion of mankind concerning them, receiv'd strength from the name *magi*, which they might bring with them from the east. *Magus* there originally signifies no more than a *priest*, or person who officiates in sacreds. The word comes from *maaghim meditabundi*, people of a contemplative, retir'd life; whom more commonly in the west, they call'd Druids. I am not dubious in thinking the times we are talking of, when this temple of *Abury* was built, are of the extremest antiquity, near that of *Abraham*. I was very often on the spot, furnish'd with what I thought a convincing argument, from considering the wear of the weather, what effect it had upon these stones of a very firm texture, a kind of gray marble. And thus my reasoning was founded.

I had sufficient opportunity of comparing the effect of the weather upon the stones here, and upon those at *Stonehenge*. For some years together, I went from one to the other directly, staying a fortnight or more at each place to make my observations. Nothing is more manifest, than that the stones of *Stonehenge* have been chizel'd, some quite round, some on three sides, easily to be distinguish'd. The stones of *Abury* are absolutely untouch'd of tool. No doubt, at that time of day, the aboriginal patriarchal method from the foundation of the world was observ'd, not to admit a tool upon them. Even when *Solomon's* temple was built, tho' the stones were all carv'd with

great art, yet that was done before they were brought to the building; for no ax or hammer was heard thereon. The like, probably, may be said of *Stonehenge*.

TAB. XX.
P. 38.



*The HAKPEN or snakes head temple on
Overton hill, calld the Sanctuary.*

It seems likely, that when *Stonehenge* was built, the Druids had some notice from *phœnician* traders, of the nature of *Solomon's* temple; therefore they made their impost work, as some kind of advance, toward a cover'd temple, and likewise chisel'd their stones in compliance thereto. By using the best of my judgment, in comparing the effect of the weather upon *Stonehenge* and *Abury*, I could easily induce myself to think that *Abury* was as old again. For in some places there were cavities a yard long, corroded by time, and on those sides that originally lay on the ground, which, if they had not been expos'd to the weather, by being set upright, would have been smooth. Several other persons of good judgment have been of the same sentiment.



*RUBEN HORSALL Clark of Abury & Antiquarian.
July 29 1722*

CHAP. IX.

Of the barrows or sepulchral tumuli about Abury, very numerous here, as having for ages been a metropolitical temple. The several kinds of them, conjecturally distinguished. Royal barrows of old and later fashions. Druids' barrows. Archdruids' or long barrows. Silbury much the largest barrow about Abury, and perhaps in the world. The temple built, seemingly, on account of this barrow. The sacred character as a prophylactic to the ashes of the dead. The Druids taught the resurrection of the body as well as soul. The great king dug up, who was interred at top. His most ancient bridle found with the corps, in possession of the author. The british chariots an oriental usage. A conjecture of the name of this king, Cunedha, who lived at Marlborough. Of the fountain of the Kennet hard by, taking its name from him. The dimension of Silbury-hill, its solid content. A demonstration of the Roman road made since Silbury-hill. A conjecture concerning the time of year when this prince died. The anniversaries of the ancients at the tombs of the dead. What has been found in other barrows here. Beads of amber, and other matter, as glass, earth, &c. A flat gold ring, spear-heads, a bit of gold. Another demonstration of the Roman road being later than these works. An entire urn which the author dug up. A double circle of stones at Winterburn-basset. Pyriform barrows. Of long barrows or archdruids'. Very large ones here, above 300 foot long. Some set round with stones. Some with great stoneworks at the end.

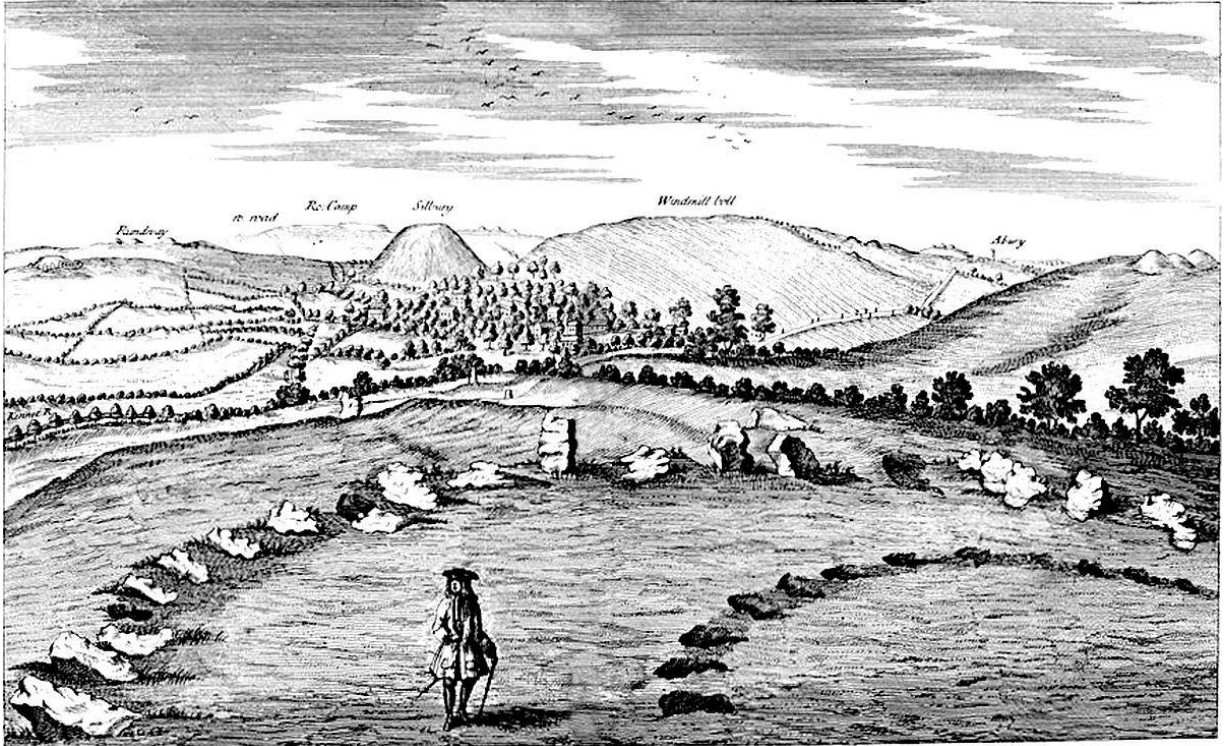
SO many ages as *Abury* was the great cathedral, the chief metropolitical or patriarchal temple of the island, no wonder there are an infinite number of these barrows about it. Great princes, and men within a considerable tract of country round here, would naturally choose to leave their mortal remains in this sacred ground, more peculiarly under the divine regard. Every hill-top within view of the place is sure to be crowned with them. As at *Stonehenge*, so here, there are great varieties of them, which no doubt, originally, had

their distinctions of the quality and profession of the person interr'd. In the additions to Mr. *Camden's Wiltshire*, several sorts of them are mention'd.

1. Small circular trenches, with very little elevation in the middle. These are what I call (for distinction-sake) Druid barrows. An eminent one I have given [plate XXII](#), on the *Hakpen* hill, overlooking *Kennet* avenue.

TAB. XXI.
P. 40.

Prospect of the Temple on Overton Hill. 8 July 1723.



Stukeley d.

The Hakpen, or head of the Snake, in ruins.

2. Ordinary barrows, meaning plain round ones, common all over *England*. Some may be *roman*, or *saxon*, or *danish*, as well as *british*.

3. Barrows with ditches round them. These are commonly such as I esteem royal, of the newest fashion among the old *Britons*; generally of an elegantly turn'd bell-form. These two last sort I call king-barrows.

4. Large oblong barrows, some with trenches round them, others without. These I call, for method sake, archdruids' barrows. Several of 'em near *Abury* and *Stonehenge*. And sometimes we find 'em in other places about the kingdom. A druid celt was found in that north of *Stonehenge*, which induc'd me to give them the title. I shall speak a little concerning them in

the method mention'd, as they are observable about *Abury*, but we ought to begin with *Silbury*, which, says our right reverend and learned author, is the largest barrow in the county, and perhaps in all *England*.

Silbury indeed is a most astonishing collection of earth, artificially rais'd, worthy of *Abury*, worthy of the king who was the royal founder of *Abury*, as we may very plausibly affirm. By considering the picture of *Abury* temple, we may discern, that as this immense body of earth was rais'd for the sake of the interment of this great prince, whoever he was: so the temple of *Abury* was made for the sake of this *tumulus*; and then I have no scruple to affirm, 'tis the most magnificent *mausoleum* in the world, without excepting the *Egyptian* pyramids.

Silbury stands exactly south of *Abury*, and exactly between the two extremities of the two avenues, the head and tail of the snake. The work of *Abury*, which is the circle, and the two avenues which represent the snake transmitted thro' it, are the great *hierogrammaton*, or sacred prophylactic character of the divine mind, which is to protect the *depositum* of the prince here interr'd. The *Egyptians*, for the very same reason, frequently pictur'd the same hieroglyphic upon the breast of their mummies, as particularly on that in my lord *Sandwich's* collection; and very frequently on the top and summit of *Egyptian* obelisks, this picture of the serpent and circle is seen; and upon an infinity of their monuments. In the very same manner this huge snake and circle, made of stones, hangs, as it were, brooding over *Silbury-hill*, in order to bring again to a new life the person there buried. For our Druids taught the expectation of a future life, both soul and body, with greatest care, and made it no less than a certainty.

—————*vobis auctoribus umbræ*
Non tacitas Erebi sedes, Ditisque profundi
Pallida regna petunt; regit idem spiritus artus
Orbe alio—— Sings *Lucan. Phars. I.*

Here might be said, with the same poet,

Et regis cineres extructo monte quiescunt. *Lucan.*

'Till in the month of March, 1723, Mr. *Halford* order'd some trees to be planted on this hill, in the middle of the noble plain or *area* at the top,

which is 60 cubits diameter. The workmen dug up the body of the great king there buried in the center, very little below the surface. The bones extremely rotten, so that they crumbled them in pieces with their fingers. The soil was altogether chalk, dug from the side of the hill below, of which the whole barrow is made. Six weeks after, I came luckily to rescue a great curiosity which they took up there; an iron chain, as they called it, which I bought of *John Fowler*, one of the workmen: it was the bridle buried along with this monarch, being only a solid body of rust. I immerg'd it in limner's drying oil, and dried it carefully, keeping it ever since very dry. It is now as fair and entire as when the workmen took it up. I have given a sketch of it in [plate XXXVI](#). There were deers' horns, an iron knife with a bone handle too, all excessively rotten, taken up along with it.

Pausanias, in *Eliacis*, writes, how in his time, a *roman* senator conquer'd at the *olympic* games. He had a mind to leave a monument of his victory, being a brazen statue with an inscription. Digging for the foundation, just by the pillar of *Oenomaus*, they took up fragments of a shield, a bridle and *armilla*, which he saw.

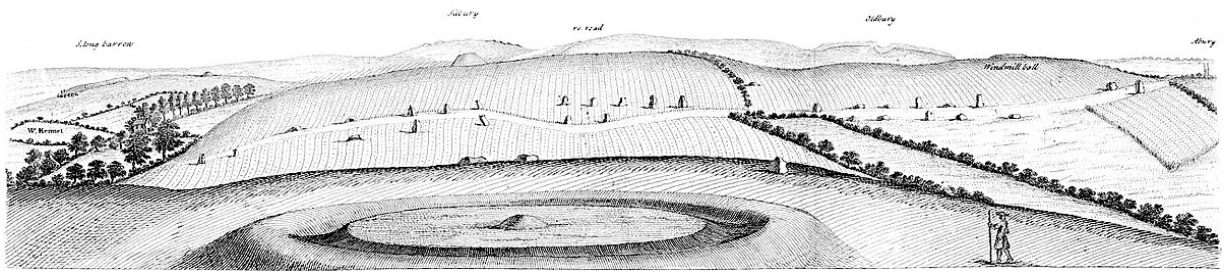
Our bridle belong'd to the harness of a *british* chariot, and brings into our thoughts the horses and chariots of *Egypt*, mention'd in earliest days. The *Tyrian Hercules*, who, I suppose, might bring the first oriental colony hither, was a king in *Egypt*. In scripture, when *Joseph* was prime minister there, we find chariots frequently mention'd, both for civil and military use. In *Joshua's* time, xvii. 16, 18. the *Canaanites*, *Rephaim* or giants, (*Titans*) and *Perizzites* had them. So the *Philistines*. Our ancestors the *Britons* coming both from *Egypt* and *Canaan*, brought hither the use of chariots; and they remain'd, in a manner, singular and proper to our island, to the time that the *romans* peopled it. And it was fashionable for the *romans* at *Rome*, in the height of their luxury, to have *british* chariots, as we now *berlins*, *landaus*, and the like.

Esseda cælati sistē Britannia jugis.

Philostratus, vit. *sophist.* xxv. *Polemon*, remarks the enameling and ornament of *phrygian* and *celtic* bridles, as being very curiously wrought. Ours is perfectly plain and rude; an argument of its great antiquity.

Silbury is the name of the hill given by our *saxon* ancestors, meaning the *great* or *marvellous hill*. So *Silchester*, the *Vindoma* of the *Romans*, means the *great Chester*. It cannot help us to the name of the monarch there buried. When I consider this hill standing at the fountain of the *Kennet Cunetio*, still call'd *Cunnet* by the country people, and that among the most ancient *Britons* the name of *Cunedha* is very famous, that they talk much of a great king of this name, it would tempt one to conjecture, this is the very man. This conjecture receives some strength from what my old friend Mr. *Baxter* writes about *Cunetio* or *Marlborough*, which the river first visits. He thinks it had its name from a famous king, *Cunedha*, who lived at *Marlborough*, called *Kynydd Kynüidion*, which we may *english*, *Cunedha* of *Marlborough*, which name is mention'd in the ancient *british* genealogies before the grandfather of king *Arthur*; tho' we scarce imagine their genealogies can truly reach the founder we are thinking of. But *Cyngetorix*, a king in *Britain*, who fought *Julius Cæsar*, and *Cunobelin*, king of the island in *Augustus's* time, may be descendants of this man, at least their names have some relation. And in *Cæsar's Comment.* B. G. VII. *Conetodunus* a *gaulish* prince, is the same name.

We may remember too, that *Merlin* the magician, who is said to have made *Stonehenge* by his magic, is affirm'd to have been buried at *Marlborough*. Mr. *Camden* recites it from *Alexander Necham*. Doubtless *Stonehenge*, much more *Abury*, are incomparably older than *Merlin's* time. But the oldest reports we can expect to have of these affairs, must be from the *Britons*, the oldest inhabitants left. And 'tis natural for them to affix old traditions vastly beyond their knowledge, to the last famous persons they have any account of; so that we may well judge some truths are generally latent in these old reports. It is likely our king *Kunedha* lived at *Marlborough*, was buried in *Silbury*, was the founder of *Abury*. And the archdruid, who with him was the projector and executor of the stupendous work of *Abury*, was buried at *Marlborough*. For *Marlborough* is in sight of that part of the temple which is the *Hakpen*, or snake's head, on *Overton-hill*.



Stukeley delin.

Toms Sculp.

Prospect of Kennet Avenue from the Druids tumulus on Hakpen hill. May 15th. 1724.

Strabo writes in XII, that there is a *tumulus* of king *Marsyas*, where he was buried, at the head of the river *Marsyas*. This seems to be an exact parallel case with ours, and that the river preserves the name of the king to this day, from whom it had its name. *Pausanias Bæot.* writes, the tomb of *Asphodius* is at the spring-head of the river *Oedipodias*. And *Tiresias's* sepulchre is by the fountain *Telphussa*. And the like of very many more.

The person that projected the forming this vast body of earth, *Silbury-hill*, had a head as well as hands, and well chose his ground, well contriv'd how to execute his purpose. He pitch'd upon the foot of the chalk hill, by the fountain of the *Kennet*, in the very meridian line of *Abury*. The bottom of the hill is natural earth, and beyond the verge of its circumference at bottom, they dug the earth of the hill away to the level of the adjacent meadow, in order to furnish materials for the artificial part of the hill, leaving as it were an isthmus, or neck of original land. Further, to render this artificial part more detach'd from the natural, they dug a deep trench on the land-side, in the middle of the isthmus, but left two bridges, as it were, or passages up to the hill. By this means the ascent for the multitude employ'd, was render'd more easy, for the natural hill was as a half-pause or resting-place for them.

The diameter of *Silbury-hill* at top is 105 feet, the same as *Stonehenge*. At bottom 'tis somewhat more than 500 feet, in reality 300 cubits, as at top 60 cubits. 100 cubits its exact perpendicular altitude. They that have seen the circumference of *Stonehenge*, will admire that such an *area* should be carried up 170 feet perpendicular, with a sufficient base to support it: and they that consider the geometry of this barrow, as I have drawn it in [plate](#)

[XXVIII](#), will be equally pleased with the natural and easy proportion of it. But without actually seeing it, we can scarce have a full idea of it. The solid contents of it amount to 13558809 cubic feet. Some people have thought it would cost 20000*l.* to make such a hill.

Some old people remember king *Charles II*, the duke of *York*, and duke of *Monmouth* riding up it. The *Roman* way, *via Badonica*, coming from *Overton-hill* to *Runway-hill*, should have pass'd directly thro' *Silbury-hill*; wherefore they curv'd a little southward to avoid it, and it runs close by the isthmus of the hill, then thro' the fields of *Bekamton*. This shews *Silbury-hill* was ancients than the *Roman* road. They have lately fenc'd out the *Roman* road (which they call the *french way*) in the plough'd fields of *Bekamton*; but you see the continuation of it when it reaches the heath ground, as in [plate IX](#).

It seems no difficult matter to point out the time of the year when this great prince died, who is here interr'd, viz. about the beginning of our present *April*. I gather it from this circumstance. The country people have an anniversary meeting on the top of *Silbury-hill* on every *palm-sunday*, when they make merry with cakes, figs, sugar, and water fetch'd from the *swallow-head*, or spring of the *Kennet*. This spring was much more remarkable than at present, gushing out of the earth in a continued stream. They say it was spoil'd by digging for a fox who earth'd above, in some cranny thereabouts; this disturb'd the sacred nymphs, in a poetical way of speaking.

We observed before, concerning the temple of *Rowldrich*, there was a like anniversary meeting at that place, which doubtless has been continued thro' all ages, and all succession of inhabitants, from the death of the arch-druid there buried. If we read the fifth *Æneid* of *Virgil*, we shall there find the major part of it to be a description of the very matters we are writing of. The great poet who affectedly describes all ancient customs, speaks of his hero making a *tumulus* for his father *Anchises*, and a temple and sacred grove; providing priests and officers necessary for that purpose. Celebrating the anniversary remembrance of his deceased parent, with great magnificence, with sacrifices, feasting, games, sports and exercises, and distributing rewards to the victors. So *Virgil* in *Georg.* 3.

Et viridi in campo templum de marmore ponam, &c.

So *Herodotus* describing the manner of sepulture among the *Thracians* and *Macedonians*. The whole matter is so notorious, that I leave the reader to make the particular application and parallel. Here at *Silbury*, the country being all a fine and exquisite down, I cannot point out the place where the games were kept: perhaps on the meadow between *Abury* and the hill.

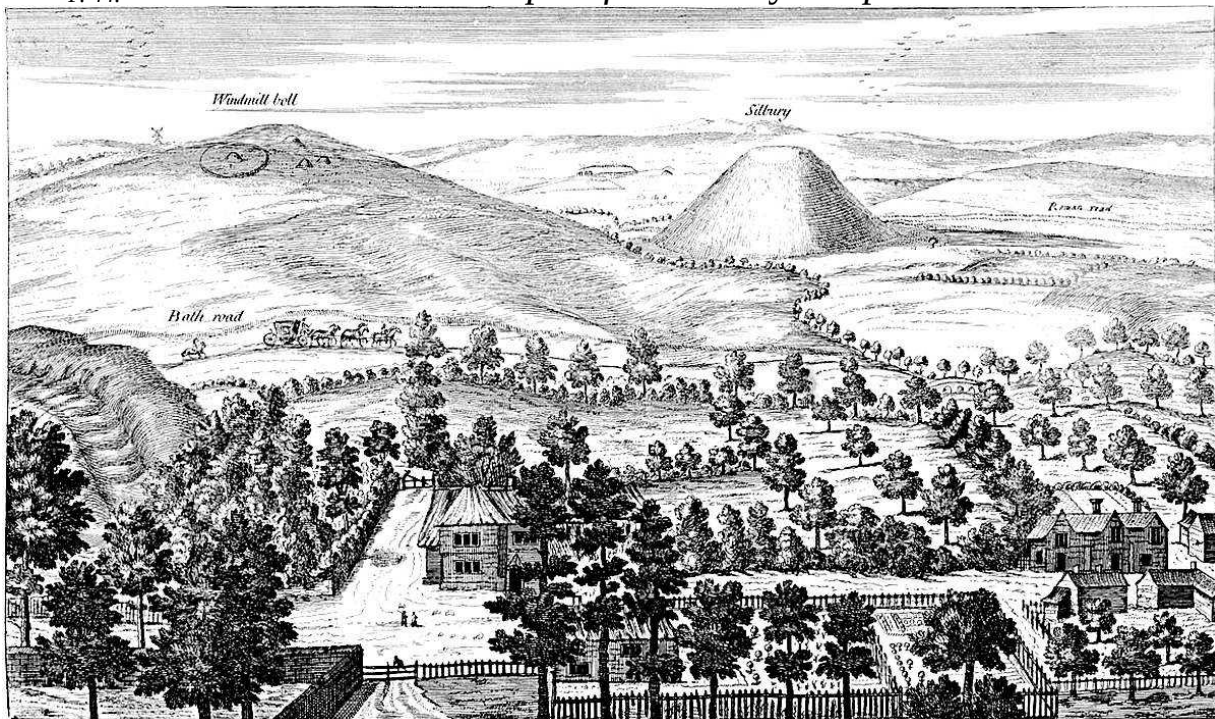
I took notice that *apium* grows plentifully about the spring-head of the *Kennet*. *Pliny* writes *defunctorum epulis dicatum apium*. To this day the country people have a particular regard for the herbs growing there, and a high opinion of their virtue.

The king-barrows which are round, both here and elsewhere vary in their turn and shape, as well as magnitude, as we see in a group together; whereof still very many are left, many destroy'd by the plough. Some of the royal barrows are extremely old, being broad and flat, as if sunk into the ground with age. There is one near *Longstone* cove set round with stones. I have depicted two groups of them, one by the serpent's head, on [*Overton-hill*](#); another by the serpent's tail, in the way between *Bekampton* and *Oldbury* camp: some flat, some campani-form, some ditch'd about, some not. One near the temple on *Overton-hill* was quite levell'd for ploughing *anno* 1720; a man's bones were found within a bed of great stones, forming a kind of arch. Several beads of amber long and round, as big as one's thumb end, were taken from it, and several enamel'd *British* beads of glass: I got some of them, white in colour, some were green. They commonly reported the bones to be larger than common. So *Virgil Georg.* 1.

Grandiaque effossis mirabitur ossa sepulchris.

I bought a couple of *British* beads, one large of a light blue and rib'd, the other less, of a dark blue, taken up in one of the two barrows on *Hakpen-hill*, east of *Kennet* avenue. These two barrows are ditch'd about, and near one another. The single barrow next it toward the snake's head temple, is large and beautifully turn'd, with a ditch about it, at a distance, which throws it into a campanule form.

A Prospect from Abury Steeple.



Stukeley d.

Mr. *Bray* of *Monkton* open'd a barrow, among many others, at *Yatesbury*. There was a great stone laid at top, just under the surface. When taken up, they found a body laid in a stone coffin, form'd by several stones. He says, in another they found a body, with a flat gold ring, which was sold for 30s. and a piece of brass, about the bulk of a pint mug, with spear-heads of iron.

A man of *Ambresbury*, who had liv'd here, told me of a brass spear-head dug up in a barrow between *Monkton* and *Abury*, by a body: and that under some stones in a barrow, south of *Silbury*, they found a bit of gold, (I suppose the covering of a button, or the like, such as that I dug up at *Stonehenge*,) and many sharp bits of iron.

Mr. *Aubury* speaks of a barrow opened in *Kennet* parish, *anno* 1643, two stones 11 feet long, laid side by side, and a corps between, with a sword and knife. Another like stone laid over all.

There is a very delicate hill north of *Abury*, of a round form, with an easy ascent quite round; 'tis call'd [*Windmill-hill*](#). The turf as soft as velvet. 'Tis encompass'd with a circular trench, exceeding old. Fifteen barrows of a most ancient shape thereon. Many barrows are on the top, of several shapes. I open'd a small one, very old, flat, and round, and found an entire urn

turn'd up-side down, into a hole cut in the solid chalk. The bones very rotten. I have given a drawing of the urn, [plate XXXVI](#). It was red without, black within, 14 inches high, 9 in diameter at the aperture, wrought a little both within and without, and at the bottom, which stood uppermost.

South of *Abury* town is a hill, between it and *Silbury*, call'd *Windmill-hill*; it lies between our two avenues, and intercepts the view from one to the other. This too is crown'd with barrows of different sorts and sizes. The *Via Badonica* runs on the southern skirt of it, going from *Overton-hill* to *Silbury*. I took notice there of a barrow of that kind I call *Druids*. This happening too near the track of the *Roman* road, it goes over part of it. Part is fill'd up, and the lump in the middle, under which the urn lay, they have dug away: A further demonstration, that it is of a date posterior to our *celtic* works here. This hill too is call'd *Weedon-hill*, perhaps from the *Roman* way.

At *Winterburn-basset*, a little north of *Abury*, in a field north-west of the church, upon elevated ground, is a double circle of stones concentric, 60 cubits diameter. The two circles are near one another, so that one may walk between. Many of the stones have of late been carry'd away. West of it is a single, broad, flat, and high stone, standing by itself. And about as far northward from the circle, in a plough'd field, is a barrow set round with, or rather compos'd of large stones. I take this double circle to have been a family-chapel, as we may call it, to an archdruid dwelling near thereabouts, whilst *Abury* was his cathedral.

There are likewise about *Abury* some pyriform barrows, longish, but broad at one end: some compos'd of earth, thrown into a *tumulus*. Of this sort a very long one in the valley from *Bekamton* to *Runway-hill*. Another among the furze bushes south of *Silbury*, set with stones, which farmer *Green* carry'd away. Others made of stones set upright in that form. Of the latter, a very large one in *Monkton-fields*, about 20 stones left on one side. 'Tis directly north of *Abury* town. Another such south of *Silbury-hill*. Another pyriform, made only of earth, under *Runway-hill*. Another on the hill south-west from *Bekamton*, cut through with some later division dike.

The long barrows are what I call archdruids'. There are but few about *Abury* left, and but two at *Stonehenge*. The paucity seems to confirm the notion. One very large at *East-Kennet*, points to *Abury*, but with its lesser

end: no less than 200 cubits in length, which is 350 feet, a huge body of earth. Another not far off points to the snake's head temple, being at a right angle with the former.

By *Horslip-gap* is another considerable long barrow of a large bulk, length and height: it regards the snake's head temple, tho' here not in sight.

By *Bekamton* cove another, a vast body of earth, as thick as the *vallum* of *Abury*, and points to the cove hard by; which shews that cove to be as a chapel. Another large round barrow near it.

In *Monkton*, west of the town, is a large and flat long barrow, set round with stones, which I have depicted in [plate XXX](#), 'tis just 120 cubits long, 30 cubits broad in the broadest end. It stands due east and west, the broadest end eastward. Its breadth the fourth part of its length: a most magnificent sepulchre, and call'd *Milbarrow*.

But even this is much exceeded in south long barrow, near *Silbury-hill*, south of it, and upon the bank of the *Kennet*. It stands east and west, pointing to the dragon's head on *Overton-hill*. A very operose *congeries* of huge stones upon the east end, and upon part of its back or ridge; pil'd one upon another, with no little labour: doubtless in order to form a sufficient chamber, for the remains of the person there buried; not easily to be disturbed. The whole *tumulus* is an excessively large mound of earth 180 cubits long, ridg'd up like a house. And we must needs conclude, the people that made these durable *mausolea*, had a very strong hope of the resurrection of their bodies, as well as souls who thus provided against their being disturbed.

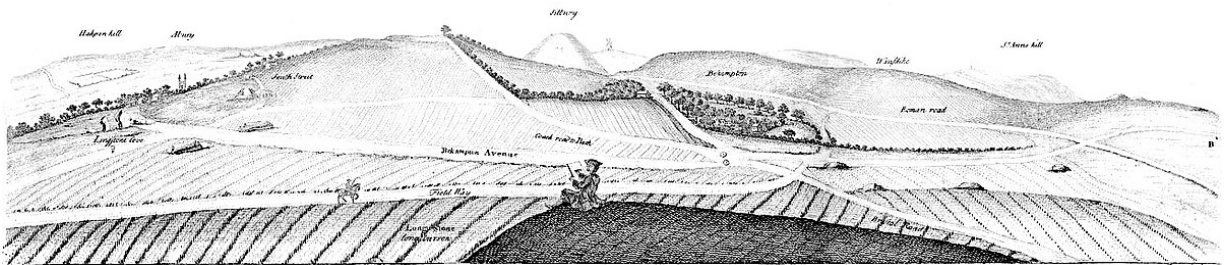
Upon the heath south of *Silbury-hill*, was a very large oblong work, like a long barrow, made only of stones pitch'd in the ground, no *tumulus*. Mr. *Smith* beforemention'd told me, his cousin took the stones away (then) 14 years ago, to make mere stones withal. I take it to have been an archdruid's, tho' humble, yet magnificent; being 350 feet or 200 cubits long.

Pausanias in Eliac. II. writes, upon the bank of the river *Cladeus* is the barrow of *Ænomaus*; of earth, incompass'd with stones. Again in *Arcadic*. he says, at *Pergamus* is the monument of *Auge*, being a barrow of earth, incompass'd with a circle of stones. In the same *Arcadic*. Book VIII. he says, he studiously contemplated the *tumulus* of *Æpitus*, because *Homer*

makes mention of it, admiring it, for he had seen no finer. 'Twas made of earth not very large, incompass'd with a circle of stones. Thus naturally does a genius admire works of antiquity! he seems thereby to antedate his own being, and to have lived in those times long before. He writes again *in Bæot.* at the barrow of *Amphion* are many rude stones, which they report, were the stones he drew together with his harp. Likewise there are three rude stones near the tomb of *Melanippus*; and the antiquarians say, *Tydeus* was buried there.

To go much higher in time, and equal to those we have been describing: *Genes. xxxv. 20. Jacob set a pillar upon Rachel's grave.*

TAB. XXIV.
P. 46.



Stukeley delin.

Toms Sculp.

Prospect of Bekampton Avenue from Longston long Barrow 1724.

⊙⊙ *Two Stones of the Avenue at the Crossing of the two Roads demolish'd by R^d. Fowler. B. the Termination of the avenue.*

CHAP. X.

Of the arch-druid's house on Temple-downs, his barrow. Of their places of judicature, and execution. Another Druid's house call'd old-Chapel towards Winterburn-basset. Another under the Hakpen-hill, over Kennet avenue. Another at Bekamton. Another under Runway-hill. A Kist-vaen in Monkton-fields. Another in Clatford-bottom by Marlborough. Some general reflexions. They must have been a very great and learned people, that made this work of Abury. The parish of Abury now comprehends many townships, taken in by the extent of the snake. A notion of the snake, and its sacred quality retain'd by the people, reporting no snake will live within this tract. A conjecture concerning the time of founding this temple, which carries it up to the time of Abraham, or very near it; deduc'd from the variation of the compass observ'd there. A mathematical designation of the termination of Bekamton avenue. The major part of Virgil's fifth Æneid is a description of like anniversary games celebrated here, in old times.

THERE is still another of these long archdruids' *tumuli* at *Abury*, which leads me to describe a kind of ancient monuments which I meet with here, and near *Stonehenge* and elsewhere; which I take to be houses of the Druids, or their courts of judicature, or both. The principal of them here, is a remarkable thing, upon the *Hakpen-hill* east of *Abury*, near a mile, between it and *Rockley*. That part of the downs thereabouts is called *Temple-downs*, and the thing is called *old Chapel*. Lord *Winchelsea*, Lord and Lady *Hertford* and myself were curious in observing it, *July 6, 1723*. 'Tis a large square, intrench'd, 110 druid cubits by 130, like a little *Roman* camp, with one entrance on the south-west side, towards *Abury*: for it is posited with accuracy, (as all these works are) from north-east to south-west. The situation of the place is high, and has a descent, quite round three of its sides; the verge of the descent inclosing it like a horseshoe. The entrance is on the side next *Abury*, on the isthmus of the peninsula (as it were,) on the

shortest side of the square, the south-west. It is made of a vallum and ditch; beyond that, a row of flat stones set quite round and pretty close to one another, like a wall. Beyond that, another lesser ditch. There are stones too set on each side the entrance. On the north-west side is a large long barrow 50 cubits in length, with two great stone works upon it. One on the end next the great inclos'd place, we have been describing: another stonework towards the other end; which seems to have been a semicircular cove, or *demi-ellipsis* consisting of five great stones; a *Stonehenge* cell in miniature, but now in ruins. This probably gave the name of *old Chapel* to the place; the barrow likewise has been set quite round with great stones.

In the second stone-work, one stone lies flat on the ground, along the middle line of the barrow. On each side a flat stone stands upright, and two flat stones stand upright at right angles, as wings to 'em. Upon them I suppose other stones were pil'd as a *kist-vaen*. Here probably lies the body of the interr'd. The stones are generally very large, about ten feet long.

The whole I take to have been the palace and interment of an arch-druid, and his tribunal or seat of justice. 'Tis posited exactly enough south-east and north-west. The learned Mr. *Rowland*, who wrote the history of the *Isle of Mona*, describes just such works as this in that place, and calls them houses of the Druids.

This place stands near a great cavity call'd *Baltimore-pond*, which seems to have some regard to this work. 'Tis a pyriform concavity, set with stones on the inside. It answers exactly to *old chapel entrance*; and the people have a report that there is a vault under it. One would be tempted to think it was a prison, and the pond was the place of executions, being form'd theatrically. Otherwise it might be a place of sports and spectacles. 'Tis 150 cubits broad, 180 long, form'd like an *Amazonian* shield.

In a valley between here and *Rockley*, are nine round barrows of different bulk. And upon all the highest ground thereabouts are an infinite quantity of immense stones, or sarsens, or gray weathers, some of as large dimensions as any at *Abury*, and lying as thick as leaves in *autumn*. Some upon the very surface of the ground, some half sunk in; and many deep holes whence stones have been taken, are visible.

If we descend the *Hakpen-hill*, westward from hence towards *Winterburn-basset*, upon the declivity of the *Hakpen*, is another Druid's

house, called too *Old Chapel*. 'Tis a square, double ditch'd, but small ditches, in the middle a broad oblong square bank. Before it a sort of court, nearly as big as the other. Near it, they say, they have found much old iron and pewter. It seems to have been set round with stones.

There is another of these places in a delightful circular hollow, under the [*Hakpen-hill*](#), on the west side, hanging over *Kennet* avenue, just 180 cubits square. It lies on a northern declivity, for coolness as one may judge. The entrance is in the middle of the lowest side. But toward the upper side is another lesser oblong square, what we should call a *prætorium* in a *Roman* camp. And to this there was a distinct entrance on the south. 'Tis plac'd exactly north and south.

In *Bekamton* town, near the termination of *Bekamton* avenue, or the snake's tail, is such another place, call'd *Old Chapel* or *Chapel field*. 'Tis full of great stones, many buried under-ground. *Richard Fowler*, that great depopulator, told me, he demolished one stone standing near the hedge of the pasture. Near it a great stone lies upon the mouth of an old well, as they say, but never remember that it was open, only speak by tradition. This field belongs still to the church.

There is another very pretty place of this sort (for ought I know) between the *Wansdike* and *Via Badonica*, running up [*Runway-hill*](#). 'Tis a charming pleasant concavity. An oblong square, with another lesser, as a *prætorium* within. In the *vallum* are many gaps at equal intervals. You will see a large part of it in plate XI. called the model of a camp. 'Tis abusing our time to be tedious, either in descriptions or enquiries, about these matters, of which 'tis scarce possible to arrive at any certainty at this time of day. The pleasure arising from them, is in being upon the spot, and treading the agreeable downy turf, crowded with these antiquities; where health to the body and amusement to the mind are mingled so effectually together.



Stukeley delin.

The Snakes tail.

In *Monkton-fields*, directly north-east from *Abury*, is a monument of four stones, which probably is a *kist-vaen*. I have exhibited a print of it in [table XXXVII](#). These seem to be what Mr. *Edward Llwyd* calls *Kromlechon*, or *bowing-stones*. I believe it was a sepulchral monument, set on a barrow, tho' chiefly now plow'd up; and that the great covering-stone is luxated.

Table [XXXII](#), [XXXIII](#), [XXXIV](#), are views of another eminent work of this sort, in *Clatford-bottom* between *Abury* and *Marlborough*, which require no further description.

[Table XXXV](#), two old *british* urns found at *Sunbury* by the *Thames*, shewn at the antiquarian society some years ago. The inscription on the monument of *Chyndonax*, an archdruid among the *Gauls*, of which a large account publish'd in *french*. Father *Montfaucon* questions the genuineness thereof, but I think his objections are trifling.

In [table XXXVI](#), I have etch'd the bit of the king's bridle found in *Silbury-hill*, the founder of *Abury*, in my possession. Underneath is the *british* urn which I dug up in a barrow on *Windmill-hill* north of *Abury*. This plate is consecrated to the memories of Sir *Robert Halford*, knight, and *Charles Tucker*, Esq; who were very solicitous in preserving these noble antiquities.

I have given the reader as plain and as concise a description of these works about *Abury*, as I possibly could. We cannot but make this general reflexion upon the whole: 1. That this temple, with the things belonging to it, when in perfection, must have been the work of a very great and learned people. The kind, manner, and idea of it, shews its extreme antiquity. When we view the ruins of *Rome*, of *Greece*, *Egypt*, *Syria*, *Persia*, or the like, we readily enough enter into a notion of the wisdom and flourishing estate of the people that performed them. The like we must do of these *british* Druids. These very works justify the high reports made concerning them in classic authors. And if we pretend to oppose them by other reports out of like authors, concerning the rudeness and barbarity of the old *Britons*; the answer is obvious. They speak of different times, or perhaps of different people, new successions from the continent, that drove out the former possessors who performed these works, more northward and westward. The works themselves are an evidence of the genius of the founders. Learning commonly arrives at its height within no long space of time. These works here have a notorious grandeur of taste, a justness of plan, an apparent symmetry and a sufficient niceness in the execution: In compass very extensive, in effect magnificent and agreeable. The boldness of the imagination we cannot sufficiently admire. When this whole *area*, which is about four miles square, was entirely sacred ground, under the care and custody of the Druids, one of their great seminaries or academies, every where a fine turf, cover'd over with an infinite variety of barrows, it was a most agreeable scene, and merely a picture.

When one traverses about this ground, an intelligent person will discern abundance of remarkable beauties in the manner and disposition of the temple. The wise Druids knew the internal meaning and purport of this great symbol of the fecundity of the deity, first exerted in producing the second person represented thereby, who with them was the creator of all things. From the supreme proceeded the divine essences equal to himself; but the son of the supreme formed the material words, whence call'd the *mind*, the *creator*, and the *wisdom of the father*, both by the Druids and us christians. And never since the creation, was so magnificent an idea form'd in mortal minds, as this hieroglyphic here before us made in stone-work. This snake of ours may be near three of our common miles in length, justly laid down, its proportions adapted to nature, its sinuosity well represented in huge curves running contrary ways, conduced over several elevations and

depressions of ground. Two hills, one on each side the stream running from *Abury* to *Silbury*, hide the view of the avenues from each other. So that probably the vulgar then knew not the true figure of the whole, no more than now. But those that approached this place with a purpose of religion, and that understood the mystical meaning thereof, must be extremely affected with it; the greatest picture, no doubt, on the globe of the earth, naturally exciting in their minds that disposition proper for those approaches!

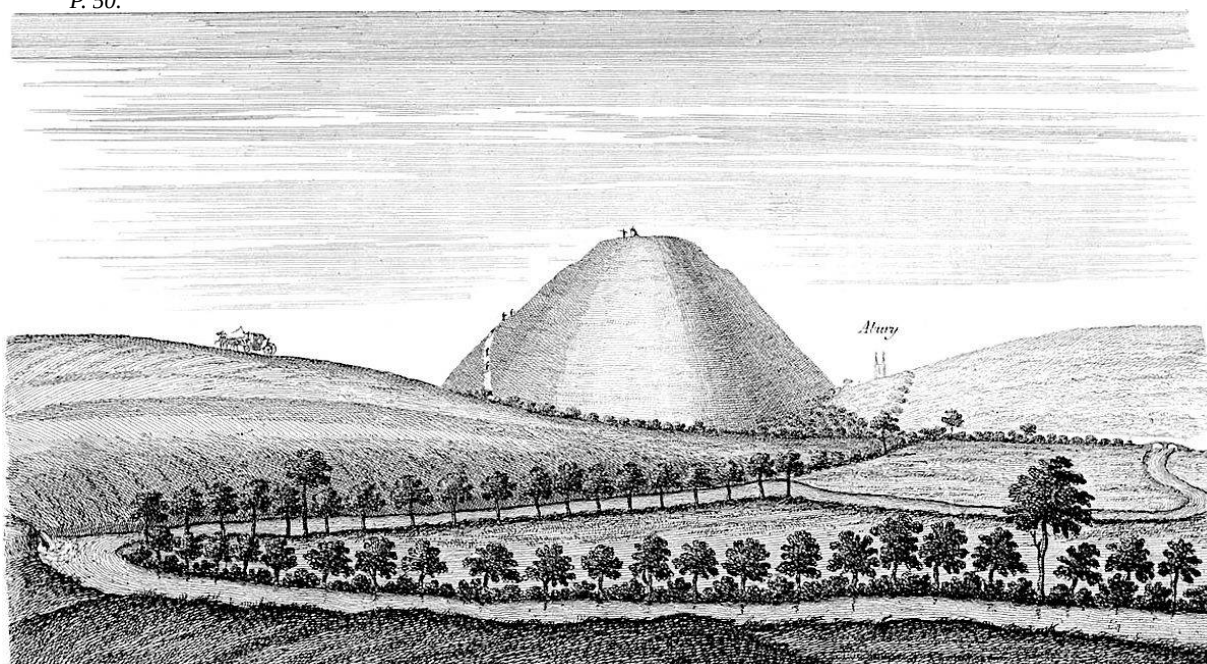
2. I observe that *Abury*, even now, lays its claim to all the old appendages: the bounds of the parish taking in chiefly all that the snake reaches, and the environs, as *Southstreet*, *West-Kennet*, and *Bekampton*, and part of *Winterburn-basset*, and *Stan-more* south of *Winterburn-basset*, (they say it has been a town;) and *Overton-hill*, *South-downs*, *West-downs*, *Cheril-hill*, almost to *Oldbury-castle*.

3. I remark, tho' the people know nothing of the figure of a snake made by the two avenues, yet a notion has been handed down from all times, that gives an obscure hint of the thing, and of the prophylactic virtue in this figure of the snake. For they say, that in all this trail of ground, which we may call the *sacred field*, there never was a snake seen; and if a snake should be brought hither, it would not live. Nevertheless snakes abound in all the country round, even to *Clatford*, between *Marlborough* and here, but never come higher up. This notion, I know not whether 'tis justly founded, but 'tis deeply rooted in the mind of the inhabitants. *Pliny* has a great deal about the Druids' fondness of snakes, but a little unintelligible, as we find most of what authors have said concerning them. And we must be content at this time, to mark out some obscure traces of things that seem to our purpose, relating to this affair of theirs, which shall be the subject of the next chapters.

4. When we contemplate the manner and disposition of our temple, in regard to its parts in the circle at *Abury*, and in regard to its position upon the cardinal points, some questions arise in our mind, which we desire a resolution of: Concerning which I believe the hints following will give us some satisfaction. Ever since the world began, in building temples or places of religious assemblies, they have been studious in setting them according to the quarters of the heavens. For they consider'd the world as the general temple or house of God, and that all particular temples should have a proper

regard to it. The east naturally claims a prerogative, where the sun and all the planets and stars arise: this therefore they accounted as the face and front of the world, or universal temple. The north then was consider'd as the right-hand and great power of the world, the south as the left-hand or lesser power. For when the sun approaches the northern region, passing over the vernal equinoctial, he brings plenty, and the fulness of his fructiferous influence; when he returns to the south, the face of nature languishes in its winter attire. Therefore they thought the polar region not only highest, but of most eminence and effect.

TAB. XXVI.
P. 50.



Stukeley delin.

Toms sculp.

A prospect of Silbury hill from the spring head of the Kennet River. 13. May. 1724.

Whence *Orpheus*: “Thou who holdest the scepter of the pole, venerable on many accounts, the throne of the world in the north.”

Psellus says, “the *Pandochean* power of the world reigns in the north.”

Hence *Plutarch* writes, “That *Xenophon* says of the *Egyptians*, they thought that part where the sun rises was the face of the world; the north was its right-hand, where the *Nile* rises its left.” And this helps us to explain several *Egyptian* antiquities.

But to apply this to our purpose. We cannot but observe, that the whole of *Abury* temple, or *Mausoleum*, regarded as a picture, has its upper part to the north, and its face (if we may so speak) toward the east. Thitherward the serpent goes. That way the cove of the northern temple opens; that way the cove of *Bekampton* avenue; that way the face of *Stonehenge* temple looks. So that the Druids appear to have the same notions with the other wise men of the oriental ancients.

This therefore shews the reason why they set their temples fronting the east, in all antiquity, and why the coves of our works look that way. As to the two temples at *Abury*, the northern and southern, included in the great circle, it should seem that the northern one had the preeminence, and was the more sacred of the two. As the cove was the *adytum* of that temple, so the whole northern temple may be esteem'd as the *adytum* of the whole work, the southern being as the body of it. *Solomon's* temple, we know, consisted of three parts: the *adytum*, or *holy of holies*; the *holy place*, or *sanctuary*; the *porch*. By this means there is a conformity between it and *Abury*; and to *Stonehenge* likewise, which has an elliptic *adytum*, a circular or outer part, and the *area*. Doubtless the different order of priests, and of religious offices, took up these different parts. And, if we may give our opinion, 'tis natural to think, that because the ring-stone is by the southern temple, there the sacrifices were offer'd and administer'd by the lesser orders of priests, around the *ambre* or central pyramidal. The highest part of religion was to be perform'd by the archdruid and the upper order of priests before the magnificent cove of the northern temple, together with hymns, incense, musick, and the like.

5. In my account of *Stonehenge* I suggested a surmise, that the Druids, in laying down these works of theirs, used a compass or magnetic instrument; whence I founded a conjecture concerning the time of building that temple, by observing the variation with a theodolite. As the variation in all the works about *Stonehenge* is between six and seven degrees to the east of the north, I found it at *Abury* to be about ten degrees the same way, and as precisely as possible. This will necessarily excite one's attention, as there is less reason to suppose 'tis accidental. The whole work was manifestly design'd to be set on the cardinal points of the heavens, but they all vary one way, exactly the same quantity; and 'tis impossible to account for it in any wise, but that they us'd a magnetic instrument. This is the reason that

the neck of the snake on *Overton-hill* crosses the *Roman* road running east and west, which would otherwise have been the ground-line of this work.

Thus *Kennet* avenue enters the town of *Abury* ten degrees north of the north-west point, which north-west point was the Druids' purpose. The neck of the snake going down from *Overton-hill* regards *Silbury* precisely, and their intent was that it should be full west, but 'tis ten degrees north of the west. The meridian line of the whole work passes from *Silbury-hill* to the center of the temple at *Abury*, this varies ten degrees to the east from the north-point. The stupendous cove in the northern temple opens ten degrees east of north-east. It was their purpose that it should regard the north-east. The diameter of the great circle of the great stones at *Abury*, on which the north and south temples are built, was design'd to have been set on the line from north-west to south-east, but it verges ten degrees northward; and so of all other particulars. And by this very means we may, at any time, point out the line of the termination of *Bekampton* avenue, tho' entirely destroy'd. For from *Silbury-hill*, it was design'd by the Druids to have been set full west, as *Overton-hill* full east. Therefore a line mark'd from *Silbury-hill*, ten degrees north of the west point, and at the proper length of the avenue, being 4000 cubits, an eastern mile, determines the spot where *Bekampton* avenue ended. That spot is south of the square inclosure going up to *Cheril-hill*, where *Silbury-hill* bears ten degrees south of east, where *Abury* steeple bears twenty-five degrees west of south-west. From [Silbury-hill](#) you mark it by the line that goes to *Oldbury* camp, on the left hand of *Cheril-hill*. In that line was the termination of *Bekampton* avenue; it being the intention of the Druids to place the founder's *tumulus* or *mausoleum* of *Silbury-hill* in the middle, between the two ends of the avenue, the head and tail of the snake, upon the east and west line, and exactly south of the center of the great circle at *Abury*. This whole work therefore was properly the *mausoleum*, or made, as it were, one *tumulus* over the founder. A prophylactic form'd by the great symbol of the deity, guarded the ashes of the deceased hero. And from this custom in mythologic times, they invented the notion of a snake being the genius of departed heroes; or of such being turn'd into snakes and the like, as is said of *Cadmus*, and many more.

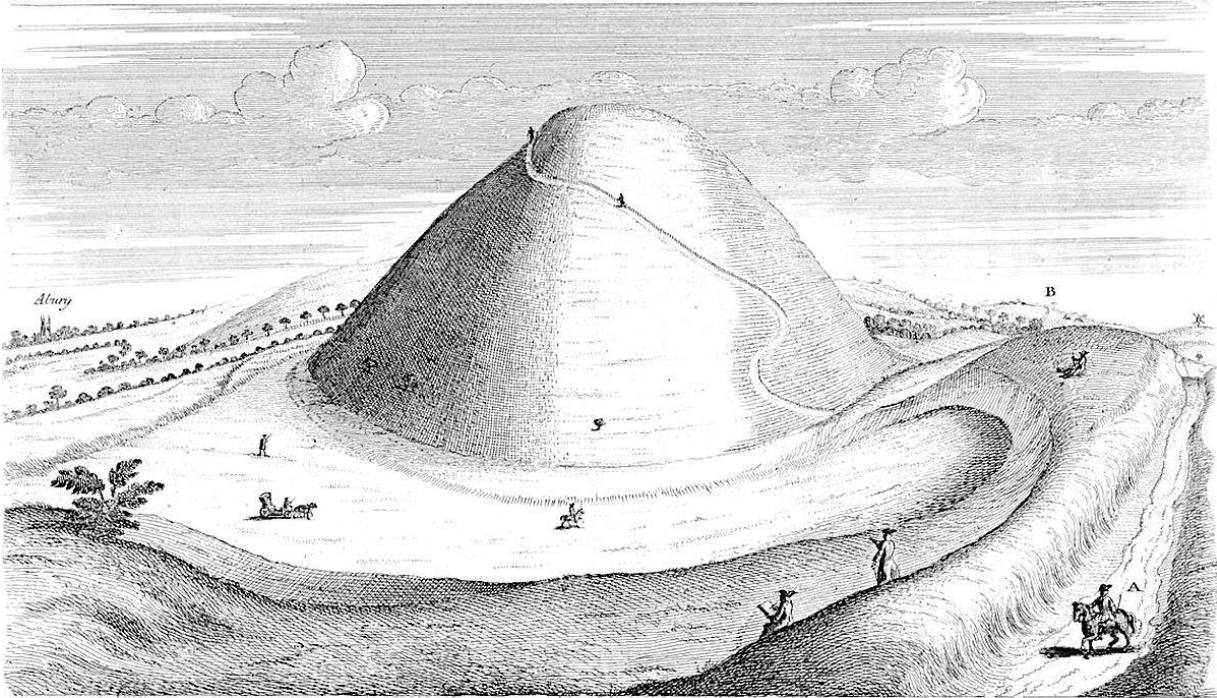
Thus *Virgil* describing *Aeneas* celebrating the anniversary of his father's death, at his *tumulus* in *Sicily*, recites the ancient rites practis'd at these places and on these occasions, and introduces a snake creeping out of the

adytum of the *tumulus*, passing by the altars and holy utensils, and retiring again, in *Æneid* V.

———*Adytis cùm lubricus anguis ab imis*
Septem ingens gyros, septena volumina traxit,
Amplexus placidè tumulum——— &c.
Hoc magis inceptos genitori instaurat honores,
Incertus geniumne loci, famulumne parentis
Esse putet———

Much might I recite to our purpose out of the ancient commentators on this passage, to which I refer the inquisitive. From the word *adytis* we may be apt to conclude the tomb of *Anchises* had a cove built upon it, as that we describ'd at [Rowldrich](#). But to return.

I apprehend the reader will scarce excuse me, if I make not some inference from that observation of the variation of the needle here from the cardinal points. Indeed in these works of antiquity, I would be as temperate as possible in multiplying conjectures; and to nothing more can I pretend in this case, and that too but in gross, for we want sufficient *data*. A future age may pronounce with more certainty, when we know the entire revolution of the circle of the magnetic variation.



Stukeley d.

A. The Roman road. B. the Snakes head or hakpen.

Dr. *Halley* supposes the whole period is perform'd in about the space of 700 years. I am sufficiently satisfy'd from considering the different effect of the weather between *Abury* and *Stonehenge*, the great diversity in the manner of the works, and some other considerations, that *Abury* must be above 700 years prior in time to *Stonehenge*. But if we take two entire revolutions, 1400 years, and set it 460 years before the christian *æra*, the supposed time of the building of *Stonehenge*, it brings us, in *Usher's* chronology, which, I take to be the best, to the year of the death of *Sarah*, *Abraham's* wife, which happen'd in the summer time of the 1859th year before Christ. This was a little before the time of *Inachus*.

By the best light I can obtain, I judge our *Tyrian Hercules* made his expedition into the ocean, about the latter end of *Abraham's* time: and most likely 'tis, that *Abury* was the first great temple of *Britain*, and made by the first *Phœnician* colony that came hither; and they made it in this very place on account of the stones of the gray-weather, so commodious for their purpose.

Usher makes this retirement of the *Hycsi*, or royal pastors out of *Egypt*, which was done by our *Hercules*, to be 34 years after that date. But my

numbers make it somewhat later.



Tho. Robinson ALBURIAE Jerostratus

CHAP. XI.

This second sort of temples made by the circle and snake, was call'd in very old times, Dracontium, and not understood. The first temples made in form of the symbol of the deity. Why mankind should make the serpent the symbol of the deity? Of symbols in general. Their antiquity and use. It was the first kind of writing, even antediluvian. The serpent of high account from China to Britain. Of the nature of the serpent. The extraordinary beauty of the creature. Its wonderful motion without legs, thought to be like that of the gods. The wisdom of the serpent consider'd. Symbolically understood. Its bifid tongue the symbol of eloquence. Its enchanting power real. By the eyes, by the ears. Whence emblematic of the preachers of the gospel, and of our Saviour himself. On these, and many other accounts, esteem'd a divine animal, and chosen to symbolize the first begotten son of God, or first product of the divine fecundity.

2. *Of the nature of the formation of symbols. The serpent a prophylactic symbol. Of the brazen serpent, typical of our Saviour. Of the emerods of the Philistines, whence the Phalli of the heathen. A serpent the symbol of Messiah in many views.*

IN my description of *Abury*, and its parts, I endeavour'd to make every thing as plain as I could from fact and view; but now we come to our speculative part, I can only propose to entertain, perhaps, the reader's curiosity, with what light I could gather from ancient learning concerning it.

We have seen by our description, that the plan on which *Abury* is built, is that sacred hierogram of the *Egyptians*, and other ancient nations, the circle and snake. The whole figure is the circle, snake, and wings. By this they meant to picture out, as well as they could, the nature of the divinity. The circle meant the supreme fountain of all being, the father; the serpent, that divine emanation from him which was called the son; the wings imported

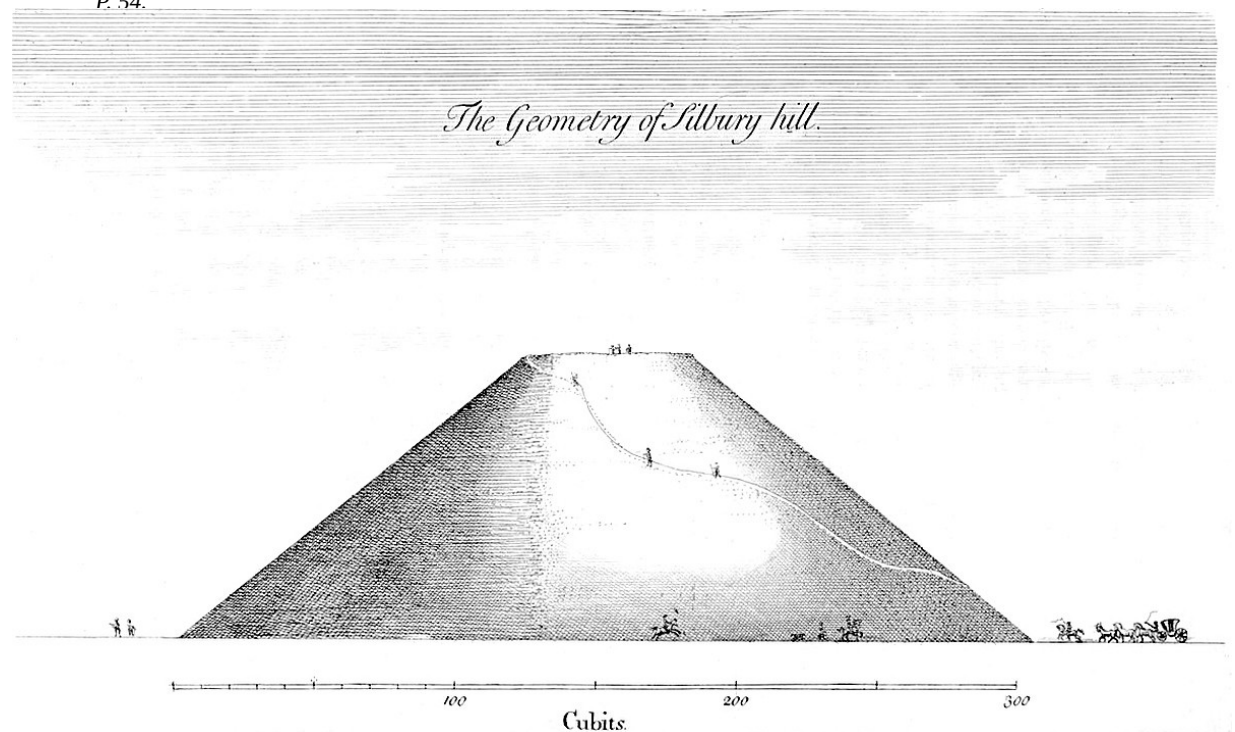
that other divine emanation from them which was called the spirit, the *anima mundi*.

This is that figure which *Kircher* names *ophio cyclo-pterygomorphos*, and discourses largely of. But that we may have a better understanding of it than hitherto has been, we shall open our mind concerning this abstruse matter by degrees.

Dracontia was a name among the first learned nations, for the very ancient sort of temples, of which they could give no account, nor well explain their meaning upon it. *Strabo* XIV. this was a name of this kind of patriarchal temple, of which *Abury* is one, deduc'd to later times, whilst the thing itself, and manner of building, was disus'd and forgot.

TAB. XXVIII.

P. 54.



Stukeley f. 1723.

The Geometry of Silbury hill.

Servius on the second *Æneid*, writes, “*anguis* is a proper name of the water-snake, *serpens* of the land, *draco* of those belonging to temples.” By which, ultimately, our representations must be meant, tho’ probably by the author not understood, as having no acquaintance with our kind of works. But it unavoidably brings to our mind the temples of the ancients kept by

dragons, which we so frequently meet with in classical history. And we may well presume they mean such temples as this of *Abury*, *Dracontia*.

“The serpent,” says *Maximus of Tyre*, *Dissert.* 38. “was the great symbol of the deity to most nations, and as such was worshipped by the Indians.” The temples of old made in the form of a serpent, were called for that reason, *Dracontia*. The universality of this regard for serpents, shews the high antiquity of the symbol, and that it was antediluvian.

To give us light into the affair, first it will be convenient to discourse a little concerning the nature of the serpent, and why mankind should make it a symbol of divinity. For it looks a little strange, after our first mother was seduc’d from her innocence, by the devil under this form, that so high a regard should be paid to it.

The first learning in the world confided chiefly in symbols. The wisdom of the *Chaldeans*, *Phœnicians*, *Egyptians*, *Jews*, of *Zoroaster*, *Sanchoniathon*, *Pherecydes Syrus*, *Pythagoras*, *Socrates*, *Plato*, of all the ancients, that is come to our hand, is symbolic. “It was the mode,” says *Serranus*, on *Plato’s Symposium*, “of the ancient philosophers, to represent truth by certain symbols and hidden images. It leads us gradually, sweetly, yet most efficaciously, towards the contemplation of the first being, which is the end of all philosophy and theology.” We may add, it was the method of ancient divines too, from the beginning to our Saviour’s time. No one cultivated it more than he, in all his sermons and discourses, which were affecting, well wrought up, lively, apposite, entertaining in the highest degree. Some of them complete *dramas*. And in general, we must conclude, it gives a beautiful gloss and amiable face to truth.

That the Druids studied in this enigmatic and symbolic way, appears from what we are writing upon; and *Diogenes Laertius*, in his proem, affirms it of them. He ranks them with the *Magi*, *Chaldeans*, and *Gymnosophists*, gives some of their doctrines, and makes them rather ancients than the *Egyptians*, meaning the learned among the *Egyptians*. He says, “the *Gymnosophists* are descended of the *Magi*, and some affirm the *Jews* too.” He means the ancestors of the *Jews*, *Abraham* in particular. I believe, Druids, *Chaldeans*, *Gymnosophists*, and *Egyptians*, all descended, or rather disciples of the *Magi*, who were the first and patriarchal priests after the flood. *Sanchoniathon* calls *Shem* (as I take it) by the name of

Magus, as the prince of the order. He says the *Egyptians* veil their doctrines under the figure of beetles, *snakes*, birds, and other animals. And it seems to be the origin of animal worship in *Egypt*. Thus *Gale*, in his *court of the gentiles*, P. I. p. 64. again P. II. p. 35. “the ancient mode of expressing things worthy of memory, by hieroglyphic forms, notes, and symbols, was very common amongst the ancients, in the oriental parts especially, both poets and philosophers; and exceeding proper for that infant state of the world, wherein knowledge was so imperfect and impolite. And we need no way doubt but that this symbolic kind of discourse, or language, had its original from the divine œconomy which God prescribed in his infant church, consisting of many terrene images and sensible forms, symbols and types, for the shadowing forth highest contemplations and heavenly mysteries. Which way of conveying and preserving knowledge is not only helpful to the memory, grateful to the fancy and judgment, but also very efficacious for the moving of the affections.”

A symbol is an arbitrary, sensible sign of an intellectual idea. And I believe the art of writing at first was no other, than that of making symbols, pictures, or marks of things they wanted to express. So that every letter was the picture of an idea. This was the first and antediluvian way of writing, before alphabet writing was invented. This latter was a postdiluvian invention, in my opinion. The reasons I shall give on another more immediate occasion. *Servius*, on the *Æneid* V. *septem ingens gyros*, speaking of the snake encompassing *Anchises*’s tomb, writes, that this method was prior to alphabet-writing. I believe the *Chinese* method of writing to be the antediluvian one; and the like, perhaps, may be affirmed of the *Egyptian* hieroglyphics. The *Egyptians* had the good sense, when alphabet writing was communicated to them, to embrace it, tho’ the *Chinese* will not. Still the *Egyptians* retain’d a particular veneration for their former method, and dedicated it to sacred uses altogether.

This symbol of the snake and circle, which is the picture of the temple of *Abury*, we see on innumerable *Egyptian* monuments. Always it holds the uppermost, the first and chief place; which shews its high dignity.

Mr. Selden, upon the *Arundel marbles*, p. 132, says, “this figure in abbreviated writing, among the *Greeks*, signifies *Δαίμων*, the *deity*.” 

And Kircher, in his third tome, affirms the like of the *Brachmans* of the *East-Indies*.

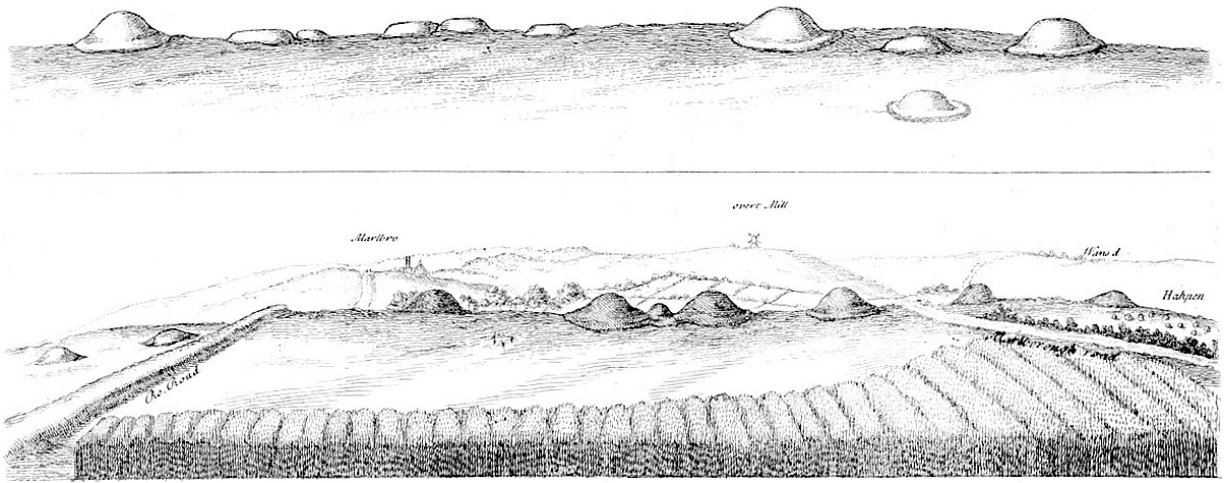
I can by no means admit it to be an *Egyptian invention*. The *Egyptians* took this, and hieroglyphic writing in general, from the common ancestors of mankind. This is sufficiently prov'd from the universality of the thing, reaching from *China* in the east, to *Britain* in the west, nay, and into *America* too.

Nothing of so high account among the *Chinese*, as the representation of dragons and serpents, as we see in all their pictures and utensils; nay, the very stamps upon their ink. 'Tis the genial banner of their empire. It means every thing that is sacred among them. In baron *Vischer's* elegant book of ancient architecture, Tab. XV. you have the picture of a *Chinese* triumphal arch (of which there are many in the city of *Pekin*) twice upon it is pictur'd, in a tablet over the front, a circle and two snakes, as on *Egyptian* works. They adorn their temples, houses, habits, and every thing with this figure, as a common *prophylaxis*. I apprehend it was from the beginning a sacred amuletic character. 'Tis carv'd several times on the cornishes of the temple (I take it so to be) of *Persepolis*, as we see in Sir *John Chardin*, *Le Brun*, *Kæmfer*. Dragons were the *Parthian* ensigns, from whom the *Romans* in later times took them, and our *saxon* ancestors from the *Romans*. 'Tis a known verse in the satyrist,

Pinge duos angues, sacer est locus.

The Druids had no less a veneration for it, as we find by *Abury* and by their fondness of snake stone beads and the like, which *Pliny* calls snakes' eggs, and discourses on, largely, in relation to our Druids.

A Group of Barrows on the side of the valley above Beckampton



A Group of Barrows upon Overton hill

Here we see the sacred regard paid to snakes from *China* to *Britain*. Still as we before suggested, it appears somewhat strange, when we consider that the patriarchs, of whose age and times we are now chiefly treating, were not ignorant of the evil deriv'd to mankind thro' this creature.

We may satisfy our selves about this difficulty, by considering, 1. the natural history of the serpent, and 2. the nature of forming of symbols.

First, the natural history of this animal. Can we divest our selves of original prejudice, we must allow the serpent kind, as to their outward *appearance*, among the most beautiful creatures in the world. The poets, those great masters of nature, are luxuriant in their descriptions of them, comparing them to the most glorious appearance in the universe, the rainbow. Thus *Virgil Æneid V*.

*Cæruleæ cui terga notæ, maculosus & auro
Squamam incendebat fulgor; ceu nubibus arcus
Mille trahit varios, adverso sole colores.*

Thus *Lucan*,

Serpitis aurato nitidi fulgore dracones.

——*cristis præsignis & auro.*

Ignem micant oculi—— Ovid. Met. 3.

Of *Cadmus's* snake.

Hephæstion II. writes concerning the *Hydra* of *Hercules*, that half his head was of gold. I saw a snake of such exquisite beauty in *Surrey*. The motion and the appearance or bright golden colour, being so like to angelick, seraphick beings; no wonder the ancients conceiv'd so high a regard for the serpent, as to reckon it a most divine animal. There is a kind of them bred in *Arabia* and *Africa*, of a shining yellow colour, like brass, or burnish'd gold, which in motion reflects the sun-beams with inconceivable lustre. Some of them are said to have wings, called *Seraphs*, *Saraphs*, *Seraphim*, mention'd *Deut.* xii. 15. this is the name given to the brazen serpent. And equally to the angels and celestial messengers, who are described of this appearance, in scripture. So the cherubim that supported the *Shechinah* in *Ezekiel* i. 7. “sparkled like the colour of burnished brass.” The divine appearance between the candlesticks in *Apocalypse* i. 15. “His feet were like to fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace.” Hence his ministers are called a flame of fire. *Psalms* civ. 4.

Secondly, consider the *motion* of a serpent, 'tis wonderful; perform'd without the help of legs, nay incomparably quicker than their kindred of the crocodile and lizard kind, which have four legs: 'tis swift, smooth, wavy, and beautiful. The ancients conceiv'd it to be like the walking of the gods; whence the notion of deify'd heroes, with serpents' feet. *Pherecydes Syrus* says, the gods have snakes' feet: meaning their motion was smooth and sweeping, without the alternate use of legs.

Heliodorus III. speaks of the wavy motion of the gods, not by opening their feet, but with a certain aerial force; it was call'd *incessus*. *Non ambulamus, sed incedimus*, says *Seneca*.

Ast ego, quæ divûm incedo regina, Jovisque

Et soror & conjunx—— Virg. *Æn.* 1.

Et vera incessu patuit dea.

So the prophet *Ezekiel* describes the motion of the alate globes under the cherubims' feet; as it ought to be understood, *Ezek.* i. 12. *Sanchoniathon* the *Phœnician* in *Euseb. p. e.* I. 7. writes, that the nature of serpents is divine. "'Tis the most spiritual animal of all and fiery; that it performs all its various motions by its spirit, without other organs;" and much more of this kind, to our purpose. *Jerem.* xlv. 22. The shout and the march of an army is compar'd to the motion of a serpent.

Thirdly, from the form, pass we to the *mind* of the serpent, if we may be allowed so to talk. The wisdom of this creature is celebrated from the time of creation itself. *Moses* writes, it was more subtle than any other creature, *Genes.* iii. 1. Our Saviour recommends to the ministry, to imitate the prudence of serpents, as well as the innocence of doves: he makes it the symbol of Christian prudence. The psalmist compares the slyness of the wicked to the serpent, which refuses to be charmed. *Aristotle* writes, that this animal is very crafty; but if we inquire into authors, concerning this wisdom of the creature, nothing occurs satisfactory: in truth 'tis figurative and symbolical; meaning the charm of rhetorick and oratory, taken from the divided tongue of this creature, and more especially regarding the preachers of evangelical truths: διγλωσσία among the antients was prudence. Our Saviour in the forecited place of the apocalypse, is represented with a two-edged sword in his mouth, meaning the efficacy of preaching. The people affirmed, "never man spake like this man;" and he sent the divine spirit of eloquence and languages upon his apostles, in the likeness of cloven tongues of fire.

Servius on the second *Æneid*, speaking of the tongue of *Laocoon's* serpent,

Sibila lambebant linguis vibrantibus ora,

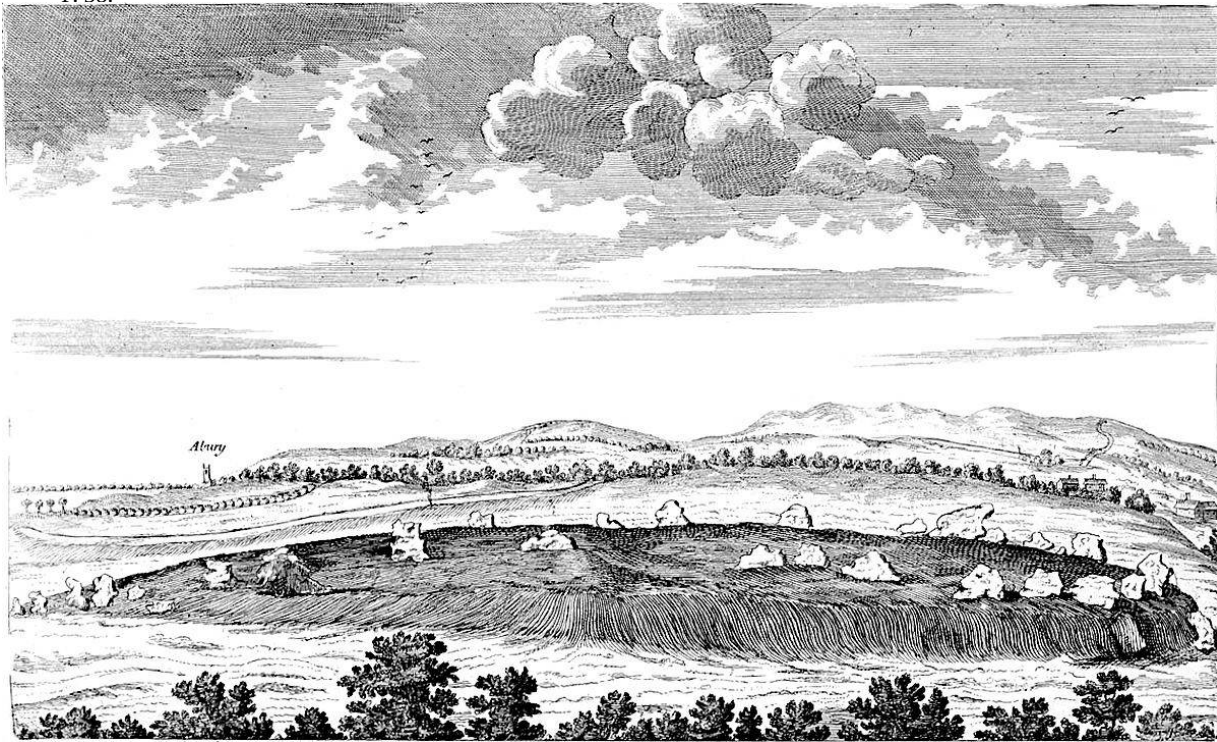
tells us, no creature moves its tongue with so much swiftness; so that it seems triple.

——*tresque vibrant linguæ*——

Says *Ovid* of *Cadmus's* snake.

The tongue was the only active arms of the apostles, as the bifid tongue of the serpent is its only weapon; and which, as the ancients thought, carried life and death with it.

From the numerous and credible accounts I have seen, snakes, I am persuaded, have a power of charming, by looking steadfastly with their fiery eyes, on birds, mice, and such creatures as they prey upon. They are put into such an agony, as to run by degrees into their open mouth. Further, snakes were thought to have an enchanting power, not only with their eyes, but likewise by whispering into the ears: for by that whispering they communicated a prophetick and divine spirit. The scholiast of *Euripides* writes, of *Helenus* and *Cassandra*, that serpents licking their ears, so sharpened their hearing, that *they* only could hear the counsels of the gods; and became great prophets thereby. This incantation by the ears, is elegantly apply'd by the fathers, in their writings, to the preachers of the gospel, and to our Saviour himself. *Clemens in pædagog.* V. calls him Επωδός the inchanter, as the learned *Spanheim* observes: and often St. *Chrysostom* uses the like expression.



Stukeley del.

Milbarrow in Monkton 215 f. long 55 broad set round with great Stones, the broad end Eastw^d. the narrow end W. drawn 10 July 1723

All these put together, I take to be some good reasons (to omit several more for brevity's sake) for the extraordinary veneration paid to this creature, from all antiquity. Our oldest heathen writer *Sanchoniathon* says, the *Phœnicians* call'd it *agathodæmon*, the good angel. *Epies* the *Phœnician* in *Eusebius* pronounces it a most divine animal. *Maximus* of *Tyre* before quoted writes, that the serpent was the great symbol of the deity, in most nations, even among the *Indians*. *Sigismund* in his *Muscovite*-history, says the like of the *Samogitians*, in the northern parts of that vast empire. *Gaguin* in his *Sarmatia*, of the *Lithuanians*. So *Scaliger* in his notes on *Aristotle* of animals, concerning the people of *Calicut* in the *East-Indies*; all books of travels into the *West-Indies*, the like. This sufficiently proves the notion nearly as old as mankind.

From these notions in antiquity, arose the strange humour of the ophite sect or heresy, who affirm the seducer serpent was the son of God. *Epiphanius*, *Tertullian*, *St. Augustin* and others speak of it. They kept a serpent in a box and worshipped it.

2. We are to consider the nature of forming of symbols. The serpent simply, as it was curs'd of God, and composite, as hanging on a tree, was symbolical of Christ: according to the sense both of *Jewish* and Christian writers.

We have seen the serpent in very advantageous light, which was in order to remove our prejudice, by the high notion its natural history presents us, to which much might have been added. But this is not necessary in the formation of symbols, for if we should think this a mean and contemptible animal, unworthy to convey to us so great an idea, I answer, it was one of the arts of the inventors of symbols and emblems, to picture out the highest things by what we may esteem the lowest subjects: a beetle, for instance, is the symbol of no less than what the heathen call *anima mundi*; and to picture out the greatest good by its contrary. Just as *Isaiah* in the prophetic style calls that most excellent prince king *Hezekiah*, by the name of dragon, basilisk, cockatrice, and fiery flying serpent, xiv. 26. This is understood not in regard to any pravity of his own disposition, but in regard to the enemies of God's people, to whom he was as a dragon, a divine avenger against enemies, a protector of his own. Again consider the serpent as a prophylactick symbol, and the highest of sacred characters, thought most effectually to guard against and drive off all evil power. It was the method in making these prophylactick symbols, to take the figure of the thing we want to remedy. A most remarkable and apposite instance of this nature, is the famous brazen serpent erected by *Moses*, being suspended on a cross-pole, like that on which military banners are hung. They that were bitten by the fiery serpents, were order'd to look on this, and be whole. So that manifestly the symbol is to excite faith and obedience. They are the proper cure, not the intrinsick efficacy of the symbolical figure, *Wisd.* xvi. 6, 7.

All writers *Jewish* and Christian with one mouth assert, this was a type of the Messiah. *Philo* is in a rapture about it; supposes somewhat extraordinary, future, is meant thereby. *Rabbi Moses Gerundinensis* writes thus. "It seems to me, concerning this mystery, that 'tis agreeable to the course of the divine law, as to miraculous works, that the mischief should be remedied by a thing similar to that which caus'd it." And it makes the miracle more illustrious and divine, that God should direct a snake to cure those bitten by snakes.

Others of the rabbin are of the same way of thinking, as *David Kimchi*, *Michlol* II. And *Abarbenel* upon the place, f. 305. And *Nachmanides*. Our Saviour applies the *Mosaic* serpent directly to himself; no wonder then that the Christian fathers do so. *Christus veluti serpens in cruce pependit*, says St. *Ambrose*. *Moebius* treats largely of this resemblance between *Christ* and the serpent, *exercitatio de æneo serpente*, p. 63. Highly honour'd was the serpent, that, as it had been the instrument of introducing the greatest evil to mankind, to it was directed God's word when he promised to us the greatest good, the Messiah, imply'd in those words, *Gen.* iii. 15. He *shall bruise thy head*: αὐτός in the LXX.

Another like case is that in 1 *Samuel* v. the ark of God was taken captive by the *Philistines*, and they dar'd to look into the venerable secrecy thereof. The nation was smote in the hinder-parts, the organs of generation, which the scripture modestly calls *emerods*, *hæmorrhoidals*. Moreover a terrible pestilence killed many, and a plague of mice at harvest-time came upon them, and devoured all the fruit of their ground. In order to make an atonement, they sent away the ark again, with golden figures of the emerods and mice, a present accompanying of costly jewels, as a consecrated λούτρον, or satisfaction to the God of the *Jews*. Here, by the way, we should be blind if we did not see the origin of the *phallus* among the heathen.

Therefore to apply this. In regard to the seeming difficulty we at first took notice of, paying such a regard to an animal which the ancestors of mankind had so much reason to detest. Did the devil injure us under the form of a serpent? The like figure is the properest of any to symbolize the remedy, the antidote against the poison whereby the devil wrought man's fall. Therefore, naturally, the same is to symbolize the Messiah then promised, who is to work man's redemption. And St. *Athanasius*, Tom. II. *quæst.* 20. scruples not to make a comparison between the union of the serpent and the devil, in the fatal temptation; to the union of the divine and human nature in our blessed Saviour. The venomous serpent is his human nature, sinful, infected by the devil's treachery; *he was made sin for us*, tho' not contaminated himself. Tho' not venomous, he cures the venom of our nature. I observe that the *rabbies*, tho' they saw sufficiently, how necessarily the *Mosaic* serpent was applicable to the Messiah, yet they were somewhat fearful therein, and of speaking their mind upon it, for fear of

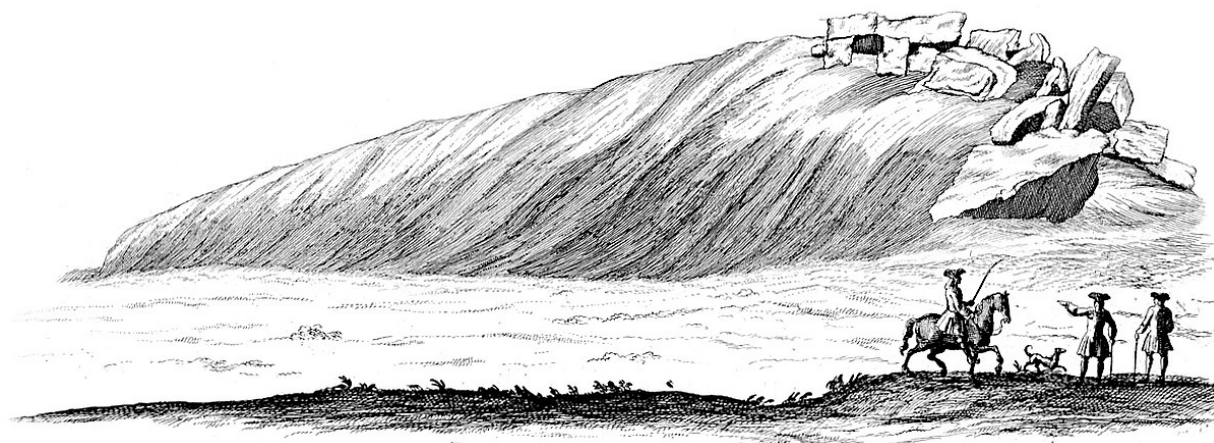
doing ill, in comparing him to an accursed animal. But our Saviour himself was not fearful in comparing himself to it, and the rather on that account, took it for a very express type of his crucifixion, and of his being accursed for our sakes, *Deut.* xxi. 25. *John* iii. 14. *Galat.* iii. 13, *i. e.* devoted as a sacrifice, an expiation, that we being freed from the curse of sin, might obtain the blessing of God. So our Christian writers explain the type between our Saviour and the brazen serpent in the wilderness. *Bede* in particular, on *John* iii. And here we see the nature of types, where a man that undergoes the curse and punishment of the law, becomes in reality a type of the Messiah. A serpent which pictures out the evil principle, the like, *2 Cor.* v. 21. Assuredly *Moses*, by the holy Spirit, meant it to regard Christ's crucifixion. A fit emblem of his divinity, thro' that remarkable quality of their throwing off old age with their skin, and returning to youth again. For so the ancients thought:

Anguibus exuitur tenui cum pelle vetustas. Tibullus.

A fit emblem of his resurrection from the dead, and of returning to an immortal life.

TAB. XXXI.
P. 60

The Long Barrow S. of Silbury Hill.



An Archdruids barrow.

No wonder then, from such reasons as these, and others as obvious, the ancients concluded this to be the most divine of all animals, and thought it the aptest symbol of the *Νοῦς ἕτερος*, the other, or second mind of *Plato*, whom they affirmed to be the creator of the world. I know not whether this

notion of theirs did not farther contribute to it; they thought these animals brought forth by the mouth. They have too no limbs, or members for action, but exert their mighty power by the mouth only; whence *Horus Apollo* says, “a serpent is the symbol of the mouth.” This well represents the omnific WORD, which *Suidas* speaks of from *Trismegistus*, all perfect, fruitful, the workman, creator of the world.

CHAP. XII.

The second sort of temples called Dracontia, like that of Abury, have been built frequently in old times. The traces of them pursued. Part of the history of Phut, third son of Cham. A genealogy of the most ancient sacred and heathen families. Phut had a fleet of ships upon the Mediterranean. The Typhon, Typhis, Python of antiquity, called Apollo Pythius after death. He was a builder of these serpentine temples. Like the emperor Augustus in countenance. He erected the first patriarchal temple at Delphos, a Dracontium. Parnassus originally Larnassus, which is no other than our Hakpen of Abury. The sabbath observed there originally. Ææas, a son of Phut's, built the Dracontium at Colchis. Perseus, another son of his, bore the sacred hieroglyph, the circle, snake, and wings, in his shield; whence the Medusa's head.

Zoroaster Magus, in Euseb. p. e. II. 7. Plato, Porphyry, and others of the old philosophers, define God to be every where and no where, who fills all space, and is contain'd in none; "from whom came all things that are, and which are not yet; eternal, immutable, omnipresent, incomprehensible, immaterial, without parts, beginning or end." If we put this definition into a geometrical figure, in order to form a symbol, we cannot possibly do it better than by describing the circle. A circle then in hieroglyphics means, divine; but particularly, as it is the most perfect and comprehensive of all geometrical figures, they design'd it for the symbol of the first and supreme being; whose resemblance we cannot find, whose center is every where, and circumference no where. It well pictur'd out, as Abenephi the Arabian and others assert, the divine nature of God.

Therefore this figure of the serpent and circle in their doctrine, aptly means the divine creator, or the creator descended from the supreme. For tho' the deity was author of all things, yet more immediately this SON or WORD of the supreme was the architect of the universe.

And this we find exactly consonant to the scripture doctrine. So that it seems very evident to me, the most important of divine truths admitted in the christian church, were imparted to the first race of mankind, the patriarchal church, which two are in reality but the same.

We learn repeatedly from *Sanchoniathon*, *Porphyry*, and other ancient authors quoted by *Eusebius* in the *præparatio evangelica*, that the first sages of the world had just and true notions of the nature of the deity, conformable to those of the Christians: That, in their hieroglyphic way of writing, they design'd the deity and the mysterious nature thereof, by the sacred figure of the circle, snake, and wings. Of these, the circle meant the fountain of all being, the invisible supreme, who had no name. The serpent symboliz'd the son, or first divine emanation from the supreme. This they called by the name of *Ptha*, which is deriv'd from the *hebrew*, meaning the WORD. The wings symboliz'd that divine person or emanation from the former, commonly called *anima mundi*, but the *Egyptians* called him KNEPH, which in *hebrew* signifies winged.

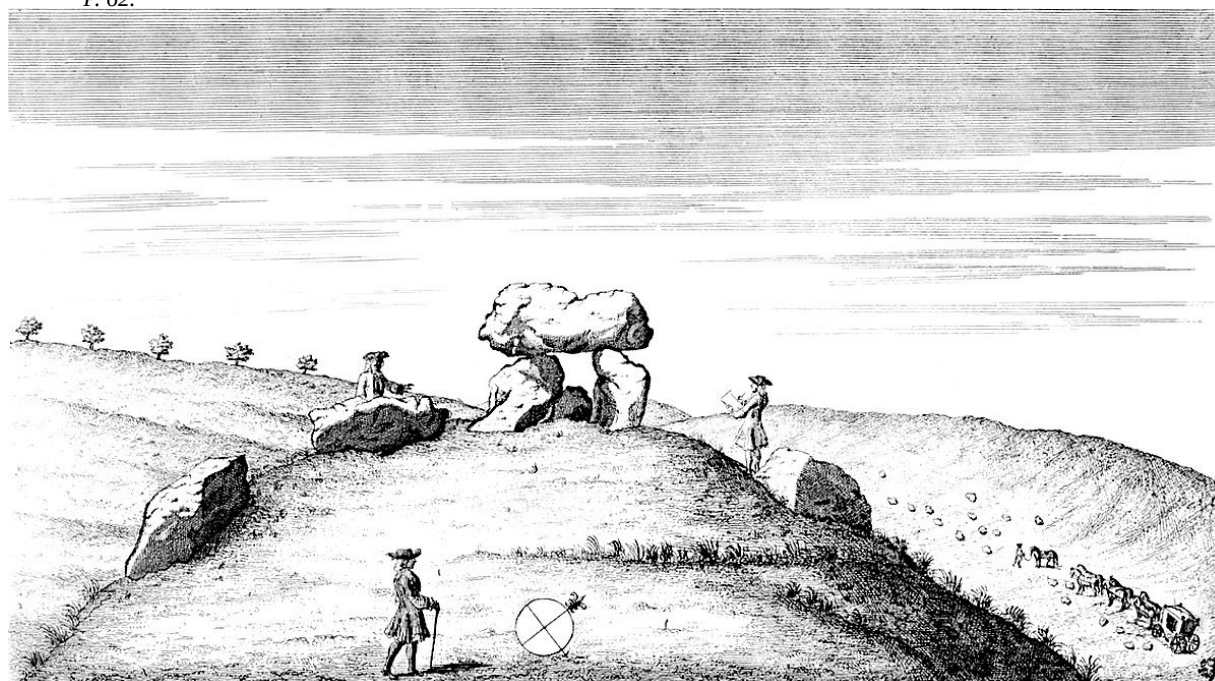
Thus the old authors that speak of these things are to be understood, though they are confus'd, not rightly apprehending the bottom of the matter. And this hieroglyphic figure, in the whole, was call'd *Knephta*.

But this knowledge of the nature of the deity, the most valuable *depositum* which could be communicated to mortals, was first perverted into idolatry; therefore God almighty forbore revealing himself further on that head, in an explicit manner, 'till the fulness of time arriv'd, the Christian dispensation. But those people who preserv'd themselves from idolatry, among which I reckon our Druids, retain'd that knowledge thereof which had already been imparted, of which this sacred figure of the alate and serpenterous circle was, as it were, a seal; which they stamp'd upon these most lasting monuments, their temples. And I doubt not but they somewhat improv'd the notions they had thereof, by reasoning, in the manner I shall speak of [Chap. XV.](#)

Abury is not the only temple in *Britain* form'd on this design of the circle and serpent. I saw another at *Shap* in *Westmorland*, when I travell'd thro' the place, *anno* 1725, with Mr. *Roger Gale*. But I had no opportunity of examining into it.

There is another, as I take it, at *Classerness*, a village in the island of *Lewis*, between *Scotland* and *Ireland*. I took a drawing of it from Mr. *Lwydd*'s travels; but he was a very bad designer, and having no knowledge of the purport, makes the representation still worse. The circle to which it belongs is 20 cubits in diameter. There is a central obelisc. A part of the snake remains going from it, which he calls an avenue. He did not discern the curve of it, no more than that of *Kennet* avenue, which he likewise has drawn in the same collection, as a straight line. It seems to me that the circle was double, or two concentric. I shall print it in the succeeding volume.

TAB. XXXII.
P. 62.



Stukely delin.

Harris sculp

View of the Kist-Vaen in Clatford bottom.

No doubt but there are more in the *britannic* isles. I propose in this chapter to deliver my notions concerning them in the more eastern parts of the world, of which are many traces in ancient writing; avoiding prolixity as much as possible.

The practice of building these serpentine temples was us'd by the patriarchs, perhaps near the beginning of the world. I have some proof of their being ancients than the flood; but shall not at present insist on it. The first person I shall take notice of on this account is *Phut*, a brother of *Canaan*, son of *Cham*. *Phut* was a person of much greater eminence in

antiquity, than vulgarly thought. But would we know anything of the particular memoirs of this man, or of any other his relations and coevals, we have nothing left us for it but heathen story.

Tho' the *Phœnicians*, and our Druids, as well as the *Egyptians* too, had the earliest use of alphabet writing, yet none of these nations have transmitted to us any memoirs of themselves. And for what little knowledge we have of them, besides their monuments, we are altogether indebted to the *Greeks*, that receiv'd these arts from them. They happily improv'd art and science, sculpture and writing, so as to hand down to us most of the ancient history we know, beside the bible. Still this misfortune attended them, that they improv'd the symbolical method of writing, which they learn'd from the *Phœnicians* and *Egyptians*, to that monstrous pitch, as to produce what we call by the general name of *mythology*. It was but very late that they came to write true history: so that the whole of the ancient history of the nations they write of, is envelop'd in this perplexing mythology.

Yet we should be highly to blame, if we absolutely neglected it. 'Tis all we can have of prophane antiquity. 'Tis more commendable for us to study to extricate it from its symbolic mystery, and find out the open truth. Those that have succeeded best therein, find much agreement between it and the scripture history, as far as they are concurrent.

'Tis from this mythology, chiefly, that I can pretend to discourse any further, concerning these great works I have been describing. I shall endeavour to do it with all the brevity and perspicuity possible, as becomes such sort of discourses. Yet I despair not of finding out a good deal of true history. I shall not answer for all. And a great deal of candour is necessary in the reader, if he would have either pleasure or instruction in it. Yea, says a predecessor in these kind of inquiries, Dr. *Dickenson*, *Delph. Phœnic*. "if we look over the *greek* mythology with proper sagacity, we shall easily discover many footsteps of true religion."

"A fable is an artificial discourse, consisting of the marvellous, and a philosopher, in some sort, is a lover of such," says the great philosopher, *Metaphys*. I. 2.

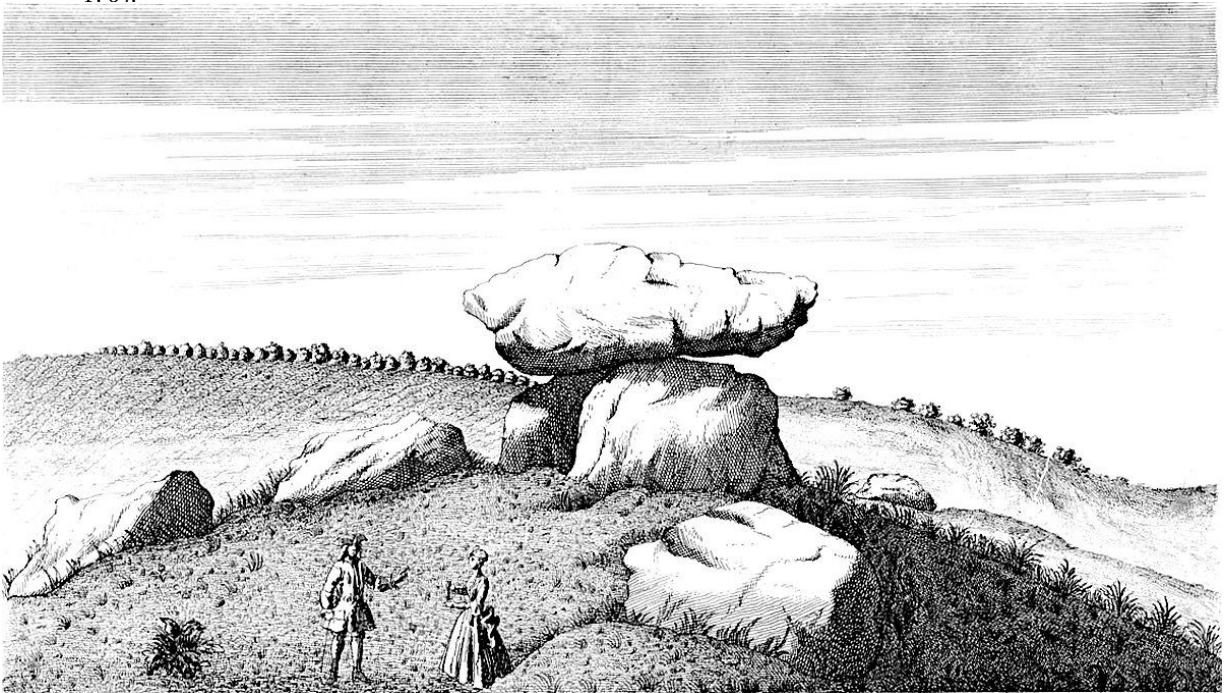
There are vast treasures of ancient knowledge in mythology, especially of history both sacred and civil. 'Tis all that we have left of heathen history of the most ancient times, and 'tis worth our while to shake off the rubbish,

and pick out the useful part. The learned labours of *Bochart*, *Selden*, *Marsham*, *Huetius*, *Gale*, *Cumberland*, *Banier*, and many more, shew us its utility. And we must pardon them if, in some things, they have gone beyond the golden medium, we ourselves will be content to err somewhat with those great names.

Phut, son of *Cham*, was a person of eminence, tho' not taken notice of so much as he deserves. I think it much to our purpose to recite some part of his history. He is the *Apollo* mention'd by *Sanchoniathon*, son of *Cronus*, who is *Cham*, as is demonstrated beyond doubt by bishop *Cumberland*, in his posthumous works; he is said to have been born in *Peræa*, i. e. the country towards the *Euphrates*: his third son; as likewise deliver'd by *Moses*. From the word *Phut*, he was called *Python*, by a little transposition natural in pronouncing a difficult name; and, by a like transposition, *Typhon*.

Apollo Pythius was the son of *Ammon*, that is *Cham*, says *Lucius Ampelius*, in *libro memoriali*. *Plutarch de Isid. & Osir.* writes, that *Typhon* was brother to *Osiris*, who was undoubtedly *Misraim*, son of *Cham*. The like by *Diodorus Siculus*.

To facilitate the understanding of antiquity, I here present the reader with a genealogical table of the great personages we are going to treat of. I could produce the evidences that prove each particular descent, in a strictly heraldical way, but it would now take up too much of our time.

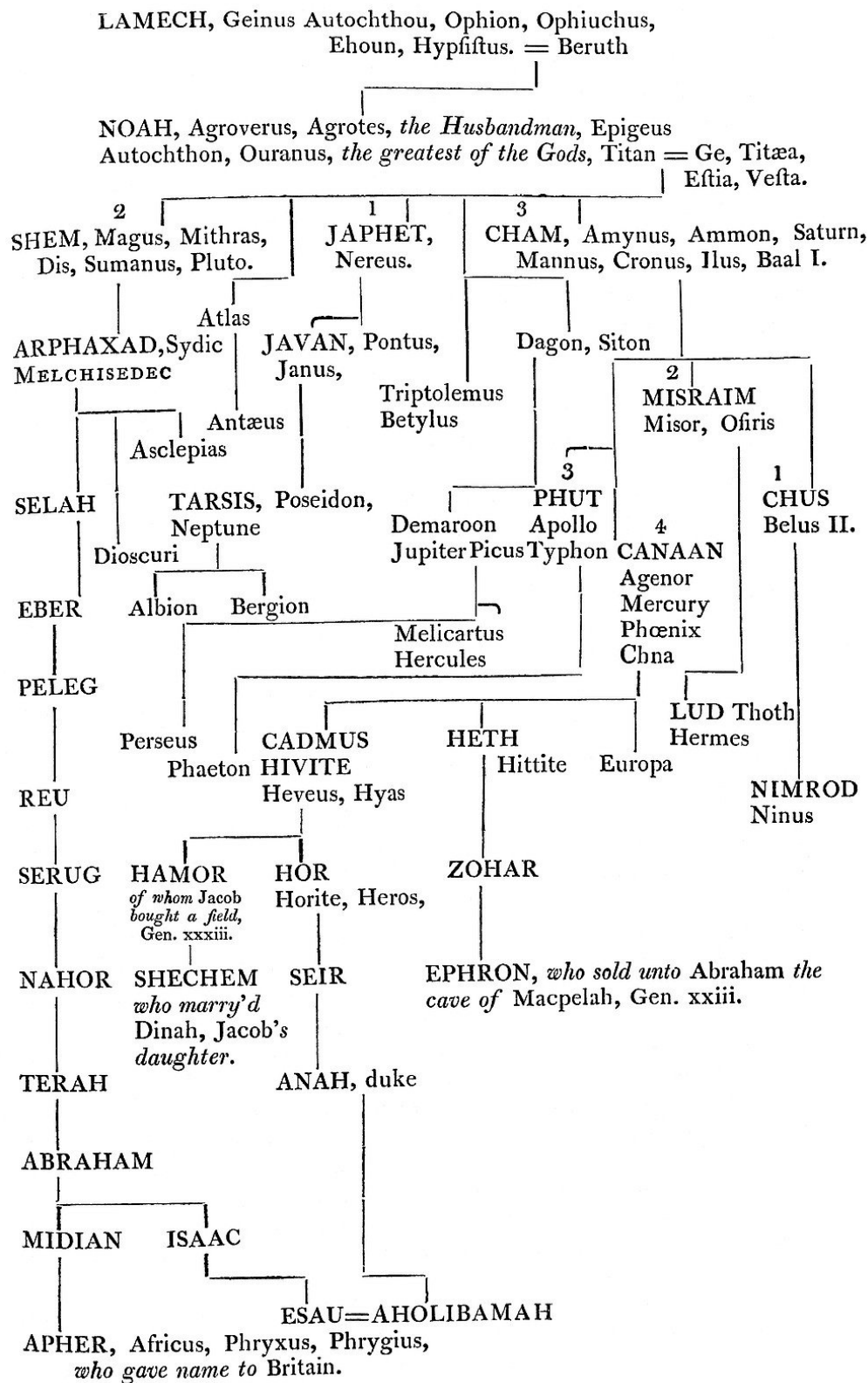


Stukely delin.

Harris Sculp.

North-East View of the Kist-Vaen in Clatford bottom. 1. July. 1723.

D E S C R I B E D.
The **G E N E A L O G Y.**



Phut was the first most celebrated navigator of antiquity, built a fleet of ships, began to carry colonies into the countries on the *Mediterranean* sea.

Strabo in IX. tells us the history of him from *Ephorus*, a very ancient historian. He says *Phut* or *Apollo* travell'd the earth, and came to the rude inhabitants of *Parnassus*. His business was to bring men to civility and manners, to use corn for their food.

Pindar writes of him,

——*He travell'd o'er earth and sea, setting watch-towers on hill-tops, among the nations, consecrating temples, and building groves.*

Lycophron mentions *Typhon's* watch-towers in *Arimis*, which probably is the *Peræa* of *Sanchoniathon*, the east part of *Syria*, where *Homer* says the εὐνη, or bed of *Typhon* was, in a field abounding with oaks. 'Tis not unusual for *Apollo* to be represented in the character of a military captain. *Hygin. fab.* 140. And he really was a leader of a vast colony of his people into *Egypt*, then possess'd by his elder brother *Misraim*. Of this more hereafter. Of him speaks *Seneca* in *Medea*,

*Ausus Tiphys pandere vasto
Carbasa ponto, legesque novas
Scribere ventis——*

Again,

Tiphys in primis domitor profundi.

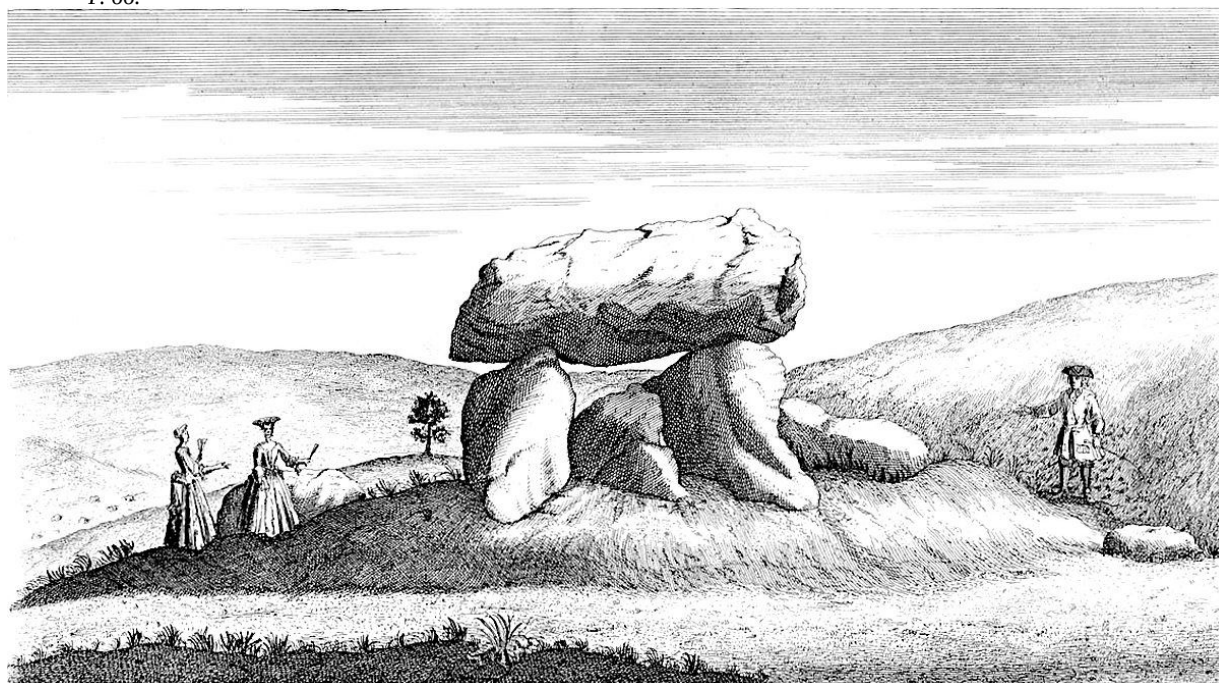
Jerem. xlv. 9. the *Libyans* of *Africa* are in the original *Phut*. The *Lydians* there are the people or posterity of *Lud*, *Thoth*, his brother.

Apollodorus I. 4. writes, that *Elios*, our *Phut*, married *Rhode* daughter of *Neptune*, who was really *Tarshish* son of *Javan*, son of *Japhet*. From her he denominated the celebrated island, where, to his honour, was erected by posterity, the most stupendous statue in brass that ever was in the world, in any metal or other matter; being seventy cubits in height, whence all great statues have been call'd *Colosses*. The *Argonauts* in *Apollonius* I. sacrifice to *Apollo* the patron of navigation; in *Artemidorus*, *Oniro* II. 35. call'd *Apollo Delphinus*; that author says it means *long voyages*. *Pausanias* in *Bæoticis* gives him the same surname. Hence, I apprehend, the *dolphin*, his cognizance, was plac'd in the heavens.

In face, he was like to *Augustus*. I have several *Rhodian* coins in silver and brass, of different sizes, in all which he is pictur'd. Nor need we be scrupulous in thinking them a good resemblance. For the *Telchines*, inhabitants of *Rhodes*, are said to be the first makers of images. And we may at this time of day, have the satisfaction of seeing an infinite number of representations of him, in the coins, busts, and images of *Augustus*, particularly the famous statue of *Apollo* in the *Vatican* garden at *Rome*, made from the emperor's face. Therefore we may well admit of it for the heroical effigies of *Phut*.

Bochart thinks, he fixt his habitation first at *Delos*, and his family, and thence the fable of his being born there. I have an ancient brass coin, with the heroical effigies of his mother *Latona*. Her head in the adverse *IEPA CYNKAEITOC*, reverse, the goddess sitting, a *hasta pura* held oblique in her right hand. $\Lambda\text{HT}\Omega\text{TPI}\Pi\text{O}\Lambda\text{EIT}\Omega\text{N}$.

TAB. XXXIV.
P. 66.



Stukeley delin.

Harris Sculp.

The Kistvaen in Clatford bottom. Jun. 30. 1723 from y^e Northwest

In this island of *Delos* he had a most magnificent temple, built to him in after ages, when idolatry began. The noble remains of it are to be seen there

still. For his great fame and exploits, posterity consecrated him, calling him the son of *Jupiter*, meaning *Jupiter Ammon*, or more properly of *Saturn*.

But in no place was *Phut* more famous than in *Phocis*. He planted the country about the mountain *Parnassus*, where he built, as I apprehend, a great serpentine temple, like ours of *Abury*, at the bottom of that mountain, by the city of *Delphos*. This I gather from the *Greek* reports of the serpent *Python* of an immense bulk, bred of the slime left on the earth, by the general deluge, which *Apollo* here overcame; and instituted annual games call'd *Pythia*, plainly from his own name. These were the first and most ancient games we hear of in *Greece*.

Change the places, *Abury* for *Parnassus*, and we have both the natural, as well as chronological history of the place; a vast temple in form of a serpent, made out of stones left on the surface of the earth after the deluge: not only so but the very name too. The name of *Parnassus* was originally *Larnassus*, says *Stephanus Byzantinus*. The letter L is not a radical in this word, as the learned *Dickenson* observes in *Delphi phænic*. therefore the word is *Harnassus*, *Har* is a headland or promontory of a hill, and *nahas* a serpent, which is no other than our *Hakpen* of *Abury*. Whence we conclude, the snaky temple extended its huge length along the bottom of *Parnassus*, and laid its head upon a promontory of it, just as ours at *Abury*, on *Overton-hill*. Whence *Ovid* not merely poetically, describes it;

——*Tot jugera ventre prementem.*

This was the original patriarchal temple dedicated to the true God, where oracles were originally given by *Themis* says *Apollodorus* I. 4. Which name I take to be a corruption made in after times from the *Jewish Thummim*, for a divine and true oracle; which *Dickenson* asserts to have been at this place, page 104. in time turn'd into an idolatrous one. Many built one after another, as the former ones were sack'd and destroy'd.

The report of the mountain having been call'd *Larnassus*, is another argument of the high antiquity of this first serpentine temple here built by *Phut*, and throws us up to the patriarchal church, and to the times immediately after the great deluge. *Stephanus* of *Byzantium* before quoted, says it: and the interpreter of *Apollonius*, and *Ovid* makes *Apollo's* engagement with *Python* to be immediately after the flood. They pretend

the name *Larnassus* comes from *Larnax*, the ark of *Deucalion* landing here, agreeable to the *Greek* method of drawing all antiquity to themselves.

The central obeliscal stone in some of the circular works here, which was the *Kebla*, as in the southern temple of *Abury*, was afterward, in idolatrous times, worshipped at *Delphos* for the statue of *Apollo*, as *Clemens Alexandrinus* writes, *Strom.* I. 'till art and *Grecian* delicacy improv'd and produc'd elegant images, like that aforementioned of the *vatican*, and innumerable more, still remaining.

In *Vaillant's* colony coins vol. I. page 242. is an elegant coin struck at *Cæsarea*, to the emperor *Antoninus Pius*. On the reverse, *Apollo* standing, leans on a *tripod*, holds in his right hand a snake extended. The learned author is at a loss to explain it, therefore I may be allowed to give my opinion, that it relates to our present subject.

It was the method of the ancient planters of colonies, to begin their work with building temples, I mean our patriarchal temples, for there were then no other. And they instituted festival and religious games, which contributed very much to polish and civilize mankind, and make them have a due notion and practice of religion, without which it is impossible for any date to subsist. Of this *Strabo* writes very sensibly in IX. treating on this very place. The *Pæanick* or *Pythian* are the most ancient games we have any account of. *Strabo* writes very largely concerning them.

These great festivals were at the four solar ingresses into the cardinal signs, which were the times of publick sacrificing, as I suppose, from the creation of the world. The *Pythian* festival was celebrated on the sixth day of the *Athenian* month *Thargelion*, *Delphick Busius*. 'Tis between *April* and *May*.

But we learn, from the scholiast of *Pindar*, *prolegom. ad Pythia*, that *Apollo* instituted the *Pythia* on the seventh day after he had overcome the serpent *Python*; and that at *Delphos* they sung a hymn called *Pæan* to *Apollo* every seventh day. The *Athenians* did the like, every seventh day of the moon, whence *Hesiod's*

Ἐβδόμη ἱερὸν ἦμαρ——

Because, says he, *Apollo* was born on that day.

The learned *Gale* observes from this, in his court of the *Gentiles*, p. 150. that it means the sabbath as the patriarchal custom, before the *Jewish* institution. *Usher* before him, of the same opinion, in his discourse on the sabbath. *Porphyry* in his book concerning the *Jews*, quoted by *Eusebius* *pr. ev.* I. 9. tells us, the *Phœnicians* consecrated one day in seven as holy; he says indeed, it was in honour of their principal deity *Saturn*, as they call'd him, and *Israel*. We are not to regard his reason, any more than *Hesiod's* aforementioned, but his testimony of a matter of fact, has its just weight. He means to prove a custom older than *Judaism*.

I take all this to be an illustrious proof of the patriarchal observation of the sabbath, before the *Mosaick* dispensation. Their sabbath was intirely like our Christian, the greatest festival of all, and deservedly the most to be regarded, as being religion properly, or practical religion.

We cannot easily determine on what day the patriarchal sabbath was kept, *Hesiod's* reason being the birth day of *Apollo*, pleads for Sunday; *Porphyry's* for saturday, consequent to which thus *Martial* XII. 63.

In Saturnum.

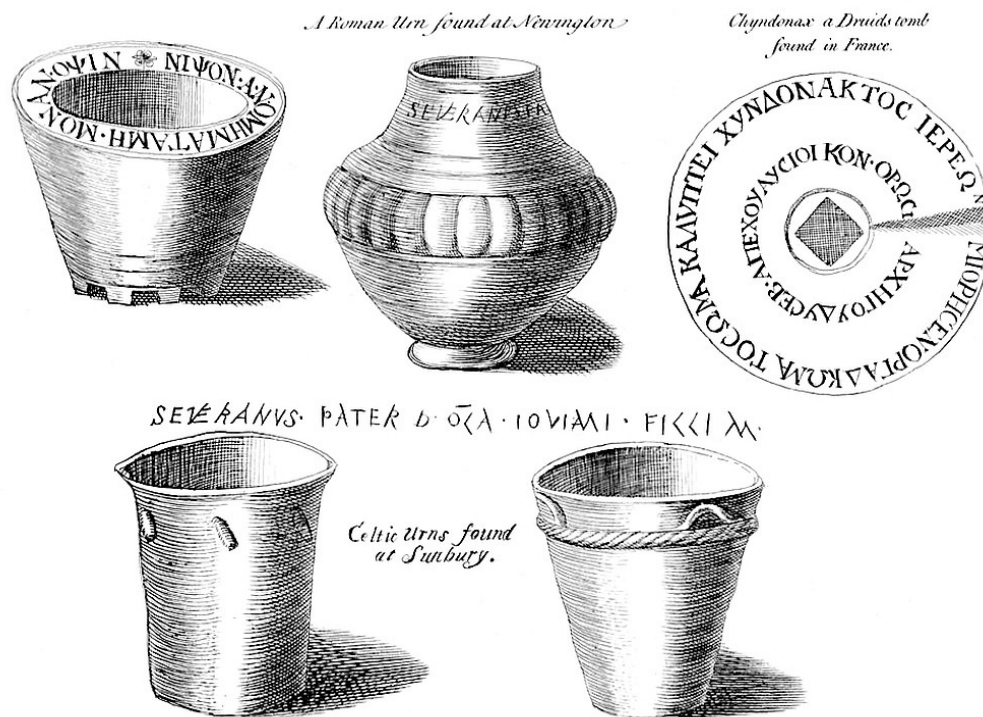
*Antiqui Rex magne poli, mundique prioris,
Sub quo pigra quies, nec labor ullus erat.*

But both shew evidently the antiquity of the hebdomadal division of time, and the planetary names of the week days, and the primæval sabbatical rest. *Pausanias in atticis* writes, at *Megara* was a statue of *Apollo* carrying the *Docimæ* or tithe, another patriarchal usage.

The work of *Phut's* building an enormous serpentine temple, was call'd killing or overcoming the huge serpent *Python*, properly son of the earth.

———*Et te quoque maxime Python
Tum genuit: populisque novis incognita serpens
Terror eras. Tantum spatii de monte tenebas.* Ovid. Met.

Publick sacrifices, games, hymns, a sabbatical observance being there celebrated; we have just reason to think all the like were observ'd by our Druids at *Abury*, especially considering they were of *Phœnician* original.



Stukeley f.

A Roman Urn found at Newington
Chyndonax a Druids tomb found in France.
Celtic Urns found at Sunbury.

To conclude this chapter, this labour of *Phut*'s is told in many places. Some say it was in *Mysia*, in *Phrygia* others, again in *Cilicia*, in *Pithecusa*, in *Bæotia*; *Strabo* xiii. writes, that it was in *Syria*; and there seems to have been a serpentine temple on the river *Orontes* of *Antioch*, for it was call'd originally *Typhon* and *Οφιτης*, as *Strabo* writes, xvi. and *Eustathius* in *Iliad*, p. 262. *Basil.* and in *Dionysium*. The story is of *Typhon* a huge serpent slain there by a thunderbolt from *Jupiter*, near a sacred cave called *Nymphæum*.

The meaning of all this, seems to be, that *Phut* in person, or his people built them in all these places. *Ææas* a son of *Phut*'s, built the serpentine temple at *Colchis*.

Perseus was a son of *Demaroon*, born in *Egypt*, *Euseb.* p. e. II. 1. he was coæval with *Phut*, and bore in his shield the sacred hierogram, and he probably built of these *Dracontia*. From this the poets made their fable of *Medusa*'s head, and that it turn'd men into snakes. *Hesiod* in the description of *Hercules*'s shield, thus paints him in *English*.

“As he went, his adamantine shield sounded, and tinkled with a loud noise. In a circle two dragons were suspended, lifting up their heads.” *Johannes Malala* makes *Perseus* institutor of the *Magi*, who were the patriarchal priests of the east. He calls the river of *Antioch* abovementioned *Dracon*.

CHAP. XIII.

Hercules of Tyre, part of his history. Was a pastor king in Egypt. Retired thence with 240000 men, about the latter end of Abraham's time. The chronology of those pastor kings fixed, somewhat more accurately than in Usher and Cumberland. Hercules king in Egypt, or the Pharaoh with whom Abraham conversed there. He was a very great navigator: a learned prince, an astronomer, a chronologer. The Hercules Ogmius. What the word means. He knew the secret of alphabet writing, and the true length of the solar year. He learn'd probably of Abraham. He carried colonies about the Mediterranean, and into the Ocean, and brought the Druids into Britain. He built many patriarchal temples; some of serpentine form: particularly at Acon in Palestine. He had a son called Isaac. The evidences of Hercules planting Britain. Of Apher his companion, grandson of Abraham, giving name to Britain. Remains of Hercules his people, called Hycsi, in Britain. Hence we conclude our Druids had the use of Writing before Cadmus carried it into Greece.

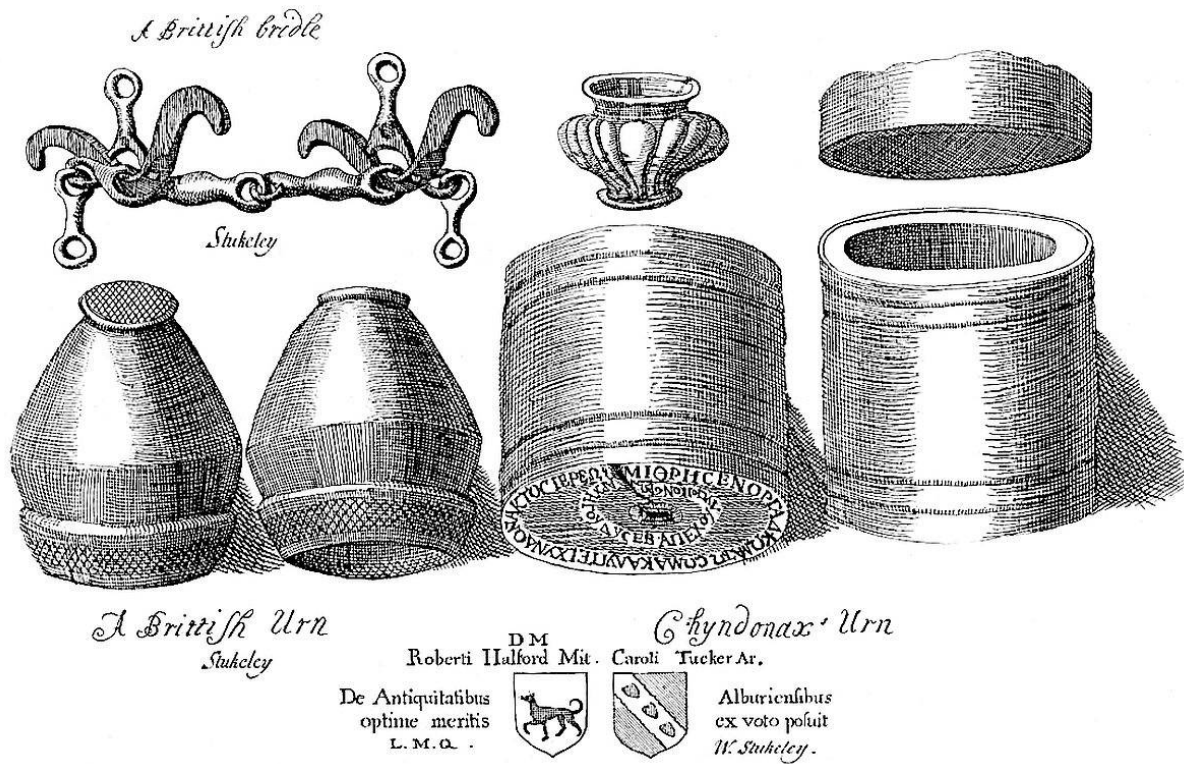
NOT much later in time than *Phut*, lived that other celebrated hero of antiquity, the *Egyptian, Phœnician, Tyrian Hercules*; whom I take to be a principal planter of *Britain*. He was of *Phœnician* extract, born in *Egypt* and king there, founder of *Tyre*, and the most famous navigator: the first that pass'd thro' the *Mediterranean*, and ventur'd into the great *Ocean*. I have wrote his history copiously, from which I must recite some deductions only, useful to our present purpose.

Hercules call'd *Melcartus*, was son of *Demaroon*, as *Sanchoniathon* the *Phœnician* writer informs us. *Demaroon* was intituled *Zeus*, whence the *Greeks* made *Hercules* the son of *Jupiter*. *Demaroon* according to our *Phœnician* author, was son of *Dagon* or *Siton* son of *Ouranus* (who in truth is *Noah*) and begat after the flood, but it was not his business to mention the flood. *Hercules* then may reasonably be suppos'd to live to the same age as *Noah's* other great grandsons; if we say grandsons, it alters not the case. We

need not be concerned at the seeming great distance between *Hercules* in the genealogy and *Apher*: for from *Sanchoniathon* we may prove that *Melchisedec* was *Arphaxad*. He conversed with *Abraham*.

Josephus in his first book against *Apion* has preserv'd a valuable and venerable piece of antiquity, call'd *Manethon*, the *Egyptians' Dynasties*. This has given the learned much entertainment. I have considered it too with attention, in what I have wrote concerning the *Mosaick* chronology. I shall here recite some conclusions from it, for my present purpose.

TAB. XXXVI.
P. 70.



Stukeley f.

A Brittish bridle
A Brittish Urn
Chyndonax' Urn

DM
Roberti Halford Mit. Caroli Tucker Ar.
De Antiquitatibus Alburienfibus
optime meritis ex voto posuit
L. M. Q. W. Stukeley.

The dynasty of the pastor kings is what we are chiefly concern'd in, which belongs to the most early ages after the flood. Sir *John Marsham* has set them too low. Bishop *Usher* and *Cumberland* are much nearer the truth, as I apprehend, and from whom I differ very little. The last of this dynasty of pastors is *Assis*, *Archles*, our *Egyptian Hercules*. They were *Canaanites* that followed *Misraim* into *Egypt*, and at first liv'd very peaceably, but in time the two families quarrel'd, and wag'd terrible wars together, for 200 years. The *Misraimites* possess'd the upper regions of the *Nile*, *Canaanites* the lower or marshy part upon the *Mediterranean* sea, call'd *Delta*. Hence the former call'd 'em *Titans*, i. e. dirty, fenmen, bog-trotters, as we say contemptuously, of a people who are their real descendants. The *Misraimites* call'd themselves the *Elohim*, or Gods, descendants of *Ilus* or *Cham*, and that liv'd, as it were, in a heavenly region, toward *Egyptian Ethiopia*, where *Homer* makes the gods to hold their festivals. So the *Greeks* call'd such as liv'd in the high countries, *Athamanes*, heavenly. Mount *Olympus* was heaven, the habitation of the gods. This was the way of talking in the heroical times.

The *Canaanites*, on the other hand, call'd themselves *Hycsi*, or royal pastors. And the stories of the battles between these two people are the oldest stories we have among the poets, when they ring about the wars between the gods and the *Titans*.

In the chronology of this pastor dynasty, I differ a little from the great authors aforementioned. The chief reason why, is this. They take the numbers in *Josephus's* catalogue, as in the present copies; but I hold 'em erroneous, and to be corrected from *Africanus*, *Eusebius*, and *Syncellus*, who copied from *Josephus* in earlier times. *Josephus's* present numbers are somewhat too short: for tho' *Africanus*, *Eusebius*, and *Syncellus* differ from one another, as well as from *Josephus*, (such is the misfortune of negligence in transcription) yet they all agree to heighten the numbers. And *Josephus* himself, twice in the same books, makes the sum total to be 393 years, which is more than his particulars, by which *Marsham*, *Usher*, and *Cumberland* go. But take that sum total 393, and set it at the *exodus*, and count upwards: I apprehend then we have it in its right situation.

By this means, the head of the pastor dynasty in *Egypt*, which commenced with *Salatis*, must be placed *anno mundi* 1860 instead of 1920, as *Usher* and *Cumberland* have it: and during the reign of *Menes*, *Misraim*,

Osiris, according to their own chronology. This, I am confident, is near the truth. And thus that dynasty is to be plac'd in the list of time.

Manethon's dynasties of pastor kings in lower Egypt.

<i>Salatis</i> began to reign A. P. J. 2570. A.M.	186 0
<i>Beon</i>	187 9
<i>Apachnas</i>	192 3
<i>Apophis</i>	195 9
<i>Janias</i> <i>Staan</i> A.P.J.	202 0
<i>Assis, Archles, Melcartus</i> 2781	207 1

By this means we have an opening scene of the greatest matters of antiquity, that relate to the world in general, as well as particularly to the island of *Great Britain*; of which I must give some account.

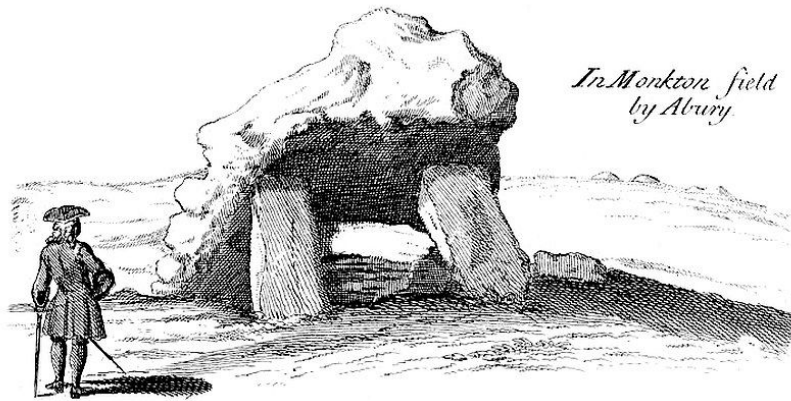
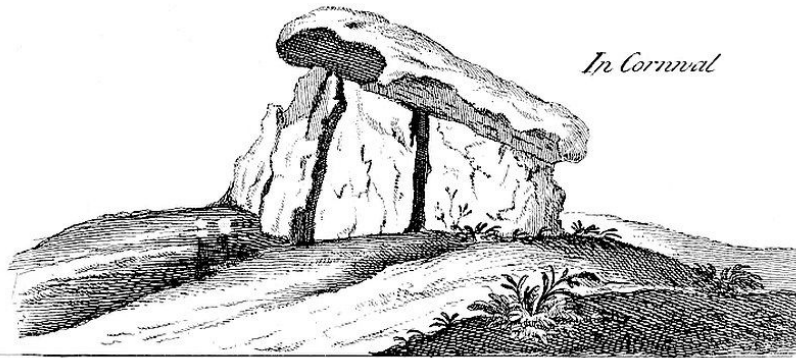
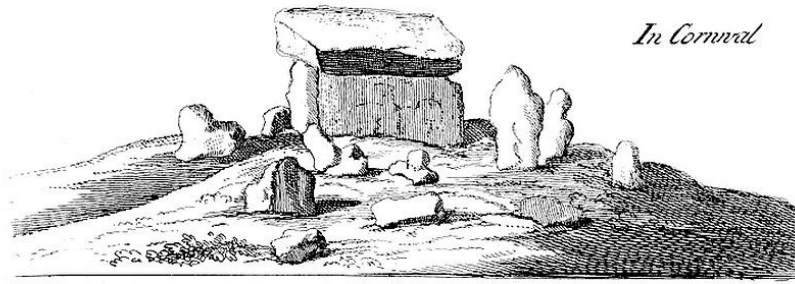
In the year of the world 2083, the great patriarch *Abraham* came out of *Chaldea* into the land of *Canaan*. This is in the 13th year of the reign of our *Melcarthus* in lower *Egypt*. About 2087, not 2084 (as *Usher* sets it) *Abraham*, by famine constrained, goes down to *Egypt*, that is, into lower *Egypt*. So that our *Melcarthus* is the real *Pharaoh* mention'd *Gen. xii.* who would have taken *Sarah*, *Abraham's* wife, 'till he learn'd the truth. *Usher*, at the year 2084, calls him *Apophis*; but 'tis an error of the pen, it means *Janias*, predecessor to *Assis*, whom he sets as regent from *anno mundi* 2081. *Castor* the chronographer, in *Syncellus*, writes, "that *Abraham* was well learn'd in the knowledge of astronomy, and the other sciences of the *Chaldeans*." *Berosus*, author of the *Chaldean* history, gave him the character of "a just and great man, expert in astronomy." *Josephus* adds, "that *Hecateus* had such a value for his memory, that he wrote his history." *Nicholas* of *Damascus* an historian, and *Trogus*, make him a king.

Alexander Polyhistor relates from *Eupolomus*, “that *Abraham* exceeded all men in wisdom; that astronomy was founded by him among the *Chaldeans*; that he came into *Phœnicia*, and taught the *Phœnicians* astronomy; that he being constrain’d by famine, went into *Egypt*, lived in *Eliopolis* among the priests, and taught them astronomy; yet he did not pretend to be the inventor of the art, but had it deliver’d to him by succession from *Enoch*.” *Artapanus* likewise, the historian, mention’d by *Eusebius præp. evang.* IX. 4. he speaks of “*Abraham* going to the king of *Egypt*, and teaching him astronomy, and that after twenty years he return’d into *Syria*.” *Melo*, another old heathen author, speaks much of *Abraham*’s wisdom. These writers, as wholly disinterested, sufficiently shew that *Egypt* hence learn’d astronomy, and *Melcarthus* their king in particular.

It seems, at this time, the major part of the world, thro’ ignorance or negligence, knew not the true length of a year, making it of 360 days only. But *Abraham* taught the *Egyptians* better; for now we may understand that remark in *Syncellus*, that under *Assis* or *Hercules*, the last of the pastor kings, the 5 additional days were placed in their year. And then a solar year of 365 days first began among the *Egyptians*. ’Tis somewhat odd, that the *Egyptians* should call these 5 additional days by the word *Nesi*, which signifies a *snake*. I suppose they meant by it *sacred days*, *holy days*. They were placed at the end of the year, and reckon’d birth-days of the gods, I suppose from some fore-notices they had of the birth of *Messiah* at that time of the year; for I find all antiquity had such notice. But *Syncellus* does not tell us the whole of the truth: *Abraham* taught *Assis* likewise the intercalation of the quarter-day, and the leap-day every fourth year. For, according to what I have been able to see concerning this matter, the *Mosaic* or patriarchal year was solar, and strictly *Julian*. But when the world was o’erwhelm’d with idolatry, providence judg’d proper to alter the year too, in order to dislocate their heathenish and superstitious festivals. Therefore to *Moses* God communicated the form of the lunæ-solar year, which the *Jews* use to this day. But toward the advent of *Messiah*, providence took care to restore the ancient patriarchal year, in the *Julian* form.

Hence we may account for what *Herodotus* tells us of the *Thebans*, a people in upper *Egypt*, who intercalate the quarter-day every fourth year: from the earliest times, no doubt from the time of *Hercules*.

Let us mention this remark. In the sacred account of *Abraham's* sojourning here in *Egypt*, we meet with no distaste of the *Egyptians* to shepherds, which in his grandson *Jacob's* time was an abomination to them. This shews that the pastor kings now reign'd here, with whom *Abraham* convers'd; and it shews the reason of that abomination, when they were expell'd; it confirms this history of *Manethon's* dynasty, and illustrates the scriptures. *Jacob's* family being *Canaanites* and shepherds, were taken to be of those that held the *Egyptians* in so long a war. They were pretended to be spies by *Joseph*, *Gen.* xlii. 9.



Stukeley delin.

E. Kirkall sculp.

KIST VAEN
In Cornwall
In Cornwall
In Monkton field by Abury

Further, we have another very important piece of history from *Abraham's* being in *Egypt*, which the learned are not aware of; for hence 'tis more than presumption, that the *Egyptians* learn'd the use of letters or alphabet-writing. If we seek into the accounts transmitted to us by *letters*, concerning

their own origin, *Philo the Jew* expressly attributes the invention thereof to *Abraham*. Whence *Plato in Philebo* and in *Phædro*, contends for their first appearance in *Egypt*, discover'd by *Theut*, "who, whether he be a god, or a man, is doubtful," says he; meaning, the use of them must be a divine communication. *Syncellus* writes, "the opinion of some is, that *Abraham* brought letters out of *Chaldea*, and taught them to the *Phœnicians*, and they taught them to the *Greeks*." *Diodorus V.* writes, "the *Syrians* invented letters, and the *Phœnicians* learn'd the great secret from them." *Eusebius, pr. ev. X.* confirms this, but asserts, "that by the *Syrians* are meant the *Assyrians* (as was often the case in old accounts) or the *Hebrews* more particularly." It was, in truth, the ancestors of *Abraham*. And this I believe is the real truth. God first imparted this knowledge to the patriarchal family, for preserving the sacred records of his church; and *Abraham* now taught their use to *Assis*, the *Hercules*, son of *Nilus Jupiter*, who wrote in the *Phrygian* letters, says *Cicero*.

All this is exceedingly confirm'd by the explication which *Mr. Toland* gives us concerning *Hercules Ogmius*, in his history of the Druids. *Lucian* says, 'tis a word of their own language, by which the *Celts* call *Hercules*. And the word has hitherto been inexplicable. He relates the picture of him (in *Hercule Gallico*) which he saw in *Gaul*, which was explain'd to him by a Druid. He was pictured as clad with a lion's skin, a club in his right hand, a bent bow in his left, a quiver hanging o'er his shoulders. As for his form, he was an old man, bald before, wrinkled, and in colour like a sun-burnt sailor. A multitude of people were represented as drawn after him by golden chains from their ears, center'd in his tongue. The Druid told *Lucian*, that *Ogmius* accomplish'd his great achievements by his eloquence, and reduc'd the people of this western world, from rude and barbarous to a state of civility.

A memorial of this knowledge which *Hercules* had of letters, we find in *Hephæstion V.* where he writes, "*Hercules* gave the name of *Alpha* to the first letter, in honour to the river *Alpheus*, when victor at the *olympic* games." My late learned friend, *Mr. Keysler*, in his *Antiq. septentrional.* guessed well that *Ogmius* means *literatus*, a *man of letters*, as we commonly say; more properly spoken of *Hercules* than of others. But *Mr. Toland* shews evidently, that *Ogum* is a word in the *Irish* language, importing the secret of alphabet writing; the *literarum secreta*, as *Tacitus*

calls it, *de mor. germ.* So that *Hercules Ogmius* fully imports the learned *Hercules*, and especially one that was master of alphabet writing; without which learning is but a vague and uncertain thing. This our *Hercules* learn'd of *Abraham* in the east, and this he brought with our Druids into the extremest west, in this very early age of the world, as we have all the reason imaginable to believe. That they had letters, we have *Cæsar's* express testimony, and they were the same as the *greek* letters, because the very same. They had them from the same fountain as the *Grecians*, tho' somewhat earlier; for I take our *Hercules* to be a little prior in time to *Cadmus*, who carry'd letters into Greece.

Hercules therefore was learned and eloquent, a great astronomer, and philosopher. A fragment of *Palæphatus* in the *Alexandrian* chronicle, calls him the *Tyrian* philosopher, who found out the purple dye: *Suidas* in the word *Hercules*, the like. And long before, *Heraclitus in Allegoriis Homericis*, says, he was a wise man, a great philosopher, και σοφιας ουρανιου Μυστης, one initiated into the wisdom from above; we may call him a professor of divinity.

Thus he appears a worthy scholar of the great *Abraham*, and from him the Druids learn'd the groundwork of learning, religion, and philosophy, which they were so famous for ever after. But my purpose is to be very short on this head at present: nevertheless I must remark that our *Assis* was not only acquainted with *Abraham* in *Egypt*, but likewise in the land of *Canaan* or *Phœnicia*; for he quitted *Egypt* by compact with *Tethmosis A.M.* 2120, carrying away with him 240000 men, which enabled him to transport colonies all over the *Mediterranean* and the ocean. And he must dwell several years in *Canaan* before his projects of that kind were ripe. But *Abraham* dy'd *A.M.* 2183, so that there was abundantly time enough for the two great men to renew their acquaintance, and there is much reason to think they actually did so.

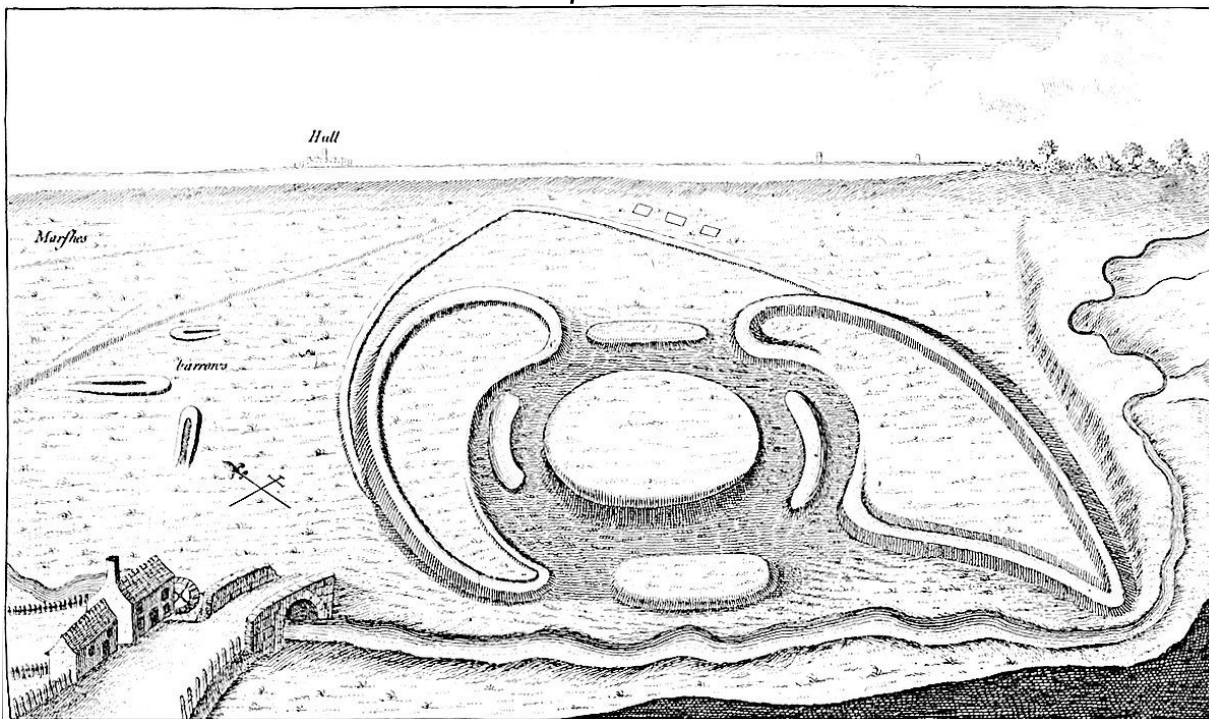
Therefore as it was the patriarchal custom to raise temples wherever they came; so of our hero *Hercules*, whether thro' his own pious disposition, or in imitation of *Abraham*: we hear of his raising pillars too, which means our temples. And thence he obtain'd the name in antiquity, of *Hercules Saxanus*.

Thus the learned *Lud. Vives* on *St. Augustin C. D.* viii. 9. “The philosophy of the *Egyptians* is very ancient, but for the most part deriv’d from the *Chaldeans*, especially from *Abraham*, tho’ they, as *Diodorus* writes, refer it to *Isis*, *Osiris*, *Vulcan*, *Mercury*, and *Hercules*.” Further from *Joseph*’s administration, the *Egyptian* learning commenc’d, for which they became so celebrated. He not only instructed the priests in religion and philosophy, but settled their colleges and possessions, as we read in *Gen.* xlvii. 22, 26. so that if *Moses* was learned in the wisdom of the *Egyptians*, he deriv’d it only thro’ them from his own ancestors. Which note may be useful to give us a true notion of this matter, which some learned men exalt too high. And this at the same time shews idolatry commenc’d in *Egypt*, after his time. They consecrated *Joseph* into the genius or intelligence of their first monarch *Osiris*, *Serapis*, &c. with the bushel on his head. But what I chiefly insist upon at present, is of *Hercules* making these serpentine temples, which in his history is call’d overcoming serpents and the like. And hence the fable of his squeezing two serpents to death in his cradle; and the *Tyrian* coins struck to his honour, some whereof I have exhibited.

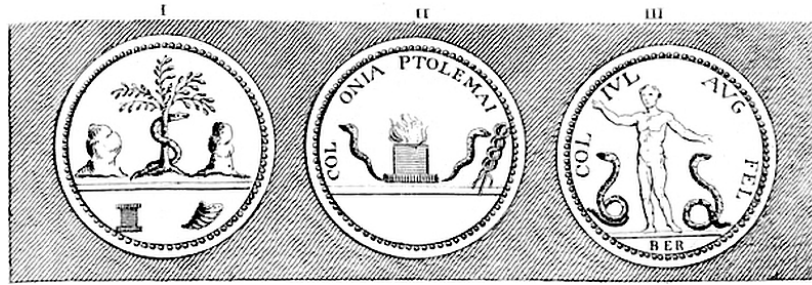
TAB. XXXVIII.

P. 74.

The alate Temple of the Druids at Barrow in Lincolnshire, on the banks of the humber.



W. Stukeley delin. 25 July 1724



I. A coin in Vaillant's colonies II. p. 148, 218, 340, 351. Of the city of *Tyre*, an olive-tree with a snake between two stones, *petræ ambrosiæ*. An altar; and a conch, meaning *Tyre*.

II. A coin in Vaillant's colony coins II. p. 314, struck at *Ptolemais* or *Acon*.

A great and rude stone altar without any mouldings or carvings, between two serpents, a *Caduceus* which is truly the *ophio-cyclo-ptyergomorph* on a staff meaning in the hieroglyphick doctrine, the power of the deity. These imperial coins of colonies intended to preserve the memory of their antiquities, and this probably regards the old serpentine temple in the foundation of their city *Acon* or *Ptolemais*.

III. A coin in Vaillant's colonies II. p. 111, struck at *Berytus*. They all regard *Hercules's* building serpentine temples.

Of his building our Druid temples in general, of these great stones, the two coins of *Gordian* in *Stonehenge* page 50, are a further evidence. The *Ambrosiæ Petræ* are a work of this sort, when he began or assisted in building the city *Tyre*. And I gather he was a great builder of serpentine temples in particular, such as we have been describing, call'd *Dracontia*. What he did of this sort in *Britain* I have no foundation for discovering; but in ancient history still left us, there are sufficient traces that shew he did it, in the more eastern parts of the world.

For instance, at *Acon* or *Ptolemais* as call'd afterward, a city on the *Phœnician* shore: it regain'd its first name and now is call'd *St. John* of

Acres, from a famous church there. The first city was probably built by our *Hercules*, at least he made one of these temples there, as I gather from the name of the place, coins and reports relating thereto. The *Greeks* call it *Ακη*, and according to their custom, give it a *Greek* original, from *ακεισθαι*, because says the *Etymologicum magnum*, *Hercules* was there *heal'd* of the bite of a serpent. *Stephanus* of *Byzance* the same, in the word *Ptolemais*; in the word *Ake*, he says, that *Claudius Julius* in his vol. I. of the *Phœnician* history, writes, “that it had its name from *Hercules*, who was order'd by the oracle to go eastward, 'till he came to a river, and found the herb *Colocasias*, which would cure his wound. He came to the river *Belus*, which here runs into the sea, and there found the herb.” *Salmasius* in his *Plinian* exertions, affirms, the herb is *Dracunculus*; it grows in our gardens, called *Dragons*, from its likeness to a snake's head and tongue; and being spotted like a snake.

All this I can understand no otherwise, than that *Hercules* made a serpentine temple on the side of this river, where the city *Acon* was afterward built, and which took its name from this temple, as our *Hakpen* at *Abury*; for *נֶכֶן Acan* in the *Chaldee*, signifies a serpent, as we observed before. *Josephus* informs us, by the river *Belus* was the sepulchre of *Memnon*; which probably was made here in regard to the temple.

When we come into *Greece*, we hear of *Hercules* overcoming the *Lernean* snake, which *Heraclides Ponticus* writes had 50 heads. We may very well understand this of 50 stones, which compos'd the head, as our temple on *Overton-hill* of 58. *Hephæstion* II. recites from *Alexander* the *Myndian*, that this *Hydra* was turn'd into stone. Thus hints and reports are drop'd, which preserve the real truth envelop'd in fable; as was the *Greek* method in all matters of antiquity.

This snake was of a very unusual bulk, and lay near a great water, call'd the *Lernean*-lake, by a large plane-tree, and the spring *Anymone*. Further 'tis said, in overcoming this animal (by which they mean the labour he bestow'd in accomplishing the work) he us'd the help of *Iolaus* the waggoner. Such help must be highly useful to him, to bring the stones. But I observe from the name *Iolaus* his waggoner and companion, and *Hylas* another great friend of his, and *Iole* his mistress, that the ancient druidical festival is couch'd under that name, call'd *Yule*, which I shall speak largely upon in its proper place. In the mean time (we are told) the snake was

assisted against him, by a very great crab. This will appear strange, 'till we are directed to its meaning by this consideration. As the serpent means the *Dracontian* temple, so the crab was a symbol like in figure and meaning to the *globus alatus* or winged circle, which was the ancient picture of the *anima mundi*, or divine spirit. Thus does mythology, when rightly consider'd, help us in these ancient enquiries. We may say of the work as *Statius* does of the temple of *Hercules Surrentinus*,

———*Deus obluctantia saxa*
Summovit nitens, & magno pectore montem
Repulit.———

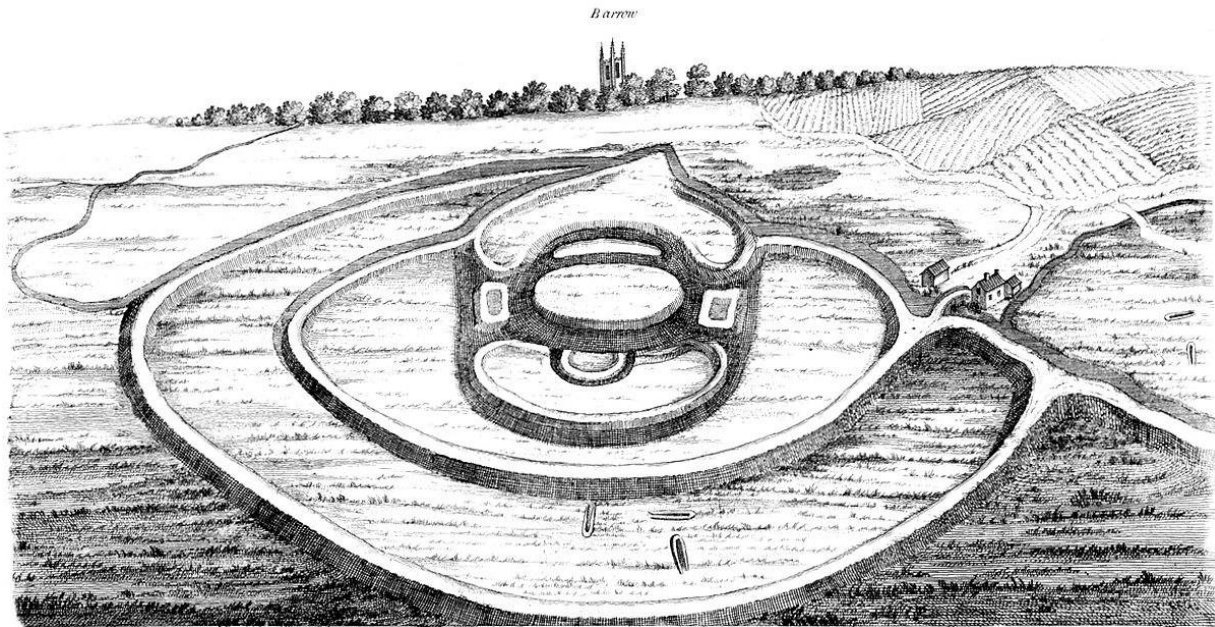
There are like vestiges of other *Dracontian* temples founded by *Hercules* in *Spain*, *Africa*, and elsewhere.

“*Hercules*,” says bishop *Cumberland*, “was a very learned prince, bred or conversant in the *Phœnician* universities, whereof *Debir* was one, *Josh.* xv. 15. 49. call'd for its eminence, *Kirjath-sepher*, the *city of books*; and *Kirjath-sanna*, the *city of learning*.” The bishop thinks he retreated from *Egypt* about the time of *Abraham*'s death. But, from what chronological evidence I gave before, it must be a good while before it. And I do not doubt but he with pleasure renew'd his acquaintance with his old friend *Abraham*, in the land of *Canaan*.

There seems to be a very pregnant proof of this, in that *Hercules* had a son call'd *Isaac*, to whom one would imagine *Abraham* was sponsor at his baptism, or perhaps his son *Isaac*; for baptism was one part of the patriarchal religion. And they had susceptors, sponsors, or what we call *god-fathers* at the font, as we have. Of this *Isaac* son of *Hercules*, *Plutarch* informs us, *de Isid. & Osir.* remembred by the *Phrygians*, for he was planted in *Phrygia* by his father *Hercules*. Hence it became a common name there, and *Æsacus* son of king *Priam* is but the same name, as my learned friend Mr. *Baxter* thinks, in his *glossar. Antiq. Rom.* If this consideration be joined to what I wrote in *Stonehenge* about *Phryxus*, or *Apher*, grandson of *Abraham*, having a concern in planting, and even naming of *Britain*, it may afford us another hint about our *Phrygian* extract, which the old *Britons* are so fond of. And we can expect no other than these kind of hints, in matters of such extreme antiquity. And further, as he was concern'd in settling colonies in *Spain*, we may attribute to him the claim

which the *Gallæci* there had, to a *Trojan* descent, of which *Justin* informs us.

TAB. XXXIX.
P. 76.



Stukeley del.

Prospect of the British Temple at Barrow Lincolnsh^r July 25. 1724.

This *Apher* is the *Africus* mention'd by *Mela*, I. 9. He calls him an *Arabian* king, who being driven out by the *Assyrians*, went into *Africa*. 'Tis very remarkable, that his name, when interpreted, signifies *Tyn*; as the great *Bochart* makes the name of *Britain*, come from *Bratanac*, the land of *tyn*; equivalent to the *greek* word *κασσιτερος*, whence *Cassiterides* in *latin*. This expulsion seems to be hinted at in *Gen.* xiv. 6. in the days of *Abraham*. Now a reader not much acquainted with these kind of inquiries, will be apt to smile at pretending to a similitude between *Apher* and *Britain*. So in making the *Wiltshire* word *sarsens* deriv'd from the same word as the name of the city of *Tyre*; tho' 'tis an undeniable fact, and easily perceiv'd by the learned.

The evidences of *Hercules* planting *Britain*, are of the like nature, which I shall very briefly recapitulate. *Apollodorus* in II. after the story of *Hercules*, *Antæus* and *Geryon*, two kings in *Afric* and *Spain*, mentions his conquering *Alebion* and *Dercynus* sons of *Neptune*, in the same mythologic strain as the others, because they attempted to drive away his oxen. He

makes it to be in *Libya*, others in *Ligyra* or *Liguria*, others in *Gaul*. The variety of places is of no consequence in these very old stories. I regard only the personal names of *Albion* and *Bergion*, as more commonly call'd, sons of *Neptune*. If this be really so, sons of *Tarshish*, son of *Javan*: for *Tarshish* was the true *Neptune* of the heathen; and he was one of the sons to whom the heathen generally attribute the plantation of islands, as well as *Moses*, *Gen. x. 5*. But *Albion* and *Bergion* are notoriously most ancient names of *Britain* and *Ireland*. *Mela*, II. 5. mentions *Hercules* fighting *Albion* and *Bergion*. So *Tzetzes* in *chiliad*. and *Tzetzes* the interpreter of *Lycophron*.

Tacitus says expressly *Hercules* was in *Germany*, in that part lying upon the ocean especially. *Ammianus Marcellinus*, in his XV. 9. tells us from *Timagenes*, an ancient historian, "that the *Dorienses* following the more ancient *Hercules*, inhabited the western countries bordering on the ocean." By mount *Carmel* was a city *Dora* spoken of by *Josephus*, and by *Stephanus* of *Byzantium*, quoting *Hecataeus*, and many more old authors. See the famous fragment of *Stephanus*. *Claudius Julius*, in his III. of the *Phœnician* history, writes, "next to *Cæsarea* is *Dora*, inhabited by *Phœnicians* on account of the great quantity of the purple fish there found." Now *Hercules* being confessedly the inventor of this *Tyrian* dye, 'tis probable the companions of his, mention'd by *Ammianus*, were of this city.

If *Hercules* peopled the ocean, coasts of *Gaul*, *Spain* and *Germany*, we may well imagine he would do the like in *Britain*. *Pliny's* testimony is express, that *Melcarthus* (corruptly *Midacritus*) first brought *tyn* from the *Cassiterid* islands, which can be no other than *Britain*.

The poets and mythologists, when speaking of the *Titans*, agree they went all into the west, which seems to be meant of *Hercules* and his people settling in *Britain*. Our *Thule*, or northern island, seems to have been named by our *Hercules*, as a demonstration of his being there, from an island of the same name in the *Persian* gulph. Of which *Bochart*.

The like is to be inferr'd from such stories as that related by *Parthenius Nicæus*, "that *Hercules* travelling, after his expedition against *Geryon*, pass'd thro' the country of the *Celts*, and was entertain'd by *Britannus*. His daughter *Celtine* fell in love with him, on whom he begat a son call'd

Celtus; from him afterwards the people of the *Celts* received their denomination.”

We took notice before, that these shepherds who quitted *Egypt* under the conduct of our *Hercules*, call’d themselves *Hycsi*, as *Manethon* informs us in *Josephus & Eusebius in chronol.* The word imports *royal shepherds, valiant, freemen, heroes*. Now we find the remains of this very name in the south-western part of our island, in *Worcestershire*, even to the *Roman* times, and still further, even to the time of venerable *Bede*. They were called *Huiccii*, to which *Orduices* and *Vigornienses* is synonymous. And all three words mean the same thing, as the great *Baxter* shews in his glossary, *Antiq. Britan. voce Orduices, Icenii, Huiccii, &c.* And by all accounts our old *Britons* lov’d that same free, shepherd’s life, which the old *Canaanites* did about *Abraham’s* time, as describ’d in scripture. Bishop *Cumberland* is elaborate upon it.

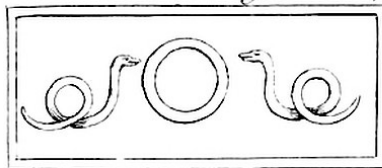
I take the *Irish*, and ancient highland *Scots*, to be the remains of the original *Phœnician* colony. My learned friend, Dr. *Pocock*, when he was in *Ireland*, observ’d a surprizing conformity between the present *Irish* and the *Egyptians*, and that in very many instances.

These considerations, added to what I said in *Stonehenge*, are enough to persuade us, that our *Hercules* had a considerable hand in peopling *Britain*.

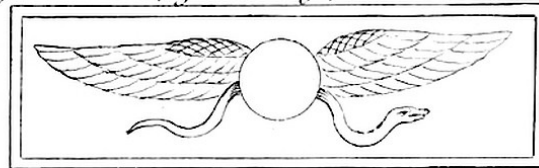
The antient Symbols of the deity.



the deity thus exprest on the imposts at Persepolis.



thus upon Chinese gates.



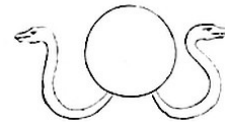
thus on Egyptian monuments.



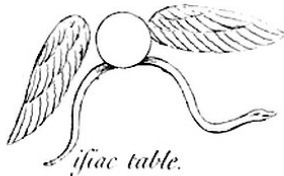
*on asardonyx in
Pignor. mens. Isiaca.
P.20.*



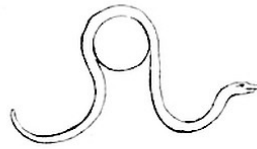
isiac table



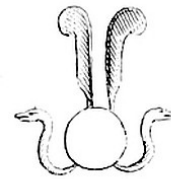
isiac table



isiac table.



isiac table



isiac table.

the deity thus exprest on the imposts at Persepolis.

thus upon Chinese gates.

thus in Egyptian monuments.

on asardonyx in Pignor. mens. Isiaca. P.20.

isiac table.

isiac table.

isiac table.

isiac table.

isiac table.

*Reverendissimo Præsuli Iohanni Archiepiscopo Cantuarensi.
humillime d.d. W. Stukeley.*

CHAP. XIV.

Part of Cadmus his history, who was a builder of serpentine temples. He was son of Canaan called Agenor. He was a Horite or Hivite, call'd Kadmonite in scripture. Hivite signifies a serpent. Mount Hermon denominated from his wife, Psal. cxxxiii. 3. "like as the dew of Hermon, which fell on the hill of Sion." Correct it, Sirijon. Another correction in the translation of our bible, "Canaanite in the house of the Lord of hosts," read merchant. 'Tis a prophecy not attended to, Zech. xiv. 21. The ancient greek fables of sowing serpents' teeth; of Cadmus and his wife being turn'd into serpents, and the like; are form'd from their building serpentine temples. Not to be wonder'd at so much, when our country-people have the very same reports of Rouldrich stones; of the Weddings, another Druid temple in Somersetshire; of Long Meg and her daughters, another in Cumberland; and most firmly believe, that they were men and women turn'd into stones. The mythology of the ancients not to be despis'd, but its original meaning sought for.

NONE more famous in Grecian history than *Cadmus*, who brought them the use of those letters that convey'd their history to us, and preserv'd the little knowledge we can chiefly have of profane antiquity. He was son of *Agenor*, by which word the *Greeks* chose to pronounce the difficult one of *Canaan*. *Alexander Polyhistor* cites out of *Eupolemus*; "from *Saturn* (who is *Cham*) came *Belus* and *Canaan*, and *Canaan* begat the father of the *Phœnicians*, or *Phœnix*. *Eusebius*, *pr. ev. 9* has it too. Again, *Eusebius*, *pr. ev. 1.* quotes from *Sanchoniathon*, *Cna*, (*Canaan*,) who was styled among the *Phœnicians* *XHNA*." So in *Stephanas of Byzantium*, *Phœnicia* is called *XHNA*, and the *Phœnicians* *XHNAI*, which is *Canaanites*. *XHNA*, *Cna*, is *Agenor*.

Cadmus lived in the time of, or very little after *Hercules*. Tho' the *Parian* marble is an invaluable monument, yet 'tis not an infallible one. If the learned *Bentley* finds it erring about *Stesichorus*, we must not depend on its

æra of *Cadmus*, who lived a thousand years before that stone was made. Nor is the authority of *Eusebius*'s chronology in this particular, greater. *Bochart* holds him older than the builder of *Tyre*; *there* perhaps he heightens his date a little too much.

To have a proper notion of the history of this great man, bishop *Cumberland* shews us, that the *Horites* or *Hivites*, sons of *Canaan*, i. e. the colony or people of *Cadmus* son of *Agenor*, or *Canaan*, went out of the land of *Canaan* about the same time that *Misraim* or *Osiris*, son of *Cham*, went to plant *Egypt*. They went likewise into *Egypt*. They lived quietly there for some time, but war arising between the *Misraimites* and the pastors, they retir'd back again, probably a little before the expulsion of the pastors. Some went to the north of *Canaan*, about mount *Hermon* under *Libanus*; some remain'd in the more southern parts, more particularly call'd *Horites*, or *Avim*, or *Hivites*.

In *Gen.* xv. 18. when God made his great covenant with *Abraham*, he tells him, he will give him the land of the *Kenites*, and *Kenizzites*, and *Kadmonites*, and *Hittites*, and *Perizzites*, and *Rephaims*, *Amorites*, &c. By *Kadmonites* he means the people of *Cadmus* son of *Canaan*. But afterward, in all those places where these nations are recited, they are called *Hivites*; *Cadmus* was likewise call'd *Hyas*, *Hivæus*: *Hyas* or *Cadmus*, one or both, being honorary names, or names of consecration, as was the mode of that time. The same is to be said of *Melchizedec*, *Abimelech*, *Pharaoh*, and many more. About this time there was likewise *Hyas* a son of *Atlas*.

The name of *Hermon* is probably deriv'd from his wife *Hermione*, as a compliment to her. And of this mountain is that saying in *Psal.* cxxxiii. 3. The psalmist draws an elegant comparison of the holy unction of *Aaron* running from his head to his beard, and so down his garments, "like as the dew of *Hermon* which falls on the hill of *Sion*." A difficulty that gave *St. Augustin* a great deal of trouble; but must needs be an absurd reading, and ought to be corrected *Sirion* for *Sion*. *Sirion* is a lower part of the high ground at the bottom of mount *Hermon*, as that lies under the elated crest of *Libanus*. *Psal.* xxix. 6. "*Libanon* also, and *Sirion*, like a young unicorn." A mountain not a little remarkable, since we read, *Deut.* iii. 9. "which *Hermon* the *Sidonians* call *Sirion*, and the *Amorites* call it *Shenir*;" *Hermon* and *Sirion* being parts of mount *Libanon*.

Since we are upon criticism, the reader will excuse me in mentioning another of like nature, and not foreign to our purpose. These *Horites*, *Hivites*, *Avim* or *Cadmonites*, as called from *Cadmus*, *Gen.* xv. 19. or *Canaanites*, as called from his father *Canaan*, extending themselves upon the *Phœnician* shore, became traders or merchants in the most eminent degree of all ancient people in the world, and traded as far as *Britain*; so that the name of *Canaanite* and *merchant* became equivalent. *Isaiah* xxiii. 8. “Who hath taken this counsel against *Tyre*, saith the prophet, the *crowning* city; whose merchants are princes, whose *traffickers* are the honourable of the earth.”

Hence we observe, 1. The prophet calls it the *crowning* city, for they sent a golden crown to *Alexander the great* as a present.

2. The word *traffickers*, *mercatores*, is *Canaanites* in the original. And the like in *Jerem.* x. 17. “Gather up thy wares out of the land, O inhabiter of the fortress.” ’Tis *Canahe* in the original.

3. This naturally leads me to mention a noble prophecy, overlook’d thro’ a too literal translation in our bible, *Zech.* xiv. 21. “Yea, every pot in *Jerusalem*, and in *Judah*, shall be holiness unto the LORD of hosts: and all they that sacrifice shall come and take of them, and seethe therein. And in that day there shall be no more the *Canaanite* in the house of the LORD of hosts.” It ought to be translated *merchant*, as in the vulgate *latin* and *chaldee*. For ’tis a prophecy concerning the days of the Messiah; and regards that famous act of his life, when he drove the traders out of the temple.

The *Kadmonites* got the name of *Hivites*, as I apprehend, from their celebrity in building temples of the serpentine form. At first they were consecrated to true religion; but too soon all these, and other patriarchal temples in the land of *Canaan* were polluted to idolatrous purposes; and probably from them the worship of snakes became famous. Now the word *Avim*, *Hevæus* in the *Syriac*, signifies a *snake*. And from this custom of the *Phœnicians* making serpentine temples, the notion might arise of the *Phœnicians* worshipping serpents, as *Eusebius* observes, *pr. ev.* I. And from this the *Greeks* made their fables of *Cadmus* overcoming a great snake, sowing its teeth, and armed men sprouting up, &c.

On this account it is, that they who represent this exploit of his, describe it as done by a stone of a very extraordinary bulk, *Ovid. Met. III. v. 59.*

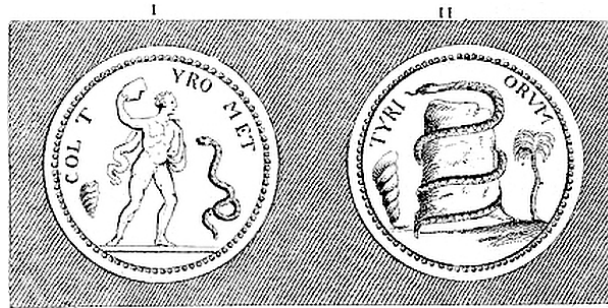
—————*dextrâque molarem*
Sustulit, et magnum magno conamine misit.
Illius impulsu cùm turribus ardua celsis
Mænia mota forent; serpens sine vulnere mansit.

The bulk of the serpent is equally extravagant,

—————*immensos sinuatur in arcus.*
—————*tantoque est corpore, quanto*
Si totum species, geminos qui separat arctos.
Ipse modò immensum spiris facientibus orbem
Cingitur, interdum longâ trabe rectior exit.

This is but a poetical description of the circle and the avenues at *Abury*.

You have this same action of the heroes represented in some *Tyrian* coins: *Cadmus* is throwing a stone at a serpent. That of *Gordian III.* in *Vaillant's* colony coins, vol. II. p. 217. Another of *Gallienus*, p. 350. The author quotes *Nonnus's Dionysiacs IV.* reciting the history of his breaking a snake's head with a stone. And he thinks those other *Tyrian* coins belong to this same history, as that p. 136, where a snake is represented as roll'd about a great stone.



I. A coin of Gordian III. Vaillant's colon. II. p. 217. which the learned author adjudges to Cadmus. Another of Gallienus, p. 350. Both struck at Tyre.

II. A coin of the city of Tyre in Vaillant's colon. p. 136, 147. The learned author says a stone and serpent is the symbol of Cadmus. The truth is, they regard Cadmus founding serpentine temples.

It was from the city of *Sareptha* that *Europa* was carry'd off; 'tis in the country of *Sidon*; and I apprehend, from the name of it, here was originally a serpentine temple. *Sareptha* is the serpent *Ptha*. I have an ancient coin of this city, in brass. A palm-tree on one side, a leopard's face on the other, which refers to the wine here famous: of which the learned *Reland* in *Palestina*.

Conon, in his narration 37, gives us the origin of the greek fable of *Cadmus's* men, the *Phœnicians*, springing out of the ground armed, for before then helmets and shields were unknown. Hence they were call'd *Spartæ*.

That these armed men sprung out of the ground upon sowing the serpent's teeth, means our *Hivites* making a religious procession along the avenue of their serpentine temples on the great festival days, when they sacrific'd. We see a like procession of armed men, carv'd upon the temple of *Persepolis* in *Le Brun's* prints. And *Ovid* calles a *Bœotian*, one of *Cadmus's* people, *Hyantius*, III. v. 147. *Strabo* vii. writes, they took that

name from their king *Hyas*, which is the same as *Hivite*. *Pliny* iv. 7. observes the *Bæotians* were so call'd anciently.

In the next book *Met.* iv. ver. 560. we have an account of *Melicerta* our *Melcarthus* and his mother deify'd: and of the *Sidonian* women their companions, some turn'd into stones, others into birds, for grieving at their fate. This seems to mean their building temples after some of the modes we have been describing, and that which is to follow [Chap. XVI.](#) near the sepulchres of heroes and founders of states; as was the custom of old: what we observed by *Silbury-hill* and *Abury*. For these temples were prophylactick, and a sacred protection to the ashes of the defunct. So we read in *Virgil* by *Anchises's* tomb, *Æneid* V.

*Tunc vicina astris Erycino in vertice sedes
Fundatur Veneri Idaliæ; tumuloque sacerdos
Ac lucus latè sacer additur Anchisæo.*

Immediately after *Ovid's* account of *Melicerta*, the poet speaks of *Cadmus* and his wife turn'd into serpents: which I understand of the like serpentine temple made by their sepulchre. *Suidas* writes, on *Epaminondas's* tomb was a shield and a snake carv'd, to shew he was of *Spartan* race. We may very well imagine the circle and snake, the cognizance of *Cadmus*.

After *Cadmus's* decease, his people built a city called *Butua*; and near it is a place call'd *Cylices*, where *Cadmus* and *Hermione* were turn'd into serpents: and two stone snakes are there set up by the *Phænicians*, to their honour: *Bochart* page 502, where many authors are quoted to prove these particulars. He says, the word *Cylices* in *Phænician*, means *tumulos*, our barrows. It was a place full of sepulchral *tumuli*, as *Stonehenge* and *Abury*: cups revers'd, regarding the form of them. *Nonnus in Dionys.* writes, that there are two great stones or rocks there, which clap together with a great noise, whence auguries are taken. *Tzetzes chiliad.* iv. *hist.* 139, mentions the same thing. I take this to be a main ambre, of which I spoke largely in *Stonehenge*. *Herodot.* V. 61. says the *Cadmeians* being admitted citizens of *Athens*, built temples there, which had nothing common with the *Greek* temples; particularly they had a temple of *Ceres Achæa* and mystical rites. *Achæa*, I suppose, means a serpentine temple, from the oriental name.

We read just now, that the *Sidonian* women, the mourners for *Melcarthus* and his mother, were turn'd some into stones, others into birds.

Pars volucres factæ, sumptis Ismenides alis.

I should suppose the internal meaning of this to be, the making an alate temple, of which we are further to speak in [chap. xvi.](#)

Antoninus Liberalis in his XXXI. tells a very old story of the first inhabitants of *Italy* before *Hercules's* time; a place among the *Messapians* called the sacred stones: where the nymphs *Epimelides* had a fane set round with trees, which trees were formerly men. This must be understood as the former.

Thus we see how the ancient *Greeks* involv'd every thing in fable, but still all fable has some historical foundation, and *that* we must endeavour to find, by applying things so properly together, as to strike out the latent truth.

The learned Dr. *Bogan* in his letter prefix'd to *Delphi phæniciss.* from *Æschylus* and others, Ικετ. α. shews, that men were often call'd snakes by the ancients, in an allegorical way; and as to the report of *Cadmus* and his wife, of the *Sidonian* women and others, turn'd into snakes, or stones, or birds, or trees, in the sense we are explaining them; 'tis no more than what we daily see and hear at this time, in these very Druid temples of our own island, which we are speaking of. The people who live at *Chippin-Norton* and all the country round our first described temple of *Rowldrich*; affirm most constantly and as surely believe it, that the stones composing this work are a king, his nobles and commons turn'd into stones. They quote an ancient proverb for it, concerning that tall stone, call'd the king stone.

*If Long-Compton thou canst see,
Then king of England shall thou be.*

And as Mr. *Roger Gale* wrote once to me from the place: "'tis the creed of all that country, and whoever dares to contradict it, is looked upon as the most audacious free-thinker."

The very same report remains, at the Druid temple of *Stanton-Drew*, in *Somersetshire*, which I shall describe in my next volume. This noble monument is vulgarly call'd the *Weddings*; and they say, 'tis a company who

assisted at a nuptial solemnity, thus petrify'd. In an orchard near the church, is a cove consisting of three stones, like that of the northern circle in *Abury*, or that of *Longstones*: this they call the parson, the bride, and bridegroom. Other circles are said to be the company dancing: and a separate parcel of stones standing a little from the rest, are call'd the fiddlers, or the band of musick.

So that vast circle of stones in *Cumberland* which was a Druid temple, is call'd *long Meg and her daughters*, and verily believed to have been human, turn'd into stones.

Thus we see an exact uniformity between the fables of the antient *Greeks*, and our present people. The former found these kind of patriarchal temples built by their first heroes and planters; admiring the vastness of the works, they affix'd these marvellous stories to them, and retain them as firmly, as our vulgar do the like now. And this is the nature of the ancient mythology; but by finding the end of the clue, we draw it out into useful truths.

These *Cadmonites*, *Avim*, *Hittites*, *Hivites*, *Spartans*, *Lacedemonians*, (who are all one and the same people,) retain'd a distinct remembrance of their relation to the *Jews*, even to the days of the *Maccabees*, as we read 1. *Maccab.* xii. and in *Josephus* Ant. xii. 5. Undoubtedly they reckoned themselves of kin to *Abraham*, if not descended from him; thus I understand it. *Joshua* mentions chap. xi. the *Hivites* in the land of *Mizpeh* under mount *Hermon* by *Libanus*. He says further, in the 19th verse, the *Gibeonites* were a portion of that same people. The *Avim* or *Horites* about mount *Seir* where *Esau* dwelt, were the same people who were expell'd by the *Caphthorim*, as *Moses* mentions: on which bishop *Cumberland* has wrote largely.

We read of the great intercourse there was between *Esau's* family and these people; for *Esau* married four of his wives from them, *Gen.* xxvi. 34. xxxvi. 2. no doubt but they married into his family again. Hence it is that *Strabo* x. writes, that *Cadmus* had *Arabians* in his company. And in xvi. that the inhabitants of *Syria* (he means properly *Phœnicia*) are originally deriv'd from the neighbourhood of the *Persian gulf*.

I doubt not but that there are now upon the face of the earth, many of these serpentine temples remaining in *Europe*, *Asia* and *Africa*. For instance, *Strabo* xvi. from *Posidonius* relates, that in a field call'd *Macra* by

Damascus, was a dead serpent, the length of an acre, so thick that two horsemen could not see each other across him, his mouth so large as a horseman might enter into it; each scale was as big as a shield.

We may hence see the origin of idolatry, soon after these heroes we have recited; and it seems to have begun first in *Phœnicia*, which *Eusebius* always puts before *Egypt*, when speaking of the matter. *Demaroon* was *Jupiter* the supreme, *Phut* they deify'd into his son, *Canaan* they made the third divine person. But wherever idolatry began, whether in the call of *Asia*, or the west, it flew too soon into other countries, and they made a *Jupiter*, a *Son*, and a *Mercury* or *Neptune* who are the same, of their own; 'till with every hero and benefactor to mankind they fill'd the heaven of the heathens.

CHAP. XV.

A metaphysical disquisition concerning the nature of the deity, shewing how the Druids, by the strength of reason, might arrive to the knowledge of a divine emanation or person, from the supreme first cause, which we call the Son of God; and the necessity of admitting of such an emanation. All the philosophers and priests of antiquity had this notion; as we read in Plato and many more.

I HAVE given the reader an account of three eminent builders of these *Dracontia*, or serpentine temples, in the earliest times after the flood, and in the more eastern parts of the world; as well as described one of those works in our island. There are many more such builders and buildings, which will be easily found out by those that are conversant in ancient learning. This figure of the circle and snake, on which they are founded, had obtained a very venerable regard, in being expressive of the most eminent and illustrious act of the deity, the multiplication of his own nature, as the *Zoroastrians* and *Platonists* speak; and in being a symbol of that divine person who was the consequence of it.

We shall not wonder that the Druids had a perception of this great truth, when we consider that it was known, as far as necessary, to all the philosophic and religious sects of antiquity, as shewn at large by several learned writers. My opinion is, that it was communicated to mankind, originally, by God himself. 'Tis the highest point of wisdom which the human mind can arrive at, to understand somewhat of the nature of the deity; and the studious, the pious, and thinking part of the world, would not fail to improve this knowledge by reflexion and ratiocination.

Tho' my business is to speak more fully of the religion of the Druids in the next volume, yet I judge it very pertinent to the present subject to anticipate that intention, so as to shew how far they might advance toward that knowledge, by the dint of reason; to further the works, wherein they have, in the largest characters that ever were made, consign'd their notions

of this sort, remaining to this day, such as we have been describing; and which may induce us to have the same sentiment concerning them as *Pere Marten* in his *Religion des Gaulois*, tho' he knew nothing of our antiquities; but thus he writes, "that the Druids worship'd the true God, and that their ideas of religion were truly grand, sublime, magnificent."

We may therefore very justly affirm of them, that in their serious contemplations in this place, concerning the nature of the deity, which, as *Cæsar* tells us, was one part of their inquiries, they would thus reason in their own minds.

A contemplative person, viewing and considering the world around him, is ravish'd with the harmony and beauty, the fitnesses of things in it, the uses and connexion of all its parts, and the infinite agreement shining throughout the whole. He must belye all his senses to doubt, that it was compos'd by a being of infinite power, wisdom and goodness, which we call God. But among all the most glorious attributes of divinity, goodness is preeminent. For this beautiful fabric of the world displays thro' every atom of it, such an amazing scene of the goodness and beneficence of its author; that it appears to such contemplative minds, that his infinite power and wisdom were but as the two hands, employ'd by the *goodness* of the sovereign architect.

Goodness was the beginning, the middle, the end of the creation. To explain, to prove, or illustrate this topic, would be an affront to the common understanding of mankind. The sum of what we can know of him is, that he is good, essentially good. We are not more assured of the existence of the first being, than that he is good, *the* good, goodness itself, in eminence. He is God, because he is good; which is the meaning of the word in *english*, and in many other languages. This, in God almighty, is the attribute of attributes, the perfection of his all-perfect nature. He made and maintains those creatures which he multiply'd to an infinite degree, the objects of his care and beneficence; those great characters of supreme love, that render him deservedly adorable.

All possible perfections, both moral and natural, must needs be inherent in this first and supreme being, because from him alone they can flow. This is in one comprehensive word, what we call good. But good unexercis'd, unemploy'd, incommunicate, is no good, and implies a contradiction, when

affirmed of the all-good being. Therefore it undeniably follows, there never was a time, never can be, when God was useless, and did not communicate of his goodness.

But there was a time before creation, before this beautiful fabric of the world was made, before even chaos itself, or the production of the rude matter, of which the world was made. And this time must be affirmed, not only as to material creation, but to that of angels and spiritual beings. Reckon we never so many ages, or myriads of ages, for the commencement of creation, yet it certainly began, and there was a time before that beginning. For, by the definition, creation is bringing that into being which was not before. There must have been a time before it.

Here then occurs the difficulty, of filling up that infinite gap before creation. Consider the supreme first being sitting in the center of an universal solitude, environ'd with the abyss of infinite nothing, a chasm of immense vacuity! what words can paint the greatness of the solecism? what mind does not start at the horror of such an absurdity? and especially supposing this state subsisted from infinite ages.

'Tis in vain to pretend, that a being of all perfections can be happy in himself, in the consciousness of those perfections, whilst he does no good to any thing; in the reflexive idea of his possessing all excellency, whilst he exerts no tittle of any one. This is the picture of a being quite dissonant to that of the All-good. And as the Druids would, without difficulty, judge, that there must needs be one, only, self-originated first being, the origin of all things: so they would see the necessity of admitting one or more eternal beings, or emanations from that first being, in a manner quite distinct from creation.

That there ever was one eternal, self-existent, unoriginated being, is the very first and most necessary truth, which the human mind can possibly, by contemplation and ratiocination, obtain. Still by considering the matter intimately, they would find it impossible to conceive, that there should ever be a time, when there was but one being in the universe, which we call the first and self-originated being, possessing in himself all possible perfections, and remaining for endless myriads of ages, torpid, unactive, solitary, useless. This is a notion so abhorrent to reason, so contrary to the

nature of goodness, so absolutely absurd, that we may as well imagine this great being altogether absent, and that there was no being at all.

This all the philosophers were sensible of, for good unexercis'd, that always lay dormant, never was put into act, is no goodness; it may as well be supposed absent, and even that there was no God. To imagine that God could be asleep all this while, shocks the mind, therefore it casts about, to remedy this great paradox.

Now it cannot be said of any part of creation, or of the whole, that God always did good to any created being or beings; for these are not, cannot be commensurate in time with his own being. Count backward never so long for the beginning of things, still there was a time prior to this beginning of things; for eternal creation is an equal absurdity with an eternal absence of any being: where no part is necessary, to affirm the whole is a necessarily and self-existing being, is a mere portent of reason.

So we see, in every light, an absolute necessity of admitting a being or beings coeval with the supreme and self-originated being, distinct from any creation, and which must needs flow from the first being, the cause of all existence. For two self-originated beings is as much an absurdity as any of the preceding.

But, as 'tis impossible that the act of creation should be coeval with the first being, what other act of goodness can be? For that being which is essentially good, must ever have been actively and actually so. To answer this great question, we must thus expostulate, as the prophet *Isaiah* does in the person of God, in his last chapter, when summing up the business of his prophetic office: "Shall I bring to the birth, and not beget, saith *Jehovah*: shall I cause to bring forth, and be myself barren, saith thy God?" He is there speaking of the birth of the son of God in human form; but we may apply it in a more eminent degree, to the son of God in his divine nature; and as the Druids may well be suppos'd to have done. The highest act of goodness which is possible, even for the supreme being, is the production of his like, the act of filiation, the begetting of his son, *Prov.* viii. 22. "The LORD begat me *from eternity*, before his works of old;" (so it ought to be read) *ver.* 30. "then I was by him, as one *brought up* with him (*amoun* in the original) and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him."

This is the internal divine fecundity of the fruitful cause of all things. Creation is external fecundity. The Druids would naturally apply the term generation, to this act of producing this person, or divine emanation from the supreme, which we are oblig'd to admit of: and to affirm him coeval with the supreme. The difficulty of priority in time, between father and son, would easily be remov'd, by considering the difference between divine and human generation, the production of necessary and contingent beings.

If an artist produces an admirable and curious piece of mechanism, he is said to make it; if he produces a person or being altogether like himself, he is rightly said to generate that person; he begets a son, 'tis an act of filiation. So the like we must affirm of the supreme being generating another being, with whom only he could communicate of his goodness from all eternity, and without any beginning; or, in scripture language, *in whom he always had complacency*. This is what *Plato* means, "by love being ancients than all the gods; that the kingdom of love is prior to the kingdom of necessity." And this son must be a self-existent, all-perfect being, equally as the father, self-origination only excepted, which the necessary relation or oeconomy between them forbids. If he is a son, he is like himself; if he is like himself, he is God; if he is God, an eternity of existence is one necessary part of his divine nature and perfection.

If the son be of the same substance and nature as the father, an eternity of being is one part of his nature; therefore no time can be assign'd for this divine geniture, and it must be what we call eternal. Or perhaps we may express it as well by saying, it was before eternity; or that he is coeval with the almighty father. In this same sense *Proclus de patriarch.* uses the word προαιώνιος, *præeternus*. For tho' 'tis impossible that creation, whether of material or immaterial beings, should be coeval with God; yet, if the son be of the same nature with the father, which must be granted, then 'tis impossible to be otherwise, than that the son of God should be coeval with the father.

If goodness be, as it were, the essence of God, then he can have no happiness but in the exercise of that goodness. We must not say, as many are apt to do, that he was always and infinitely happy, in reflecting upon his own being and infinite perfections, in the idea of himself. This is no exercise of goodness, unless we allow this idea of himself which he produces, to be a being without him, or distinct from himself; and that is

granting what we contend for. A true and exact idea of himself is the *logos* of the ancients, the first-born of the first cause. And this is the meaning of what the eastern and all other philosophers assert, “that it was necessary for unity to make an evolution of itself, and multiply; it was necessary for good to communicate itself. There could be no time before then, for then he would be an imperfect unity, and may as well be termed a cypher, which of itself can never produce any thing.” Agreeable to this doctrine, *Philo in II. de monarchiis*, writes, “the *logos* is the express image of God, and by whom all the whole world was made.” It would be senseless to think here, he meant only the wisdom of the supreme, the reason, the cunning of God, a quality, not a personality.

What difficulty here is in the thing, arises merely from the weakness of our conceptions, and in being conversant only with ordinary generation. A son of ours is of the same nature as his father. His father was begat in time, therefore the son the like. Not so in divine generation. But as the father is from eternity, so is the son. This only difference there is, or rather distinction; the father is self-existent, and unoriginate; the son is of the father.

Further, we must remove, in this kind of reasoning, all the imperfection of different sexes, as well as time, which is in human generations; and all such gross ideas incompatible with the most pure and perfect divine nature. The whole of this our reasoning further confirms, that the son is necessarily existing. It was necessary for God to be actively good always, and begetting his son was the greatest act of divine goodness, and the first, necessarily. But the word *first* is absurd, betraying our own imperfection of speech and ideas, when we treat of these matters; for there could be no *first*, where no beginning. And the very names of father and son are but relative and oeconomical; so far useful, that we may be able to entertain some tolerable notion in these things, so far above our understanding.

But tho’ it be infinitely above our understanding, yet we reach so far, as to see the necessity of it. And we can no otherwise cure that immense *vacuum*, that greatest of all absurdities, the indolence and uselessness of the supreme being, before creation. And all this the Druids might, and I may venture to say, did arrive at, by ratiocination. And we can have no difficulty of admitting it, if we do but suppose, there were obscure notions of such being the nature of the deity, handed down from the beginning of the world.

Whence in *Chronicon Alexandrinum*, *Malala*, and other authors, we read, for instance, “in those times (the most early) among the *Egyptians* reigned, of the family of *Misraim*, *Sesosiris*, that is, the branch or offspring of *Osiris*, a man highly venerable for wisdom, who taught, there were three greatest energies or persons in the deity, which were but one.” This man was *Lud*, or *Thoth*, son of *Misraim* or *Osiris*, and for this reason, when idolatry began, he was consecrated by the name of *Hermes*, meaning one of those divine energies, which we call the Holy Spirit.

This is a short and easy account of that knowledge which the ancients had of the nature of the deity, deduc’d from reason in a contemplative mind, and which certainly was known to all the world from the beginning, and rightly call’d a mystery. For our reason is strong enough to see the necessity of admitting this doctrine, but not to see the manner. The *how* of an eternal generation is only to be understood by the deity itself.

The Druids would pursue this notion from like reasoning a little further, in this manner. Tho’ from all that has been said, there is a necessity of admitting an eternal generation, yet the person so generated, all-perfect God, does not multiply the deity itself, tho’ he is a person distinct from his father. For addition or subtraction is argument of imperfection, a thing not to be affirmed of the nature of the deity. They would therefore say, that tho’ these two, the father and the son, are different divine personalities, yet they cannot be called two Gods, or two godheads; for this would be discerping the deity or godhead, which is equally absurd and wicked.

That mankind did formerly reason in this wise, is too notorious to need my going about formally to prove it. ’Tis not to be controverted; very many authors have done it substantially. And when there was such a notion in the world, our Druids, who had the highest fame for theological studies, would cultivate it in some such manner as I have deliver’d, by the mere strength of natural reason. Whether they would think in this manner *ex priori*, I cannot say; but that they did so think, we can need no weightier an argument than the operose work of *Abury* before us; for nought else could induce men to make such a stamp, such a picture of their own notion, as this stupendous production of labour and art.

As our western philosophers made a huge picture of this their idea, in a work of three miles’ extent, and, as it were, shaded by the interposition of

divers hills; so the more eastern sages who were not so shy of writing, yet, chose to express it in many obscure and enigmatic ways. *Pythagoras*, for instance, affirmed, the original of all things was from unity and an infinite duality. *Plutarc. de plac. philos.* *Plato* makes three divine authors of all things, the first or supreme he calls king, the good. Beside him, he names the cause, descended from the former; and between them he names *dux*, the leader, or at other times he calls him the *mind*. Just in the same manner, the *Egyptians* called them *father, mind, power*. Therefore *Plato*, in his VIth epistle, writing to *Hermias* and his friends, to enter into a most solemn oath, directs it to be made before “God the leader or prince of all things, both that are, and that shall be; and before the Lord, the father of that leader or prince; and of the cause: all whom, says he, we shall know manifestly, if we philosophize rightly, as far as the powers of good men will carry us.” And in *Timæus* he makes MIND to be the son of GOOD, and to be the more immediate architect of the world. And in *Epinomis* he writes, “the most divine LOGOS or WORD made the world,” the like as *Philo* wrote; which is expressly a christian verity.

’Tis not to be wonder’d at, that the ancients wrap’d up this doctrine in an abstruse and symbolic way of speaking, of writing, and in hieroglyphic characters and works, as we have seen. It was communicated to them in the same manner; they did not, could not comprehend it any more than we, but they held it as a precious depositum of sacred wisdom.

We may therefore make this deduction from what has been said, that the christian doctrine of distinct personalities in the deity, is so far from being contrary to reason, as some would have it, or above human reason as others, that ’tis evidently deducible therefrom, at least highly agreeable thereto, when seriously propos’d to our reason. And when most undoubtedly the ancients had such a notion, even from the creation, those minds that were of a contemplative turn, would embrace it and cultivate it, as being the most exalted knowledge we are capable of. Of such a turn were our Druids, as all accounts agree.

CHAP. XVI.

Of the third species of patriarchal temples, form'd in the resemblance of a circle and wings. A description of one of this sort on the banks of the Humber in Lincolnshire. A very remarkable sort of barrows there, like to beds. This figure of the alate circle, the Egyptians call'd by the name of CNEPH; authors mistake in telling us it was the name of God. 'Tis indeed the symbol of the third divine emanation from the supreme, call'd the anima mundi. CNEPH is an oriental word, from canaph, to fly, עָנַף. The entire symbol, circle, snake and wings, was call'd CNEPHPTHA. Ptha more particularly meant the serpent, or symbol of the second divine person. The supreme, they held to be ineffable, as well as invisible, therefore symboliz'd him by the circle. The Neptune of the Greeks deriv'd from CNEPH, עָנַף dunia, a circle added to Cneph, is circulus alatus. He was president of the waters, from Gen. i. 2. and the divine spirit moved upon the face of the waters. Hence this temple set on the edge of the Humber. Of the Egyptian Canopus. Another of these alate temples on Navestock-common in Essex. The word ganaph preserv'd in the name of the town. Knave, gnavus and knap, a teutonic word, all from the hebrew. Mr. Toland mentions an alate temple of the Druids in the hebrid islands, but does not altogether understand it. Of Abaris the hyperborean Druid, a friend of Pythagoras's. That the directive virtue of the magnetic needle was known anciently. The bed barrows on the Humber banks explain'd. A metaphysical disquisition concerning the Druids' knowledge of a third emanation or divine person, from the supreme; a truth agreeable to reason. This was the Mercury of the ancients, as well as Neptune. The names which the Druids gave to the three divine persons. Conclusion. They were in effect Christians.

WHEN I wrote my *Itinerary*, I travelled a good deal of the *Hermen-street* road, and the *Foss* road, having Mr. *Samuel Buck* in my company. At that

time I engag'd him to take in hand the work, which he has so laudably pursued, and sav'd the remembrance of innumerable antiquities in our island, by that collection of elegant prints which he has publish'd. When we were on the banks of the *Humber*, the name of *Barrow* invited my curiosity, and it was fully answer'd, by finding that most noble antiquity there of the old Druids, upon the *marsh*, call'd *Humbers castle*.

A rivulet rises near the town of *Barrow*, and when it falls off the high ground, and enters on the level marshes on the [Humber](#) shore, it turns a mill. Just there, upon the edge of the marsh, upon a gentle eminence, nearly overflow'd by high spring-tides, and between the salt and fresh water, is the work we are to speak of, made of great banks of earth thrown up, in an odd manner, which gives it the denomination of castle. I observ'd all about it, and in the adjacent marshes, many long *tumuli* of different sizes, but all of a particular shape, such as I had never seen elsewhere, being form'd like a bed. I immediately set to work in digging into several of them, and we found burnt bones, ashes, bits of urns, and such kind of matters, all extremely rotten and decay'd; and the very same appearances as I had so often seen, in digging the barrows about *Stonehenge* and *Abury*.

This satisfied me that the work must belong to the most ancient inhabitants of the island, notwithstanding its unusual form. And when I attentively consider'd those banks, and made a plan of them, I was very agreeably surpriz'd in discovering the purport and meaning, which was to represent the *circulus alatus* or winged circle, an ancient hieroglyphic well known to those more particularly conversant with *Egyptian* monuments; and what they rightly call the symbol of the *anima mundi*, or *spirit pervading the universe*; in truth, the divine spirit.

I had no hesitation in adjudging this to be a temple of our Druids. All reasons imaginable concurr'd. Tho' instead of stones, they have made this work with mounds of earth; I suppose for want of stones, lying on the surface of the ground. It makes the third kind of the Druid temples which I proposed to describe. The vertical line of it is north-east and south-west, the upper part being directly north-east; and the barrows generally conform to this line, being either upon it, or at right angles with it; the head of the barrow sometimes one way, sometimes the other.

The circle was 120 cubits in diameter. The wings 100 cubits broad, 150 long; but the eastern wing was more extended than the other. For the design of it is somewhat in perspective, as 'tis sometimes seen on *Egyptian* antiquities.

This very extraordinary work, which I could not sufficiently admire, has very often entertain'd my thoughts. We see an uniformity in human nature throughout all ages. We build our churches, especially cathedrals, in a cross, the symbol or cognizance of Christianity; the first builders of churches did it in the symbol of the deity, which was pictur'd out with great judgment, and that (most likely) from the beginning of the world.

The circle and wings was the picture of the deity, which the old *Egyptian* hierophants call'd C N E P H. As there were three varieties in this figure, so they had more names than one for it, I mean the whole figure, the circle, serpent, and wings. And sometimes they used one word, sometimes another, and sometimes conjoin'd them. *Eusebius* in *pr. ev.* III. 3. writes, "that the *Egyptians* painted God, whom they call'd *Kneph*, like a man in a blue garment, holding a circle and serpent (not scepter, for no such figure ever appears) and on his head, feathers or wings." Now this very figure is seen on the portals of the *Persian* temple of *Chilminar*. Authors are not sufficiently accurate in these matters, for want of a more perfect knowledge of them. *Cneph* is properly the alate circle; yet sometimes they call the whole figure by that name. So a feather or two, or wings, are often plac'd on the heads of the *Egyptian* deities; but the picture above-mention'd at *Chilminar* has the wings, as more commonly, annexed to the circle.

Phtha was another name of one of these figures, which they sometimes join'd to the preceding, and made the word *Cnepththa*. *Kircher* erroneously calls it *Hemptha*; for before him *Iamblichus* err'd in calling *Cneph*, *Emeph*. *Strabo* calls *Cneph*, *Cnuphis*, and says his temple was at *Syene*, XVII. Undoubtedly a temple some way of this form. *Athenagoras* in *Eroticis* VI. calls him Κνεφαίος, *Cnepheus*; and says, "he can't be seen by our eyes, nor comprehended by our mind." *Hesychius*, and the etymologist *Suidas*, voce κνεφους, interpret the word, *obscure, hidden, not to be seen or understood*. *Iamblichus* and *Proclus* the like, who make *Amûn* and *Phtha* the same, *Prov.* viii. 30. The truth is, the word *Cneph* comes from the *hebrew* עָנַף *ganaph* *volare*, to *fly*, עָנַף a wing, *Psal.* xviii. 11. *He rode upon the cherubim, and did fly*.

Phtha, in *Suidas* called φθάς, is deriv'd, on the authority of *Kircher* and *Huetius*, from the *hebrew* פתח the same as the *greek* word πειθω, to *persuade*, *suada* in *latin*. It regards more particularly the serpent, the emblem of eloquence, and the divine WORD. In *Arabic* it signifies the son. So that *Cnephta* means the entire figure, the circle, snake and wings. The supreme had no name. They held him ineffable, as well as invisible. Whence they call'd the *Jehovah* of the jews an uncertain or unknown deity, or the deity without a name. *Herodotus in Euterpe* writes, "he heard from the priests of *Dodona*, that the ancient *Pelasgians* made their prayers and sacrifices to the deity without any name or surname, for at that time they knew none." *Iamblichus's* interpretation of *Phtha* is very little different. He says, "It signifies him that performs all things in truth, and without lying." The *Egyptians* called this *Phtha Vulcan*, and say, he was the son of the supreme God; whom *Cicero* makes the guardian god of *Egypt*, who was the author of all the philosophy of the *Egyptians*, according to *Diogenes Laertius in proem*. And this is that most ancient deity of the *Egyptians* who was particularly design'd by the serpent. And hence the fables of the *greeks* make *Vulcan* the only son of *Juno*, without the help of her husband. Again, they make *Pallas* produc'd out of *Jupiter's* brain, who wore the *Ægis* or snaky breast-plate, which originally was no other than our great prophylactic hierogramma, the circle and snake, us'd by the most ancient warriors as a sacred preservative. *Medusa's* head is the very same, a circle, wings, and snakes. But the delicate *greeks* new drest it, and made the circle into a beautiful face, more agreeable to their taste of things. And its turning men into stones means, at the bottom, nothing but the making our serpentine temples in that form by the first heroes, who bore this cognizance in their shields.

But to return to CNEPH, the deity to whom these winged temples are dedicate. It became the chief and more famous name. Whence *Porphyry* in *Eusebius's pr. ev. III. 11.* calls this *Cneph* the creator, *Plutarch, de Is. & Os.* testifies, "the inhabitants in *Thebais*, or the remotest part of *Egypt*, worshipped only the eternal God *Cneph*, and paid nothing toward the charge of idolatrous worship in the other parts of that kingdom." Thus we see, those countries farthest separated from the busy part of the world, such as *Thebais* and *Britain*, retain'd the pure and ancient religion: which bishop *Cumberland* too asserts, *Sanchon. p. 15. of Thebais*, before *Abraham's* time. *Strabo* says, "there was a temple of *Cnuphis* (as he writes it) at *Syene*,

the farther part of *Thebais*:" which must be understood of one of our winged temples originally, tho' probably afterwards built upon, cover'd, and become idolatrous. "Hence the *Ethiopians*, neighbours to those of *Thebais*, living still in the upper regions of *Egypt*," says *Strabo*, "worship two gods, the one the immortal creator, the other mortal, who has no name, nor is easily to be apprehended." Here we find they have a notion of the supreme and his son. Their opposite neighbours across the *red sea*, worshipped only two gods, τὸν Διὸν καὶ τὸν Διονύσου, *Jovem & Jovem Nysæum*, God, and the God of *Nysa*. This is what is meant by the two principles of *Pythagoras*, mention'd by *Plutarch de plac. philos.* unity and indefinite duality, the sacred *Dyas* of *Plato*. Whence *Diodorus* in his I. writes, "that the *Egyptians* declar'd there were two first eternal Gods." These they express'd by the names of *unity* and *duality*. I do not believe that they found this out by their own understanding and reasoning, but had it from patriarchal tradition. And then their own reasoning would confirm it. For it is altogether agreeable to reason, arguing from the fecundity of the first cause. The *Greeks* turned *Cneph* into their *Neptune*, the sovereign of the waters, from what the *hebrew* legislator writes in the beginning of his *cosmogony*; "and the spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters." The word *Neptune* comes from *Cneph* and דּוּנְיָ *Dunia, orbis, circulus*, the winged circle. And this probably will give us some light into the reason, why we find our winged temple of *Barrow* upon the banks of that noble æstuary, the *Humber*. I wonder'd indeed how it should come about, that the *Druids* should so studiously place this work under the verge of the high land, and upon the brink of the salt marsh; so that every high tide washes or overflows the skirts of it, whilst the freshwater brook runs close under it. At this time it must have presented them with the agreeable picture of the sacred hieroglyphic, hovering over both fresh and salt-water.

I observ'd a line, or little bank and ditch, cast up above our figure, which I judg'd to be done with an intent to keep off the inundation of the ocean at the times of sacrifice, which seems to have been perform'd within that inclos'd area, where I have set the figure of the compass in the engraven view. Likewise just without that line, eastward, I remarked three little square plots, which perhaps were habitations of the *Druids* who were keepers of the temple.

'Tis not from the purpose to take notice of one of the greatest fix'd stars of the heavens, at the bottom of the constellation call'd the *ship*, having the name of *Canopus*, which is no other than our word *Cneph*. This star had this name given it by the *Egyptians*, as appearing to them just above the edge of the southern horizon. And in their spheres, we may very well presume, they painted it as a winged circle, and because it always appear'd as hovering over the horizon or great ocean.

—————*O numen aquarum*
Proxima cui cælo cessit, Neptune, potestas. Ov. Met. IV.

So that originally the ancients understood the spirit or soul of the universe, or more properly the divine spirit, by this figure which they call'd KNEPH, which the *European* nations call'd *Neptune*, sovereign of the waters. So often by the poets call'd Ενοσιχθων, Ενοσιγαιων, the *shaker of the earth*; for the waters in *Moses* means the *Hyle*, or moist matter of chaos whence the universe was made.

Two of the quarterly solemnities or general sacrifices of the Druids were on the two equinoxes, when are the highest tides. A curious observer being upon the spot, for some years together, at these times, might possibly make some notable discovery concerning the difference of the surface of the sea, since the current of 5 or 6000 years: for I persuade myself this temple was made by the very first inhabitants of the isle, and not long after the flood, on account of the interment here of some great hero, that advanc'd so far in peopling the country. And if our reasonings and testimonies hitherto be any whit agreeable to truth, we may point out the species of many of these most ancient temples built at the place of sepulture of heroes, spoken of in writings of those times. For instance, we infer a serpentine temple was made by the *tumulus* of *Orpheus*, from the fable of a serpent offering to devour his head, which serpent was turn'd into stone.

Hic ferus expositum peregrinis anguis arenis
Os petit, & sparsos stillanti rore capillos
Lambit, & hymniferos inhiat divellere vultus.
Tandem Phæbus adest, morsusque inferre parentem
Congelat, & patulos, ut erant, indurat hiatus.

Again, we may reasonably suppose that an alate temple was built by the tomb of *Memnon*, said to be buried in *Phrygia*, who was turn'd into a bird on the funeral pile, at the request of his mother *Aurora*. We see some hints of it even from *Ovid*'s telling the story. This was done at the request of his mother *Aurora*, who petitions *Jupiter* for this favour to her son, for herself she desires none. Thus she begins:

Omnibus inferior, quas sustinet aureus æther
(*Nam mihi sunt totum rarissima templa per orbem,*)
Diva tamen venio: non ut delubra, diesque
Des mihi sacrificos, caliturasque ignibus aras, &c.

He was turn'd into a bird, and a flock of the same birds, call'd *Aves Memnoniæ*, arose from the same funeral pile, which immediately divided into two companies, and fought till they destroy'd each other. And that a like flight of the same birds came on the same day every year from *Ethiopia*, went thrice round his monument, and then divided and fought in honour of their ancestor.

What can we understand by this, but an assembly of his people and descendants to celebrate his anniversary, as was the custom of antiquity toward great men. The story is entirely of a piece with that told of *Cadmus*, and must be interpreted in the same way.

In this sense we are treating of, are we to understand authors when they tell us, that *Cadmus* built a temple to *Neptune* in the island of *Rhodes*. This was not a cover'd temple with elegant pillars, nor an idolatrous one, which were matters of after-times; but one of our alate temples. *Phut* had built a *Dracontium* there before.

Antoninus Liberalis XII. speaks of the lake *Canopus*, which I suppose had its name from a *Cneph* or alate temple near it, built by a hero, *Cygnus*, son of *Phut*, "who, the fable says, was turn'd into a bird there," and *Phylius* his sepulchral monument was by it.

In this sense, *Strabo* II. speaks of *Hercules* being call'd *Canopeus*, from building such a temple. And we may now understand that hitherto abstruse *Egyptian* antiquity called *Canopus*, a vase which they us'd for preserving of water in their temples and in their families, with a cover to it. In order to insure the blessing of heaven to this most necessary element, they

frequently consign'd it with the sacred prophylactic character of the *Kneph* or *circulus alatus*, which is the greek *Neptune*, the *dominator aquarum*. Many of these vases are still remaining in the cabinets of antiquarians. Such a one pictur'd in *Kircher*.

And, by the by, I may mention that some of these vases are adorn'd with a *scarabeus* with expanded wings, and this is entirely of the same meaning as the alate circle. But this is not a place to discourse larger on these matters.

I suspect *Geneva* and *Geneffa* have their names from such temples. As *Gnaphalus* a bird mention'd by *Aristotle*. *Simias* the *Rhodian* celebrates our *Cneph*, in his poem compos'd in the form of wings: as the author of motion and creation: hence the word *Nebula*, νεφέλη and perhaps *Nebulo*.

In the year 1725, the next year after I found out this *Humber* temple, and the last year of my travels, I found another of these alate temples, on *Navestock-common* in *Essex*, which seems to be of a later date than the other, and when perhaps the original doctrine concerning these theological speculations was somewhat forgotten; Because this temple is situate on a dry common, not near water; but the figure is the very same.

What is exceedingly remarkable as to this noble antiquity on *Navestock-common*, is, that the name should remain to this time, and which confirms all that we said before concerning them, as to their name and meaning: for *Navestock* must have been so call'd from some old and remarkable tree, probably an oak, upon or by the C N E P H, or winged temple; *Navestock*. Our *English* word *Knave*, which had no ill meaning at first, signifies the same thing, *alatus*, *impiger*; the latin word *Gnavus* the very same: and *Knap* a *Teutonical* word the like: all from the hebrew original.

I doubt not, but there are more such temples in the *Britannick* isles, called *Knave-castles* or the like. One I remember to have seen, on a great heathy common, by the *Roman Watling-street* in *Staffordshire*. And Mr. *Toland* takes notice of a winged temple of our Druids in the *Hebrid* or *Hyperborean* islands, *Shetland*. *Abaris* a Druid of this country, fir'd with a desire of knowledge, travell'd into *Greece* where philosophy flourish'd; after that to *Pythagoras* in *Italy*, and became his favourite disciple. *Pythagoras* imparted to him his best notions in philosophy, which perhaps, in the enigmatical way of those times, they call the shewing to him his

golden thigh. *Abaris* on the other hand, presented to *Pythagoras* *Apollo's* arrow, which he brought out of his own country, where it had been deposited in a winged temple. They tell you further, that *Abaris* rode on this arrow in the air to *Greece*. This undoubtedly would proceed from the notion they entertain'd of the Druids practising magick.

I cannot help thinking, after what I have said in *Stonehenge*, concerning the magnetick needle, that this arrow of *Apollo's* which *Abaris* made use of in his journey from *Shetland* to *Greece*, was an instrument of this sort, which the *Hyperborean* sage gave to *Pythagoras*. And the Druids possessing such a secret as this, would reciprocally create, and favour that notion of their practising magick. Calling it *Apollo's* arrow seems to throw the possession of it up to *Phut* the most famous navigator, we before treated of: nay it seems that we may trace it still higher, even to *Noah* himself. *Sanchoniathon* the *Phœnician* writer tells us, among other remarkable things concerning *Ouranus*, who is certainly *Noah*, "that he devised *Bætulia*, or contriv'd stones that mov'd as having life."

Besides the interpretation, we may very naturally affix to this account, of anointed stones or main ambres: we may well judge that the knowledge of the magnet is here understood; which at first they placed in a little boat, in a vessel of water, and then it would move itself, 'till directed to the quarters of the heavens. *Atheneus Deipnosoph.* affirms, that *Hercules* borrow'd his golden cup wherewith he sail'd over the ocean, of *Nereus*. *Nereus* is *Japhet* eldest son of *Noah*, and the golden cup was a compass box in all probability.

Among the ancient constellations pictur'd on the celestial globe, is an arrow; said by *Eratosthenes* the most ancient writer we have on the *Catasterisms*, (as called,) to be the arrow of *Apollo*, which was laid up in the winged temple among the *Hyperboreans*. *Diodorus Siculus* from *Hecateus* and other older writers, shews, the *Hyperborean* island was in the ocean, and beyond *Gaul*, to the north, under the bear; where the people liv'd a most simple and happy life. *Orpheus* places them near the *Cronian* sea; a word purely *Irish*, as Mr. *Toland* shews, *Croin* signifying frozen. He shews further and that very largely, that the *Hebrid* islands, *Skie*, *Lewis*, *Harries*, *Shetland*, are the true *Hyperborean* islands of the ancients. Among them therefore was the winged temple; whether made of mounds of earth,

like those two on the *Humber*, and on *Navestock-common*; or made of stones like other Druid temples.

There are other Druid temples in those islands, made of stones, I shall give a print of one, in my next volume. Further there is a famous one in *Cornwall* call'd vulgarly the *Hurlers*, which I take to have been one of our alate temples, made of stones set upright.

The learned *Bayer* in his fine designs of the celestial constellations, represents the arrow of *Apollo* beforemention'd, as a magnetick needle; and he took his designs chiefly from a very ancient book of drawings. I observe likewise that the isle of *Skie*, in the language of the natives, is call'd *Scianach*, which signifies winged. And in that probably, was the winged temple we speak of; which gave name to the isle.

We mention'd before that *Phut* married *Rhode*, whence the isle of *Rhodes* had its name. *Rod* in the *Psalms* and the *Prophets* signifies a snake. Nay *Pliny* in vii. and 56, of his natural history asserts, that *Rhodes* was originally call'd *Ophiusa*, a word equivalent. Most likely they built a serpentine temple there, which gave the name. So the isle of *Tenos*, which *Bochart* shews, means a serpent in the oriental language, was call'd *Hydrusa* and *Ophiusa*. The isle of *Cyprus* was call'd *Ophiodia* by *Nicænetus*. So *Hydra* an isle just before *Carthage*, which was first built by *Cadmus*. *Ophiades insulæ* on the *Arabian* coast of the *Red-sea*. *Pausanias* mentions a place called *Opheos Cephale*, the serpent's head; the same as our *Hakpen* on *Overton-hill* in *Abury*.

In the isle of *Chios* is a famous mountain higher than the rest, called *Pelineus*, which had undoubtedly one of our great *Dracontian* temples. The learned *Bochart* I. 9. shews its name signifies the prodigious serpent: a story of the sort is annex'd to it. Nay this famous temple gave name to the whole island, for he shews that 'tis a *Syrian* word חוּיָא *Chivia* a serpent, so that *Chios* isle is the serpent's isle: the word is the same as *Hivite*: probably *Cadmus* or some of his people built it. *Hesychius* and *Phavorinus* mentions *Jupiter Pelineus*, the name of the deity worshiped.

Virgil in *Æneid* II. describes the two serpents that destroy'd *Laocoon* coming from the isle of *Tenedos*.

I described the barrows about *Humbers* castle, to be like beds. They are all long barrows, of very different lengths, higher at the head than the feet, (if we may so express it) and with a cavity the whole length of them, drawn off at the feet, to the turf: So that they represent the impression of a person that has lain on a very soft, downy couch. One which I dug into near the temple was 60 cubits long: the other two near it 40 each, [plate xxxix](#). The sight of them necessarily intruded into my mind, the εὐνή or couch of *Typhon* or *Phut*, which *Homer* says, was in *Arimis*. 'Tis natural for us to imagine, he means exactly such a *tumulus* of the hero, as these we are speaking of.

Phut was a great arch druid or patriarchal high-priest, as being the head of his family. And according to my notion of the matter, these long barrows all belong to some of the higher order of the Druids. *Eustathius* interprets *Homer's* word by that of τάφος, tomb. *Stephanus* the scholiast on *Hesiod's Theogon*, makes *Arima* a mountain in *Cilicia* or *Lydia*, where is *Tiphon's* κοιτή. V. *Oppian. Alexand.* ver. 599. *Lucan* ver. 191. *Apollon.* II. *Strabo* XVI. *Mela* I. 13. *Pausanias in Atticis* tells us of *Hippolita* the *Amazons' tumulus*, that 'twas made in shape of an *Amazonian pelta* or shield; perhaps somewhat like our *tumulus*.

In the beginning of the idolatrous times, they likewise consecrated *Hermes* the *Egyptian* into *Mercury*, but the *Egyptians* took *Mercury* in a different light from the *Canaanites*: they made him the god of divine wisdom, the *Canaanites* who were immers'd in trade and traffick, made him the god of profit and gain; and that in the person of their ancestor *Canaan*. Nevertheless they knew the holy spirit prior to idolatry: for many think that *Mercury* was no mortal man, *S. Augustin, C. D.* viii. 26. and *Orpheus* in his hymn to him, pronounces him to be of the race of *Dionysus*, by whom *Jehovah* is understood.

I suppose *Canaan* when he died, had an alate temple built about his place of sepulture, which in after times occasion'd posterity to deify him under the name of *Mercury*. Again I suppose the like done over the *tumulus* of the patriarch TARSIS; which gave a handle in idolatrous times, to consecrate him into the *Neptune* of the heathen; who in effect is the same as *Mercury*, saving that being done by people of a different genius and disposition, they divided one god into two.

Thus we have sail'd thro' a wide ocean of antiquities, and that not without a compass. We set old things transmitted to us in writing, in parallelism with these we may now see at home, in such a manner, as I think evidently shews them to be the same.

*Nec sum animi dubius, verbis ea vincere magnum
Quàm sit, & antiquis hunc addere rebus honorem.
Sed me Parnassi deserta per ardua dulcis
Raptat amor——— Virg.*

I shall conclude, with 1. what we may very well imagine to have been the ratiocination of the Druids among one another, in their theological contemplations, concerning this last kind of their works, these winged temples. Of such sort would be their speculations thereon, in their serious scrutiny into the nature of the deity.

We observ'd, the Druids in their theological studies must, with the other eastern sages, find out two ways of the supreme being exerting his almighty power, multiplying himself, as the *Zoroastrians*, the *Pythagoreans* and the *Platonists* call it, or divine geniture: and creation. The first necessary, therefore done before time; the second arbitrary, therefore done in time. Nevertheless this second was fit and proper to be done, therefore necessarily to be perform'd. For whatever becomes the allperfect being, we may pronounce necessary with him.

The Druids would advance still further in their contemplations this way, and conclude, that it became the supreme, and was therefore necessary, for him to exert his power in all possible ways and modes of acting; that he was not content in producing a single divine person or emanation from himself, from the infinite fund of his own fecundity; that he was pleas'd to proceed to that other mode of acting, which we call divine procession; or a third divine person to proceed from the first and second. This person the ancients had knowledge of, and styled him *anima mundi*, "that spirit of the LORD which filleth the world," *Wisdom* i. 7. and made him a distinct person from God, or the supreme: but, more immediately, he was the author of life to all living things. And this he disseminated throughout the whole macrocosm. I need only quote *Virgil*, for many more, in his fine poem, *Georg.* IV.

*Esse apibus partem divinæ mentis & haustus
Æthereos dixere. Deum namque ire per omnes
Terrasque tractusque maris, cælumque profundum.
Hinc pecudes, armenta, viros, genus omne ferarum,
Quemque sibi tenues nascentem arcessere vitas;
Scilicet huc reddi deinde & resoluta referri,
Omnia.—————*

This divine mind, or *anima mundi*, [the ancients pictur'd](#) out by the circle and wings, meaning the holy spirit in symbolical language, or the spirit proceeding from the fountain of divinity. And we see it innumerable times on *Egyptian*, and other ancient monuments. *Plutarch*, in his *platonick questions*, asks, “Why should *Plato* in his *Phædro* say, the nature of a wing, which mounts heavy things upward, is chiefly participant of those that are about the body of the deity?”

But thus the Druids would reason. There are three modes of divine origin and existence, quite different from creation: they are these: the self-existent, unoriginated first cause; divine generation; and divine procession: all equal in nature, self-origination excepted, and equally necessarily existent. When the supreme produces his likeness, it must be divine filiation; or the son of God is produc'd. Divine procession must be from them two: but it cannot possibly be filiation: for besides that, in these acts of the divinity, we must separate all ideas like that of human production, it would be absurd to call this generation; because, as it is done prior to all notion of time, or eternity itself; it is making the son to be son and father in the same act. Therefore there remains no other word for this, than procession from the father and son.

Whether these abstract and metaphysical notions would occur to a mind wholly unacquainted with any doctrine of this sort, may be matter of doubt; but when propos'd to a serious and contemplative genius, they would be embraced and improved, as agreeable to reason; and as an advance towards the most sublime and most useful knowledge of all others, that of the nature of the deity.

2. The very learned *Schedius*, in his treatise *de mor. germ.* XXIV. speaking of the Druids, confirms exceedingly all that we have said on this

Belenus is the *Baal* in scripture, us'd originally to be spoken of the true God *Jehovah*, 'till adopted into idolatry. *Belus* of the *Assyrians*. If we examine the word to the bottom, it means God the son. Βηλ, in the *babylonian* language is the son, Βηλτις the *daughter*. He is the *Apollo* of the *Latins*.

Tharamis is the same as *Tat*, *Thoth* of the *Egyptians*, *Thor* of the northern nations, call'd more particularly the *spirit: lord of the air*, from the wings being symbolical of him; and hence made the thunderer, from the *Phœnician* and *celtick* *Tarem*. He was sometimes call'd *Theutates*, the *Mercury* of the *Latins*, who was particularly worshipped by the *Germans*, says *Tacitus de mor. germ. Cæsar* the same, VI. *bell. gall.* Hence the *Greeks* dress'd their *Mercury* with a winged cap, and winged heels, which was no other than the *circulus alatus* we have been speaking of. He bears a staff in his hand, with a globe on the end of it with wings and snakes. The *Phœnicians* call'd him *Taautus*. *Sanchoniathon*, *Varro* IV. *de ling. lat.*

So in the temple of *Belus* or the *sun*, at *Edessa* in *Mesopotamia*, in idolatrous times, by his statue was another of *Ezizus*, who is our *Hesus*, and another of *Mercury*, whom they call *Monimus*. *Julian*, in his *hymn to the sun*, mentions the same. And so generally the true theology communicated to mankind from the beginning, was perverted into polytheism and idolatry.

3. So by the tree came death, by the tree came life, which the *Druids* seem to have had some knowledge of. *Ruffinus* II. 29. affirms the cross among the *Egyptians* was an hieroglyphic importing the life that is to come. *Sozomen* the same, *hist. eccl.* VII. 15. and *Suidas*. *Isidore* tells, "it was the method of the muster-masters in the *roman* army, in giving in the lists of the soldiers, to mark with a cross the name of the man that was alive; with a Θ him that was dead."

The ancient inhabitants of *America* honour'd the form of the cross. So the conjurers in *Lapland* use it. Which intimate this hieroglyphic to be most ancient, probably antediluvian.

But concerning the knowledge of the cross which the *Druids* had, and of their religion more at large, I shall discourse fully in the next volume, which will conclude what I have to say concerning them and their works.

4. From what has been delivered in the speculative part of this treatise, the springs of idolatry appear sufficiently. For the race of heroes that built these patriarchal temples in the eastern part of the world especially, and propagated true religion, were some ages after deify'd by their idolatrous posterity; and had names of consecration taken from the divine attributes, and the just notions delivered to them concerning the nature of the deity.

5. If then we reflect on the foregoing description of the work of *Abury*, whether we consider the figure it is built upon, the antiquity or the grandeur of it, we must needs admire it, as deservedly to be rank'd among the greatest wonders on the face of the earth. The ancients indeed did make huge temples of immense pillars in colonnades, like a small forest; or vast concaves of cupolas to represent the heavens; they made gigantick colosses to figure out their gods; but to our *British* Druids was reserv'd the honour of a more extensive idea, and of executing it. They have made plains and hills, valleys, springs and rivers contribute to form a temple of three miles in length. They have stamp'd a whole country with the impress of this sacred character, and that of the most permanent nature. The golden temple of *Solomon* is vanish'd, the proud structure of the *Babylonian Belus*, the temple of *Diana* at *Ephesus*, that of *Vulcan* in *Egypt*, that of the *Capitoline Jupiter* are perish'd and obliterated, whilst *Abury*, I dare say, older than any of them, within a very few years ago, in the beginning of this century, was intire; and even now, there are sufficient traces left, whereby to learn a perfect notion of the whole. Since I frequented the place, I fear it has suffer'd: but at that time, there was scarce a single stone in the original ground-plot wanting, but I could trace it to the person then living who demolish'd it, and to what use and where.

This I verily believe to have been a truly patriarchal temple, as the rest likewise, which we have here described; and where the worship of the true God was perform'd. And I conclude with what *Epiphanius* writes, speaking of the old religion from the beginning of the world. *Non erat judaismus aut secta quæpiam alia: sed ut ita dicam, ea quæ nunc in præsentī sancta Dei catholica ecclesia obtinet, fides erat; quæ cum ab initio extiterit, postea rursum est manifestata.* He affirms *Adam* and all the patriarchs from him to *Abraham*, were no other than christians; and this is the doctrine of the apostle of the *Gentiles*, 1 *Cor.* ix. 21.

I N D E X.

The dignity of the study of antiquities, Page [1](#), [46](#)
Religion the principal purpose of life, [6](#), [7](#), [55](#), [85](#), [100](#)
The patriarchal and Christian religion the same, [4](#), [6](#), [62](#), [68](#), [89](#), [102](#)
Publick religion began with Adam's grandson, Enos, [2](#), [6](#)
Exercis'd in a publick place call'd a temple, [3](#), [7](#), [25](#)
A temple was an open circle of stones, [4](#), [8](#)
Groves planted as cathedrals, summer-temples, [4](#), [5](#)
*Groves and temples equivocal, *ibid.**
The Druid temples were patriarchal, [4](#), [5](#), [102](#)
Heathen remains of patriarchal temples, [5](#), [8](#), [33](#), [52](#), [83](#)
Our patriarchal round temples often dedicated to the sun, [9](#), [67](#)
Likewise to dead heroes who built them, [13](#), [84](#), [95](#), [98](#), [101](#)
Publick religion was on a stated day, the sabbath, [6](#), [36](#), [68](#)
Heathen remains of the sabbath, [68](#)
The ordinary service of publick religion was call'd invoking, [3](#), [4](#), [6](#)
Heathen remains of invoking, [4](#), [6](#)
This implies an expected mediator, Messiah, [3](#), [6](#)
Jehovah was the Messiah who appear'd visibly, [3](#), [6](#)
Knowledge of the nature of the deity, the highest wisdom, [7](#), [85](#), [90](#)
From that knowledge idolatry first began, [62](#), [84](#), [89](#), [101](#)
Sacrificing was the extraordinary service of religion, [4](#), [38](#)
At the four solar ingresses, [68](#)
Temples were form'd on figures of the symbol of the deity, [8](#), [9](#), [92](#)
Whence thought prophylactic, to guard the ashes of the dead, [41](#), [52](#), [82](#), [95](#)
*When desecrated to idolatry, the Mosaic tabernacle was order'd;
square and cover'd, [3](#), [5](#), [8](#), [14](#), [24](#), [62](#), [72](#)*

Three kinds of Druid or patriarchal temples, from the threefold symbol
of the deity. First, the circle, [9](#)
The circle, the symbol of the Supreme, [54](#), [61](#)
The Supreme, as invisible, had no picture, no name, [3](#), [50](#), [62](#), [98](#)
Called As, Atys, Hesus, by the Druids, [100](#)
Rowldrich temple described, as an example of the first kind, [10](#)
The requisites of a Druid temple drawn up, [10](#), [13](#)

The Second kind of temple, the circle and snake, Dracontium, [9](#), [54](#)
ABURY, a serpentine temple of the second kind, described, [14](#)
Another at Shap in Northumberland, [62](#)
Another at Classerness, *ibid.*
Of the symbol of the snake, [49](#), [54](#), [56](#), [92](#)
It means the divine Son, [55](#), [60](#), [61](#), [62](#), [93](#), [94](#)
The Druids' great regard to it, [56](#)
The natural history of the serpent, [50](#), [57](#)
Origin of serpent worship, [59](#)
Of symbols in general, [55](#)
It was the ancient form of writing, [56](#)
The divine Son call'd Phtha, νοῦς ἕτερος, mind, creator, wisdom,
word, Logos, [50](#), [61](#), [62](#), [88](#)
He was Jehovah, the Mediator, who appeared visibly, [3](#)
He was called the NAME, [3](#), [6](#), [100](#)
Called Belenus by the Druids, [100](#)
Of the kebla or central obelisc in our temples, called ambre, [5](#), [23](#), [24](#),
[67](#), [100](#)
Became idols, [5](#), [67](#)
The petra ambrosia of the heathen, [24](#), [75](#), [82](#)
Of the cove, or ansæ, [5](#), [23](#), [100](#)
Kist vaen, [13](#)
Indicative of the divine presence, [24](#)
The Hakpen, or snake's head, [15](#), [31](#), [32](#)
Heathen remains of such, [33](#), [84](#), [97](#)
The snake's tail, [36](#), [37](#), [52](#)

*The whole symbol of the deity was a circle, snake, and wings; call'd
Cnephta, [9](#), [29](#), [54](#), [62](#), [92](#), [93](#)
Heathen remain of this in Medusa's head, [69](#), [93](#)
The Third sort of Druid temple form'd like the circle and wings, alate
temples, [9](#), [76](#), [83](#), [92](#)
This figure call'd Cneph, means the divine spirit, or anima mundi, [62](#),
[92](#), [93](#)
An alate temple of the Druids on the banks of the Humber, described,
[92](#)
An alate temple on Navestock-common, [96](#)
Another in Cornwall, [97](#)
Another in the isle of Scianach, *ibid.*
Hence the Mercury of the heathen, [84](#), [98](#), [101](#)
The same as Neptune, [84](#), [94](#), [98](#)
Same as Taranus, Thoth, [101](#)
Same as Hermes, [98](#)
Same as Canaan, *ibid.*
An alate temple over the tomb of Canaan, *ibid.*
By the lake Canopus, [96](#)
In the isle Chios, [98](#)
In the isle of Cyprus, [97](#)
At the tomb of Hermes or Lud, [98](#)
At the tomb of Memnon, [95](#)
Over the tomb of Neptune or Tarsis, [98](#)
In the isle of Rhodes, [95](#), [97](#)
In the isle of Tenos, [97](#)
The crab likewise a symbol of the anima mundi, [76](#)*

*Serpentine temples, Dracontia, built by the ancients, [9](#), [61](#)
By Phut or Typhon, son of Cham, [61](#), [63](#)
The history of Phut, [64](#)
His effigies, [66](#)
The patriarchal and heathen genealogy, [65](#)
The heroical effigies of Phut's mother, [66](#)*

Dracontia built by the Tyrian Hercules, [70](#), [75](#), [76](#)
He was a great navigator, and had the use of the compass, [97](#)
His history and time fixed, [53](#), [71](#)
He planted Britain, [53](#), [77](#), [78](#)
He was king in Egypt when Abraham went thither, [72](#)
He learn'd religion and other things from Abraham, [74](#), [76](#)
He built temples wherever he came, thence call'd Saxanus, [74](#)
He brought the use of alphabet-writing hither, [73](#)
He had a son call'd Isaac, [76](#)
Apher, grandson of Abraham, a companion of Hercules in planting
Britain, [70](#), [77](#)
Of Albion and Bergion, [77](#)

Dracontia built by Cadmus, [34](#), [80](#)
History of Cadmus son of Canaan, [79](#)
The Cadmonites related to the Jews, [84](#)
Serpentine temples at Acon, [75](#)
At Colchis, [69](#)
By Damascus, [84](#)
By the tomb of Orpheus, [95](#)
By the river Orontes, [69](#)
At Parnassus, [67](#)
In the isle of Rhodes, [95](#)
At Sarephtha, [82](#)
At Tyre, [75](#)

The Druid measure, cubit, stadium, [11](#), [19](#), [31](#)
A demonstration of the Druid works prior to roman times, [26](#), [43](#), [45](#)
A Druid celt or hatchet found at Abury, [27](#)
Another at Stonehenge, [41](#)
The time of founding Abury conjectured, [52](#)
The founder's tumulus, Silbury-hill, [41](#)
A conjecture concerning his name, [42](#)
A conjecture concerning the time of his death, [44](#)
The founder of Abury's bridle dug up, [42](#)

Antediluvian bones, [17](#), [35](#)
The formation of sarsens, [16](#)
British beads, urns, &c. dug up, [44](#), [45](#)
Heathen barrows like ours, [42](#), [44](#), [46](#), [52](#), [66](#), [98](#)
Conjecture concerning the age of Abury, from the wear of the weather, [17](#), [38](#)
From the Variation of the magnetic needle, [51](#), [52](#)
Of the use of the loadstone of old, [51](#), [96](#)
Seems to have been known to Noah, to Japhet, to Phut, to Hercules, [97](#)
*A magnetic needle among the constellations, *ibid.**

The origin of alphabet-writing, [56](#), [73](#)
The patriarchal genealogy, [65](#)
Origin of Egyptian learning from Abraham and Joseph, [72](#), [74](#)
The reason of the Mosaic institution, [8](#), [62](#), [72](#)
Of mythology, the oldest heathen history, [13](#), [31](#), [33](#), [63](#), [76](#), [83](#)
Our present reports at the Druid temples the same mythology, [5](#), [13](#), [76](#), [83](#)
Why E I inscrib'd on the door at Delphos, [100](#)
Temples made on account of sepulchres, [13](#), [41](#)
Typhon's couch, what it means, [66](#), [98](#)
The atlantic islands, where, [14](#)
Of Solomon's temple, [38](#), [39](#)
The astonishing tumulus of Silbury, [41](#), [42](#), [43](#)
Of british chariots, [42](#)
Why antient temples regarded the east, [50](#), [51](#)
Origin of animal-worship, [55](#)
Origin of the Phallus, [60](#)

The Roman road, Runway, Via Badonica, [26](#), [30](#), [32](#), [43](#)
A demonstration that 'tis later than our works, [26](#), [27](#), [43](#)
A demonstration that 'tis later than the Wansdike, [27](#)
King Divitiacus founder of Devizes, [27](#)
Cunetio Marlborough, [19](#), [26](#)

E T Y M O L O G Y.

Abl, Hal, Healle, [19](#)
Au, Aux, Awy, *ibid*
As, Ata, Atys, [100](#)
Atlas, [9](#)
Apher, [77](#)
Avim, Hevæus, [81](#), [98](#)
Athamanes, [71](#)
Belenus, Baal, Bel, Belus, [100](#)
Bratanac, [77](#)
Beth, [5](#)
Canopus, [94](#), [96](#)
Cnepththa, [93](#)
Cronius, [97](#)
Cneph, [92](#)
Cromlechen, [49](#)
Dionysus, [11](#), [98](#)
Efi, [100](#)
Esar-haddon, *ibid.*
Elohim, [71](#)
Elagabalus, [24](#)
Gilgal, [11](#)
Genessa, Geneva, Gnaphalus, Gnavus, [96](#)
Gable, Gaveloc, [9](#), [24](#), [29](#)
Hesus, [100](#)
Har, [67](#)
Hakpen, [16](#), [31](#), [32](#), [75](#), [76](#)
Hycsi, [71](#), [78](#)
Javelin, [9](#), [24](#), [25](#)
Kibla, *ibid.*
Kist-vaen, [12](#), [49](#)
Knave, Knap, [96](#)
Kneph, [62](#)

Magus, [38](#), [55](#), [69](#)
 Neptune, [94](#)
 Nebula, Nebulo, [96](#)
 Nahas, [67](#)
 Nesi, [72](#)
 Ogmius, [73](#)
 Parnassus, Larnassus, [67](#)
 Ptha, [62](#), [93](#)
 Rhwl drwyg, [11](#), [12](#)
 Rhode, Rod, [97](#)
 Sarsens, [16](#), [48](#)
 Sarephtha, [82](#)
 Scianach, [97](#)
 Taramis, Thoth, [101](#)
 Themis, [67](#)
 Titans, [71](#)
 Tempe, Temple, [7](#), [25](#)
Knowledge of the nature of the deity, the most valuable, [7](#), [85](#), [90](#), [100](#)
Of divine geniture, a metaphysical discourse, [49](#), [50](#), [85](#), [99](#)
Of divine procession, [100](#)
This doctrine is discoverable by reason, [85](#), [99](#), [100](#)
The Druids came from Phœnicia, [38](#), [42](#), [51](#), [73](#), [78](#)
The Druids were not idolaters, preface, [24](#), [51](#), [85](#)
They were a great and learned people, [38](#), [49](#), [76](#)
They were disciples of Abraham, [5](#), [35](#), [73](#), [74](#), [76](#), [85](#)
Of the patriarchal religion, [11](#), [37](#), [51](#), [55](#), [62](#), [69](#), [85](#), [102](#)
They observ'd the sabbath, [6](#), [35](#)
A proof that the patriarchs observ'd the sabbath, [68](#)
Tithe paid by the patriarchs, [68](#)
Baptism and sponsors in the patriarchal religion, [76](#)
The Druids built our temples of stones untouch'd of tool, [20](#), [21](#), [39](#)
Groves not their only temples, [5](#)
They bore a celt on a staff ordinarily, [27](#)
Abaris a hyperborean Druid, [96](#)
Chyndonax a gallic arch-druid, [49](#)
They believ'd a future state, and resurrection of the body, [13](#), [40](#), [41](#), [46](#), [82](#)

*They knew Messiah was to be born at the end of the year, [72](#)
The yule festival then, [76](#)
They knew the mysterious nature of the deity, [6](#), [7](#), [9](#), [90](#)
As the patriarchs, the ancient priests and philosophers, [4](#), [6](#), [9](#), [85](#), [89](#),
[94](#), [100](#)
They believ'd the unity of the divine nature, [100](#)
All this deducible from reason, [6](#), [85](#), [100](#)
They had knowledge of the cross, [101](#)
They knew alphabet-writing, [56](#)
Notions of the magic of the Druids, [21](#), [38](#), [69](#)
Druid houses, [12](#), [27](#), [47](#), [48](#), [94](#)
Druid celt or hatchet, [27](#)
Sharp flints, [33](#)*

F I N I S.

Transcriber's Notes:

- Blank pages have been removed.
- Table of contents added.
- Obvious typographical errors have been silently corrected.
- Sidenote references to illustrations replaced by inline links.
- Special font used: 'Old English Text MT'

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ABURY, A
TEMPLE OF THE BRITISH DRUIDS, WITH SOME OTHERS,
DESCRIBED ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.